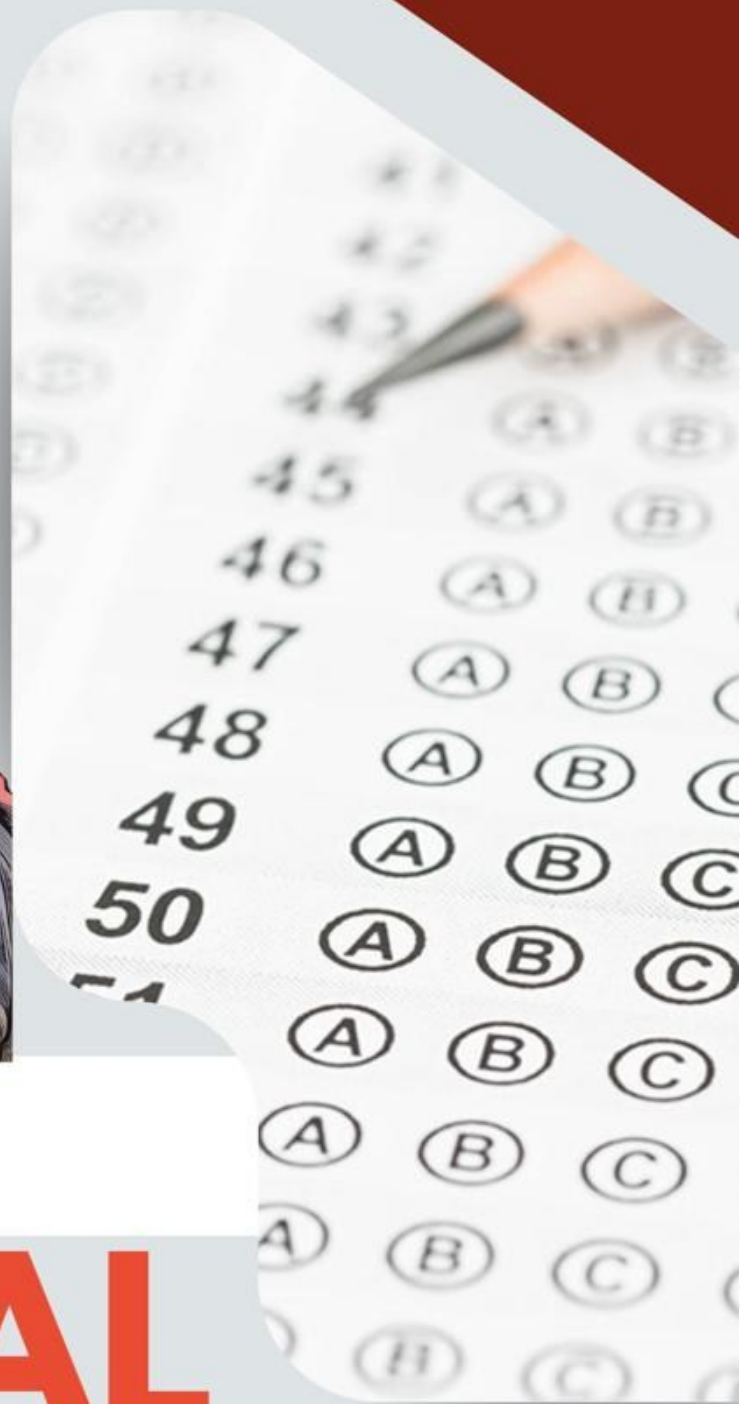




MAY 2026

SAWAAL

**The CA OBJECTIVE
Monthly e-Book**

400^{*} MCQs
Detailed
Explanation

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Important Days

Q1. Tuna fish is especially known for being rich in:

- (a) Vitamin C
- (b) Calcium
- (c) Omega-3 fatty acids
- (d) Carbohydrates

Answer: (c) — Omega-3 fatty acids

Explanation: 2nd May - World Tuna Day,
Tuna is rich in Omega-3 and it also contains minerals, proteins, and vitamin B12, among other advantages.

Q2. Vesak is associated with which of the following events in the life of Gautama Buddha? Birth Enlightenment (Nirvana) Mahaparinirvana (death) Select the correct answer:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: 1st May Vesak Day/ Buddha Purnima
Vesak, also known as Buddha Purnima, is observed on the full moon day in the month of May.
It marks three major events in the life of Gautama Buddha, all of which occurred on the same day:
Birth of the Buddha – 563 B.C.
Enlightenment (Nirvana)
Passing away (Mahaparinirvana) at the age of 80 (483 B.C.).

Q3. The Declaration of Windhoek is associated with which of the following days?

- (a) World Human Rights Day
- (b) World Press Freedom Day
- (c) International Day of Peace
- (d) World Environment Day

Answer: (b) — World Press Freedom Day

Explanation: 3 May World Press Freedom Day
3 May, the anniversary of the Declaration of Windhoek is celebrated worldwide as World Press Freedom Day.
Theme: Shaping a Future at Peace

Q4. International Sun Day is observed every year on:

- (a) 1st May
- (b) 2nd May
- (c) 3rd May
- (d) 5th May

Answer: (c) — 3rd May

Explanation: 3rd May International Sun Day
Focuses on promoting solar energy as a sustainable, clean power source to drive a green energy future

Q5. Coal mining in India first started in which coalfield?

- (a) Jharia Coalfield
- (b) Talcher Coalfield
- (c) Singrauli Coalfield
- (d) Raniganj Coalfield

Answer: (d) — Raniganj Coalfield

Explanation: 4 May – Coal Miners Day - Observed to recognise the sacrifices and hard work of the coal miners
Coal mining in India first started in the Raniganj Coalfield.

Q6. International Firefighters' Day was established after a tragic wildfire incident in:

- (a) Canada
- (b) Australia
- (c) United States
- (d) South Africa

Answer: (b) — Australia

Explanation: 4 May - International Firefighter's Day
Established after the tragic deaths of five firefighters in a wildfire in Victoria, Australia, in 1998.

Q7. Fire Safety Week (2026) will be observed from:

- (a) 1–7 May
- (b) 3–9 May
- (c) 4–10 May
- (d) 5–11 May

Answer: (c) — 4–10 May

Explanation: Union Ministry of Health & Family Welfare to Observe Pan-India 'Fire Safety Week' from 4th–10th May 2026.

It will mark the commencement of a series of awareness and preparedness activities to be conducted nationwide during the week.

Q8. World Asthma Day is observed on which of the following?

- (a) 5th May every year
- (b) First Monday of May
- (c) First Tuesday of May
- (d) Second Sunday of May

Answer: (c) — First Tuesday of May

Explanation: 5th May - World Asthma Day (First Tuesday of May)

Theme : "Access to anti-inflammatory inhalers for everyone with asthma – still an urgent need"

Q9. World Athletics Day was first introduced in:

- (a) 1992
- (b) 1994
- (c) 1996
- (d) 2000

Answer: (c) — 1996

Explanation: 7 May - World Athletics Day
The day was first introduced in 1996 by the International Amateur Athletic Federation (IAAF)—now known as World Athletics.

Q10. The theme of World Red Cross and Red Crescent Day 2026 is:

- (a) Humanity First
- (b) United in humanity
- (c) Peace Through Service
- (d) Together for Humanity

Answer: (b) — United in humanity

Explanation: 8th May World Red Cross and Red Crescent Day
THEME : United in humanity.

Q11. Which of the following symptoms is commonly associated with anemia caused by Thalassemia? Fatigue

Weakness Shortness of breath Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: 8 May World Thalassaemia Day –
Thalassemia is an inherited blood disorder where the body produces an insufficient amount of hemoglobin, the protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen.
This deficiency leads to a condition called anemia, characterized by fatigue, weakness, and shortness of breath.

Q12.

- (a) First Saturday of May
- (b) Second Saturday of May
- (c) Third Sunday of May
- (d) 9th May every year

Answer: (b) — Second Saturday of May

(4) World Migratory Bird Day is officially observed on:
Explanation: Theme: "Every Bird Counts – Your Observations Matter!"
World Migratory Bird Day is officially celebrated on the second Saturday of May in Canada and the US, and the second Saturday of October in Mexico, Central and South America, and the Caribbean.

Q13. The United Nations observes the "Time of Remembrance and Reconciliation for Those Who Lost Their Lives during the Second World War" on:

- (a) 6–7 May
- (b) 7–8 May
- (c) 8–9 May
- (d) 9–10 May

Answer: (c) — 8–9 May

Explanation: 8th – 9th May Time of Remembrance and Reconciliation (WWII)
On 2 March 2010, by resolution 64/257, the General Assembly invited all Member States, organizations of the United Nations system, non-governmental organizations and individuals to observe 8-9 May in an appropriate manner to pay tribute to all victims of the Second World War.

Q14. The theme of World Lupus Day 2026 is:

- (a) Lupus Free Future
- (b) Make Lupus Visible
- (c) Fight Autoimmune Diseases
- (d) Care for Chronic Illness

Answer: (b) — Make Lupus Visible

Explanation: 10 May- World Lupus Day
World Lupus Day is observed to raise awareness about Lupus, a chronic autoimmune disease that can cause damage to virtually any part of the body.
Theme : Make Lupus Visible

Q15. National Technology Day is observed every year to commemorate:

- (a) India's first satellite launch
- (b) The successful nuclear tests under Operation Shakti
- (c) The launch of Chandrayaan-3

(d) The establishment of ISRO

Answer: (b) — The successful nuclear tests under Operation Shakti

Explanation: National Technology Day commemorates the momentous events of 11th May 1998, when India conducted successful nuclear tests under Operation Shakti, and saw the maiden flight of the indigenously developed Hansa-3 aircraft.

In recognition of these achievements, then Prime Minister Sh. Atal Bihari Vajpayee declared 11th May as National Technology Day.

Q16. Mother's Day is observed every year on:

- (a) First Sunday of May
- (b) Second Sunday of May
- (c) Third Sunday of May
- (d) Last Sunday of May

Answer: (b) — Second Sunday of May

Explanation: 10th May International Mother's Day
Mother's Day is a significant global occasion which honours mothers and maternal figures in our lives.
Formerly known as Mothering (according to early Christian practices), the day is observed on the second Sunday in May; this year it falls on Sunday, May 10, 2026.

Q17. The theme of International Day of Plant Health 2026 is:

- (a) Plants for Climate Action
- (b) Healthy Plants, Healthy Planet
- (c) Plant Biosecurity for Food Security
- (d) Protect Plants, Protect Life

Answer: (c) — Plant Biosecurity for Food Security

Explanation: 12th May International Day of Plant Health
THEME: "Plant Biosecurity for Food Security".

Q18. The theme for International Nurses Day 2026 is:

- (a) Nurses: A Voice to Lead
- (b) Our Nurses. Our Future. Empowered Nurses Save Lives.
- (c) Nursing the World to Health
- (d) Caring Beyond Boundaries

Answer: (b) — Our Nurses. Our Future. Empowered Nurses Save Lives.

Explanation: 12th May International Nurses Day
Honors the birth anniversary of Florence Nightingale
Theme: "Our Nurses. Our Future. Empowered Nurses Save Lives."

Q19. Sirhind Fateh Divas commemorates:

- (a) The birth anniversary of Guru Gobind Singh
- (b) The victory of Khalsa forces over Sirhind in 1710
- (c) The foundation of the Khalsa Panth
- (d) The coronation of Maharaja Ranjit Singh

Answer: (b) — The victory of Khalsa forces over Sirhind in 1710

Explanation: Union Home Minister Amit Shah extended greetings to the nation on the occasion of Sirhind Fateh Divas and paid tribute to Baba Banda Singh Bahadur, Sirhind Fateh Divas commemorates the historic victory of the Khalsa forces led by Baba Banda Singh Bahadur over the Mughal administration of Sirhind in 1710.

The victory is regarded as a significant chapter in Sikh history and is remembered as a symbol of resistance against oppression and tyranny.

Q20. The 2026 theme of the International Day of Families is:

- (a) "Families and Climate Action"
- (b) "Building Stronger Communities"
- (c) "Families, Inequalities and Child Wellbeing"
- (d) "Inclusive Families for Sustainable Growth"

Answer: (c) — "Families, Inequalities and Child Wellbeing"

Explanation: In 1993, the UN General Assembly decided that 15 May of every year should be observed as The International Day of Families

2026 Theme: Families, Inequalities and Child Wellbeing

Q21. The theme of International Day of Light 2026 is:

- (a) Light for Humanity
- (b) Light and Innovation
- (c) Science for Sustainable Growth
- (d) Light for a Sustainable Future

Answer: (d) — Light for a Sustainable Future

Explanation: 16 May - International Day of Light
16th May commemorates the first successful operation of the laser by physicist and engineer Theodore Maiman in 1960.

THEME: Light for a Sustainable Future

Q22. National Dengue Day is observed in India every year on:

- (a) 12 May
- (b) 14 May
- (c) 16 May
- (d) 18 May

Answer: (c) — 16 May

Explanation: 16 May - National Dengue Day
In India it is led by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare to raise awareness about dengue fever and promote preventive measures against this mosquito-borne viral disease.

Q23. The theme of World Telecommunication and Information Society Day 2026 is:

- (a) Connecting the Unconnected
- (b) AI for Good
- (c) Digital innovation for sustainable development
- (d) Digital lifelines: Strengthening resilience in a connected world

Answer: (d) — Digital lifelines: Strengthening resilience in a connected world

Explanation: World Telecommunication Day has been celebrated since 1969, marking the founding of ITU and the signing of the first International Telegraph Convention in 1865.

The General Assembly adopted a resolution in March 2006 stipulating that World Information Society Day shall be celebrated every year on 17 May.

THEME: "Digital lifelines: Strengthening resilience in a connected world"

Q24. Which of the following organs can be damaged due to uncontrolled hypertension? Heart Brain Kidneys Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: 17 May World Hypertension Day
To raise awareness and promote hypertension prevention, detection and control

Theme: "Controlling Hypertension Together: check your blood pressure regularly, defeat the silent killer"

Q25. The exhibition "My Own Collection" primarily showcases:

- (a) Modern art installations only
- (b) Space technology exhibits
- (c) Rare historical objects and unique personal collections
- (d) Marine biodiversity specimens only

Answer: (c) — Rare historical objects and unique personal collections

Explanation: 18 May International Museum Day
The day was officially created in 1977, when a resolution approved by the ICOM General Assembly in Moscow was adopted.

The theme - "Museums Uniting a Divided World"

A special attraction of this year's celebration is the exhibition "My Own Collection", showcasing rare and fascinating historical objects along with unique personal collections reflecting the richness of India's cultural and scientific heritage.

Q26. World AIDS Vaccine Day is observed every year on:

- (a) 1 December
- (b) 7 April
- (c) 18 May
- (d) 21 June

Answer: (c) — 18 May

Explanation: 18 May World AIDS Vaccine Day (HIV Vaccine Awareness Day)

The day began on May 18, 1997, when U.S. President Bill Clinton gave a crucial speech at Morgan State University.

Q27. World Fair Play Day is observed annually on which date?

- (a) 11 April
- (b) 19 May
- (c) 21 June
- (d) 29 August

Answer: (b) — 19 May

Explanation: May 19 World Fair Play Day

Theme : Embrace the Spirit of Fair Play

Q28. The theme of World Bee Day 2026 is:

- (a) Save Bees, Save Earth
- (b) Pollinators for Future
- (c) Bee Together for People and the Planet – A partnership that sustains us all
- (d) Protect Pollinators, Protect Food

Answer: (c) — Bee Together for People and the Planet – A partnership that sustains us all

Explanation: The first World Bee Day was observed on May 20, 2018, after the United Nations General Assembly declared the date as World Bee Day in 2017

Theme: "Bee Together for People and the Planet – A partnership that sustains us all."

Q29. The theme of World Metrology Day 2026 is:

- (a) Measurements for Health
- (b) Metrology for Sustainability
- (c) Metrology: Building Trust in Policy Making
- (d) Science for Future

Answer: (c) — Metrology: Building Trust in Policy Making

Explanation: 20th May World Metrology Day 2026

This year's theme, "Metrology: Building Trust in Policy Making"

World Metrology Day is the annual celebration of the signature of the Metre Convention on 20 May 1875 by representatives of seventeen nations.

Q30. The theme of International Tea Day 2026 is:

- (a) Tea for Health
- (b) Sustainable Agriculture
- (c) Sustaining Tea, Supporting Communities
- (d) Global Tea Economy

Answer: (c) — Sustaining Tea, Supporting Communities

Explanation: 21 May International Tea Day

The inaugural International Tea Day festivity occurred in 2005 in the key tea-producing countries like India, Sri Lanka, Nepal and Kenya to focus on tea producers and the changing tea marketplace.

In 2019, the UN officially announced May 21 as the International Tea Day.

THEME: Sustaining Tea, Supporting Communities

Q31. National Anti-Terrorism Day is associated with the assassination of:

- (a) Indira Gandhi
- (b) Lal Bahadur Shastri
- (c) Rajiv Gandhi
- (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

Answer: (c) — Rajiv Gandhi

Explanation: 21 May National Anti-Terrorism Day

The origin of National Anti-Terrorism Day dates back to 1991, when former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated by a member of the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE), a Sri Lankan militant group.

Q32. The United Nations General Assembly declared May 21 as the World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development in:

- (a) 1999
- (b) 2000
- (c) 2002
- (d) 2005

Answer: (c) — 2002

Explanation: 21 May World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development

In December 2002, the UN General Assembly, declared May 21 to be the World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development.

Q33. The theme of International Day for Biological Diversity 2026 is:

- (a) Ecosystem Restoration
- (b) Harmony with Nature
- (c) Acting locally for global impact
- (d) Biodiversity and Climate Action

Answer: (c) — Acting locally for global impact

Explanation: 22 May International Day for Biological Diversity

To commemorate the adoption of the text of the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) on 22 May 1992

Theme 2026: "Acting locally for global impact"

Q34. The theme of World No Tobacco Day 2026 is:

- (a) Commit to Quit
- (b) Tobacco: Threat to Our Environment
- (c) Protecting Children from Tobacco Industry Interference
- (d) Unmasking the Appeal – Countering Nicotine and Tobacco Addiction

Answer: (d) — Unmasking the Appeal – Countering Nicotine and Tobacco Addiction

Explanation: 31st May World No-Tobacco Day

The Member States of the World Health Organization created World No Tobacco Day in 1987 to draw global attention to the tobacco epidemic and the preventable death and disease it causes.

THEME: Unmasking the appeal – countering nicotine and tobacco addiction

Q35. The theme of the Global Day of Parents 2026 is:

- (a) Families and Climate Action
- (b) Parents for Peace
- (c) Together for Parents
- (d) Parenting in a Digital World

Answer: (c) — Together for Parents

Explanation: 1 June - Global Day of Parents

2026 Theme: Together for Parents

Books

Q1. The book "The Bench, the Bar and the Bizarre" and "The Lawful and the Awful" has been authored by:

- (a) Tushar Mehta
- (b) Harish Salve
- (c) Kapil Sibal
- (d) Mukul Rohatgi

Answer: (a) — Tushar Mehta

Explanation: Shri Amit Shah, releases Solicitor General Shri Tushar Mehta's book 'The Bench, the Bar, and the Bizarre and the Lawful and the Awful' in New Delhi

Q2. The book "The Folk Festival of Ganga Jatara in Tirupati" is authored by:

- (a) C. Narayana Reddy
- (b) Peta Srinivasulu Reddy
- (c) Viswanatha Satyanarayana
- (d) Yarlagadda Lakshmi Prasad

Answer: (b) — Peta Srinivasulu Reddy

Explanation: The English version of the book 'The folk festival of Ganga Jatara in Tirupati' was released on the final day of the nine-day annual "Gangamma Jatara".

The book is authored by Peta Srinivasulu Reddy, a retired professor of Telugu at Sri Venkateswara University (SVU).

Q3. Who is the author of the book Apnapan, based on Prime Minister Narendra Modi?

- (a) Shivraj Singh Chouhan
- (b) Amit Shah
- (c) Rajnath Singh
- (d) M. Venkaiah Naidu

Answer: (a) — Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Explanation: Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has authored a book on Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Titled Apnapan, the book will be released on May 26 by former vice-president M Venkaiah Naidu and former prime minister H D Deve Gowda,

Q4. Which publishing house released All-Time Favourite Friendship Stories?

- (a) HarperCollins India
- (b) Penguin Random House India
- (c) Rupa Publications
- (d) Aleph Book Company

Answer: (b) — Penguin Random House India

Explanation: Celebrated Indian author Ruskin Bond marked his 92nd birthday on 19 May 2026 by launching his newest anthology, All-Time Favourite Friendship Stories, in Dehradun.

Title: All-Time Favourite Friendship Stories

Publisher: Published by Penguin Random House India as the latest installment in the popular "All-Time Favourite" series.

Q5. Who has been given the additional charge of Chairman of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)?

- (a) Ajit Doval
- (b) Rajesh Kumar Singh
- (c) Samir V. Kamat
- (d) Anil Chauhan

Answer: (b) — Rajesh Kumar Singh

Explanation: Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh was given the additional charge of Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) Chairman

He will take up the additional responsibilities from 31 May 2026, after the completion of the tenure of Dr. Samir V. Kamat.

Q6. Who recently assumed charge as the 48th Vice Chief of the Naval Staff?

- (a) Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar
- (b) Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan
- (c) Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi
- (d) Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

Answer: (a) — Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar

Explanation: Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar, who spearheaded high-level naval combat readiness during Operation Sindoor, assumed charge as the 48th Vice Chief of the Naval Staff.

Vice Admiral Kochhar was commissioned into the Indian Navy on July 1, 1988.

Q7. Y. Balaji Kiran, recently in the news, belongs to which service?

- (a) Indian Railway Accounts Service (IRAS)
- (b) Indian Railway Personnel Service (IRPS)
- (c) Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS)
- (d) Indian Railway Service of Engineers (IRSE)

Answer: (c) — Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS)

Explanation: Y. Balaji Kiran, a 2013-batch Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) officer, has taken additional charge as the Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of the South Coast Railway (SCoR).

Mr. Balaji Kiran has been serving as the Deputy General Manager-cum-Secretary to the General Manager of South Coast Railway since November 2025

Appointments

Q1. Who has been appointed as the Chairman of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)?

- (a) Prasoon Joshi
- (b) Shashi Shekhar Vempati
- (c) Anurag Thakur
- (d) Amit Khare

Answer: (b) — Shashi Shekhar Vempati

Explanation: The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting appointed former Prasar Bharati CEO Shashi Shekhar Vempati as the Chairman of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC).

An, alumnus of IIT-Bombay, Mr. Vempati was the CEO of Prasar Bharati from 2017 to 2022.

Q2. Who has been appointed as the Director of Cricket Operations for the Hyderabad Cricket Association (HCA)?

- (a) Ambati Rayudu
- (b) VVS Laxman
- (c) Mohammad Azharuddin
- (d) Robin Uthappa

Answer: (a) — Ambati Rayudu

Explanation: Former Indian cricketer Ambati Rayudu has been appointed as the Director of Cricket Operations for the Hyderabad Cricket Association (HCA).

Q3. Who has been appointed as the Managing Director of Mahanagar Gas Limited?

- (a) Ashu Shinghal
- (b) Sanjiv Singh
- (c) Praveer Kumar Srivastava
- (d) Sandeep Kumar Gupta

Answer: (c) — Praveer Kumar Srivastava

Q4. Praveer Kumar Srivastava has recently taken over as Managing Director of which company?

- (a) GAIL (India) Limited
- (b) Indian Oil Corporation Limited
- (c) Mahanagar Gas Limited
- (d) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited

Answer: (c) — Mahanagar Gas Limited

Explanation: Mahanagar Gas Ltd has announced that Praveer Kumar Srivastava has taken over as its Managing Director.

Prior to joining MGL, Mr. Srivastava served as Executive Director, Western Region at GAIL.

Q5. Recently, who has taken charge as the 22nd Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Hindustan Aeronautics Limited?

- (a) D. K. Sunil
- (b) Ravi K.
- (c) R. Madhavan
- (d) S. Somanath

Answer: (b) — Ravi K.

Explanation: Ravi K. has taken charge as the 22nd Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Bengaluru-headquartered Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).

Q6. Who has been appointed as the President of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)?

- (a) Anupinder Singh Grewal
- (b) Ramalingam Sudhakar
- (c) D. Y. Chandrachud
- (d) N. V. Ramana

Answer: (a) — Anupinder Singh Grewal

Explanation: Justice (retired) Anupinder Singh Grewal, a former judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, has been appointed President of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).

Justice Grewal succeeds Justice (retired) Ramalingam Sudhakar, former Chief Justice of the Manipur High Court, who demitted office earlier this year.

Q7. Who has been appointed as the Festival Director for the 57th edition of the International Film Festival of India?

- (a) Sanjay Leela Bhansali
- (b) Karan Johar
- (c) Rajkumar Hirani
- (d) Ashutosh Gowariker

Answer: (d) — Ashutosh Gowariker

Explanation: Noted filmmaker Ashutosh Gowariker has been appointed as the Festival Director for the 57th edition of the International Film Festival of India (IFFI), to be held in Goa. Gowariker is known for films such as Lagaan, Swadesh and Jodha Akbar.

Q8. Bharat Khera has assumed charge as Secretary in the:

- (a) Ministry of Rural Development
- (b) Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- (c) Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
- (d) Ministry of Consumer Affairs

Answer: (c) — Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Explanation: Bharat Khera has assumed charge as Secretary in the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises.

Q9. Who has been appointed as the non-executive Vice Chairman of Infosys?

- (a) Nandan Nilekani
- (b) Salil Parekh
- (c) Nitin Paranjpe
- (d) Rishi Sunak

Answer: (c) — Nitin Paranjpe

Explanation: Infosys has announced that the Board of Directors has approved the appointment of Nitin Paranjpe as non-executive Vice Chairman of the Board with immediate effect, as per the company's regulatory filing.

Q10. With reference to the State Information Commission (SIC), consider the following statements: It is a constitutional body. The number of Information Commissioners is uniform across all States. The State Chief Information Commissioner holds office for a term of three years or until attaining the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 3 only

Explanation: Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot has appointed retired IAS officer Sathyavathi G. as the Chief Information Commissioner of the Karnataka Information Commission. The State Information Commission (SIC) is a statutory body established under the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, to promote transparency and accountability in the functioning of state public authorities.

The State Chief Information Commissioner and other State Information Commissioners serve a term of three years or until reaching 65 years of age, whichever comes first. Reappointment after their tenure is not permitted.

Q11. Who has been appointed as the Chairman of Prasar Bharati?

- (a) Gulzar
- (b) Prasoon Joshi
- (c) Javed Akhtar
- (d) Shankar Mahadevan

Answer: (b) — Prasoon Joshi

Explanation: The Ministry of Information & Broadcasting has appointed noted lyricist, writer and communications expert Shri Prasoon Joshi as the Chairman of Prasar Bharati, India's public service broadcaster.

Shri Joshi has served as Chairperson, Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), Mumbai since August 2017

Q12. Rohit Jain has been appointed as the Deputy Governor of the:

- (a) Securities and Exchange Board of India
- (b) Reserve Bank of India
- (c) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
- (d) Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India

Answer: (b) — Reserve Bank of India

Explanation: The government has appointed Rohit Jain as a deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India. Mr. Jain's appointment will take effect from May 3 for a period of three years.

Q13. Prime Minister Narendra Modi approved the appointment of Dr R Balasubramaniam and Dr Joram Aniya as:

- (a) Governors of states

- (b) Full-time members of NITI Aayog
- (c) Members of the Finance Commission
- (d) Deputy Governors of RBI

Answer: (b) — Full-time members of NITI Aayog

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi has approved the appointment of Dr R Balasubramaniam and Dr Joram Aniya as full-time members of NITI Aayog.

With the two new additions, the total number of full-time members of NITI Aayog will now rise to seven.

Q14. Commodore Jasvinder Singh has assumed charge as Director (Strategic Projects) at:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- (d) Cochin Shipyard Limited

Answer: (c) — Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Explanation: Commodore Jasvinder Singh has assumed charge as Director (Strategic Projects) at Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL).

Q15. Yoweri Museveni was sworn in as the President of which country?

- (a) Kenya
- (b) Tanzania
- (c) Uganda
- (d) Rwanda

Answer: (c) — Uganda

Explanation: Ugandan President Yoweri Museveni has been sworn in for a historic seventh term, extending his 40-year tenure following a landslide victory

Uganda is a landlocked country in East Africa

Q16. Who has been appointed as the next Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Naval Command?

- (a) Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi
- (b) Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan
- (c) Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan
- (d) Admiral R Hari Kumar

Answer: (b) — Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan

Explanation: Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan has been appointed as the next Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Naval Command, headquartered in Mumbai.

He is currently serving as the Vice Chief of Naval Staff.

Q17. Who has been unanimously elected as the first chairman of the Sardar Patel Cooperative Dairy Federation Limited (SPCDF)?

- (a) Amit Shah
- (b) Abhay Karandikar
- (c) Dr M Srinivas
- (d) Jayan Mehta

Answer: (d) — Jayan Mehta

Explanation: Jayan Mehta was unanimously elected as the first chairman of the Sardar Patel Cooperative Dairy Federation Limited (SPCDF).

The Sardar Patel Cooperative Dairy Federation Limited is a newly formed multi-state cooperative federation in India.

Q18. Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan will succeed _____ as the Chief of the Naval Staff.

- (a) Admiral R. Hari Kumar
- (b) Admiral Sunil Lanba
- (c) Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi
- (d) Admiral Arun Prakash

Answer: (c) — Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi

Explanation: The Government appointed Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan as the next Chief of the Naval Staff. He will succeed Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi, who is scheduled to retire on May 31, 2026.

Q19. Who has been appointed as the new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India?

- (a) General Anil Chauhan
- (b) Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani
- (c) General Manoj Pande
- (d) Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi

Answer: (b) — Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani

Explanation: The Government of India has appointed Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani as the new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS). He will succeed General Anil Chauhan after the latter completes his tenure on 30 May 2026.

Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani is a retired senior officer of the Indian Army appointed as India's new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS).

Q20. Péter Magyar has become the new Prime Minister of which country?

- (a) Hungary
- (b) Poland
- (c) Romania
- (d) Slovakia

Answer: (a) — Hungary

Explanation: Péter Magyar, Hungary's new prime minister, has risen rapidly from a little-known insider to the leader who unseated Viktor Orbán after 16 years in power
Capital: Budapest

Q21. The Karnataka government appointed retired Karnataka High Court Judge Ramachandra D. Huddar as the chairperson of the:

- (a) Karnataka Public Service Commission
- (b) Admission Overseeing Committee (AOC)
- (c) State Education Commission
- (d) Karnataka Law Commission

Answer: (b) — Admission Overseeing Committee (AOC)

Explanation: The Karnataka government has finally appointed retired Karnataka High Court judge Ramachandra D. Huddar as chairperson for the Admission Overseeing Committee (AOC) for professional courses.

Judge B. Manohar's term as AOC chairperson had ended in October 2024.

Q22. Kuljeet Kaur Marhas became the first Indian woman to be elected Fellow of the:

- (a) Royal Society
- (b) International Astronomical Union
- (c) Meteoritical Society
- (d) Geological Society of America

Answer: (c) — Meteoritical Society

Explanation: Kuljeet Kaur Marhas Becomes First Indian Woman Fellow

Kuljeet Kaur Marhas has become the first Indian woman to be elected Fellow of The Meteoritical Society(HQ :USA), one of the world's most prestigious honours in meteoritics and planetary science.

Prof. Marhas, a professor in the Planetary Science Division at Physical Research Laboratory in Ahmedabad, was elected as a Fellow of the society for 2026, joining an elite group of global scientists and researchers recognised for exceptional contributions to the study of planetary materials and the origins of the Solar System.

Prof. Marhas is internationally known for her pioneering work on short-lived radionuclides and stable isotopes found in extraterrestrial materials.

Founded in 1933, the Meteoritical Society has elected Fellows for more than nine decades.

In its 93-year history, Prof. Marhas is only the third Indian scientist to receive the honour, following the late Devendra Lal and JN Goswami.

Q23. Who is Q Manivannan, recently seen in the news?

- (a) India's first transgender judge
- (b) UN Human Rights Rapporteur
- (c) CEO of a global technology company
- (d) Indian-origin member elected to the Scottish Parliament

Answer: (d) — Indian-origin member elected to the Scottish Parliament

Explanation: An Indian-origin transgender candidate Q Manivannan has been elected to the Scottish Parliament despite not having permanent UK residency.

Q Manivannan, a PhD student represent "diversity in power," is among the newest members of the Scottish Parliament, also referred to as Holyrood.

A native of India's Tamil Nadu, Manivannan arrived in Scotland in September 2021 as a PhD student at the University of St Andrews.

Q24. Prashant Pise has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to

- (a) Qatar
- (b) United Arab Emirates
- (c) Oman
- (d) Bahrain

Answer: (c) — Oman

Explanation: Additional Secretary in the Ministry of External Affairs, Prashant Pise, has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to the Sultanate of Oman.

A 1995 batch Indian Foreign Service officer, Mr Pise, will succeed Godavarthi Venkata Srinivas from the 1993 Indian Foreign Service batch in Muscat.

Q25. Professor Susan Elias is set to become the first woman principal of:

- (a) Miranda House
- (b) Lady Shri Ram College
- (c) St Stephen's College
- (d) Hindu College

Answer: (c) — St Stephen's College

Explanation: Professor Susan Elias, a computer scientist and academic administrator, is set to become the St Stephen's

college's first woman principal from June 1. She succeeds Professor John Varghese.

Q26. Who was named as the successor to P.R. Sreejesh as coach of the Indian junior men's hockey team?

- (a) Graham Reid
- (b) Frederic Soye
- (c) Craig Fulton
- (d) Ric Charlesworth

Answer: (b) — Frederic Soye

Explanation: The Junior men's team, Hockey India named Frenchman and former France and Spain coach Frederic Soye as his successor.

REPLACING P.R. Sreejesh

Q27. Consider the following statements regarding the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI): The CBI Director is appointed by the Central Government on the recommendation of a three-member committee. The Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha is a member of the selection committee for appointment of the CBI Director. The CBI derives its powers from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) Director, Praveen Sood, has been given another one-year extension, as approved by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) based on the recommendations of the Selection Committee.

As per the Delhi Special Police Establishment (DSPE) Act 1946, the CBI Director is appointed by the Central Government on the recommendation of a 3-members committee consisting of

Prime Minister (Chairperson)

Chief Justice of India (or Judge of the Supreme Court nominated by him)

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha (or the leader of the single largest opposition party in Lok Sabha).

The CBI is not a statutory body. It derives its powers from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.

Q28. P. Kumaran has been appointed as India's High Commissioner-designate to:

- (a) Canada
- (b) Australia
- (c) Singapore
- (d) United Kingdom

Answer: (d) — United Kingdom

Explanation: P. Kumaran assumed charge as India's High Commissioner-designate to the United Kingdom .

Kumaran served as India's Ambassador to Qatar from 2016 to 2020 and as High Commissioner to Singapore from 2020 to 2023.

Q29. Senior IPS officer Sibash Kabiraj has been appointed as the new Police Commissioner of Gurugram, replacing

- (a) Shatrujeet Kapur
- (b) Vikram Kumar Arora
- (c) Pankaj Nain
- (d) Manoj Yadav

Answer: (b) — Vikram Kumar Arora

Explanation: The Haryana government has appointed senior IPS officer Sibash Kabiraj as the new Police Commissioner of Gurugram, replacing Vikram Kumar Arora.

Q30. Who has assumed charge as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)?

- (a) Saurabh Garg
- (b) Saurabh Vijay
- (c) Amit Agrawal
- (d) Rajesh Kumar

Answer: (b) — Saurabh Vijay

Explanation: Shri Saurabh Vijay assumed charge as the Chief Executive Officer of Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI).

He was Principal Secretary (Expenditure) in the Finance Department, Government of Maharashtra, prior to joining UIDAI.

Q31. Tushar Kumar recently became the youngest Indian-origin mayor in which country?

- (a) Canada
- (b) Australia
- (c) United States
- (d) United Kingdom

Answer: (d) — United Kingdom

Explanation: Tushar Kumar has made history by becoming the youngest Indian-origin mayor of the United Kingdom's Elstree & Borehamwood at just 23 years old.

His mayoral appointment was confirmed during the council's Mayor Making Ceremony held at Fairway Hall in Borehamwood on 13 May.

Q32. Who became the first woman officer in the Indian armed forces to earn the Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor (QFI) qualification?

- (a) Squadron Leader Saanya
- (b) Wing Commander Anjali Singh
- (c) Group Captain Shaliza Dhani
- (d) Flight Lieutenant Avani Chaturvedi

Answer: (a) — Squadron Leader Saanya

Explanation: Squadron Leader Saanya has achieved a historic milestone after becoming the first woman officer in the Indian armed forces to earn the coveted Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor (QFI) qualification.

Squadron Leader Saanya is an officer in the Flying branch who was commissioned on June 20, 2015, as part of the 42 SSC (W) FP Course. She was elevated to the rank of Flight Lieutenant in 2017 and promoted to Squadron Leader in 2021.

Q33. Who became the first Indian test pilot to be elected as a Fellow of the Society of Experimental Test Pilots (SETP)?

- (a) Rakesh Sharma

- (b) K.K. Venugopal
- (c) Ajay Kumar
- (d) S. Somanath

Answer: (b) — K.K. Venugopal

Explanation: Gp Capt. K.K. Venugopal has become the first Indian test pilot to be elected as a Fellow of the Society of Experimental Test Pilots (SETP).

Gp Capt. Venugopal, who is the executive director and Chief Test Pilot (Fixed Wing), Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), has been involved in key indigenous programmes like the Saras LTA, LCA Mk I, HTT 40, HJT 36 and LCA Mk IA.

Q34. Jasmeet Singh Bindra has assumed charge as the Chairperson of the:

- (a) Mumbai Port Authority
- (b) Chennai Port Authority
- (c) Visakhapatnam Port Authority
- (d) Paradip Port Authority

Answer: (c) — Visakhapatnam Port Authority

Explanation: Jasmeet Singh Bindra, an officer of the 1996 batch of the Indian Railway Traffic Service, assumed charge as the Chairperson of the Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA).

Prior to his new assignment, Mr. Bindra served as the Principal Chief Operations Manager of the South East Central Railway at Bilaspur.

Q35. Mohammed Shah has been appointed as the Additional Advocate General of which state?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (c) — Kerala

Explanation: Mohammed Shah, a lawyer of the High Court of Kerala, has been appointed as the Additional Advocate General of Kerala.

Q36. N.S.K. Umesh, recently seen in news, was appointed as the Additional Secretary and Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the Chief Minister of:

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (c) — Kerala

Explanation: The Department of General Administration has issued orders appointing N.S.K Umesh, Director of General Education, as the Additional Secretary and Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the Chief Minister of Kerala.

Q37. Manindra Agrawal was elected as a Fellow of the:

- (a) American Physical Society
- (b) Royal Society
- (c) Royal Geographical Society
- (d) Indian National Science Academy

Answer: (b) — Royal Society

Explanation: Manindra Agrawal, Director of the Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur, was elected a Fellow of the Royal Society. Manindra Agrawal received the Padma Shri in 2013 and the Gödel Prize in 2006.

Awards

Q1. Consider the following statements regarding the President's Police Colour Award: It is the highest honour bestowed upon a police force in India. The award can be conferred multiple times on the same police force. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah addressed the President's Colour Award Ceremony of the National Disaster Response Force in Ghaziabad as the Chief Guest.

The President's Police Colour award, also known as 'Nishaan', is the highest honour bestowed upon a police force in India, in recognition of its exceptional service, bravery and professionalism

The President of India's Police Colour is awarded only once to a force .

It is awarded based on parameters such as discipline, bravery, professionalism, and notable contributions to public safety.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding the National Panchayat Awards 2025: Andhra Pradesh secured the highest number of awards in 2025. Financial incentives for winning Panchayats range from ₹50 lakh to ₹5 crore. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: The government has announced the winners of the National Panchayat Awards 2025, with 42 Panchayats from across the country being selected for the honours.

The Ministry of Panchayati Raj informed that the award distribution ceremony will be held in New Delhi on the 3rd of next month.

Karnataka has secured the highest number of awards with six Panchayats being selected, followed by Andhra Pradesh and Odisha with five awards each.

the winning Panchayats will receive financial incentives ranging from 50 lakh rupees to five crore rupees, depending on the category and tier.

Q3. Each National Florence Nightingale Award carries a cash prize of :

- (a) ₹50,000
- (b) ₹75,000
- (c) ₹1 lakh
- (d) ₹2 lakh

Answer: (c) — ₹1 lakh

Explanation: The President of India, Smt Droupadi Murmu presented the National Florence Nightingale Awards for the year 2026 to the nursing personnel, on the occasion of

International Nurses Day, at a function held at Rashtrapati Bhavan.

A total of 15 awards are given in the category of Registered Auxiliary Nurses & Midwife, Registered Nurses and Midwife and Registered Lady Visitor.

The National Florence Nightingale Awards were instituted in 1973 by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, as a mark of recognition for the meritorious services rendered by nursing personnel to society.

Each award includes a Certificate of Merit, a cash prize of one lakh rupees and a medal symbolising the nation's gratitude for the invaluable service rendered by these health warriors.

Q4. Match the following regarding the 2026 BAFTA Television Awards: List I List II Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) P&O Cruises Memorable Moment Award
- (b) BAFTA Fellowship
- (c) Limited Drama
- (d) Special Award
- (a) A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
- (b) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
- (c) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- (d) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Answer: (a) — P&O Cruises Memorable Moment Award

- (1) Dame Mary Berry
- (2) Martin Lewis
- (3) Adolescence
- (4) The Celebrity Traitors – Alan Carr wins

Explanation: BAFTA has announced the winners of the 2026 BAFTA Television Awards with P&O Cruises at a ceremony in London

Adolescence wins four BAFTAs

Public vote for The Celebrity Traitors as the P&O Cruises Memorable Moment Award winner

Category

Winner

Limited drama

Adolescence (Netflix)

Bafta Fellowship

Dame Mary Berry

Special award

Martin Lewis

P&O Cruises Memorable Moment Award (voted for by the public)

The Celebrity Traitors - Alan Carr wins (BBC One)

Q5. Soma Mandal was announced as the regional winner of the 2026 Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Awards for which region?

- (a) East Asia
- (b) Europe
- (c) South Asia
- (d) Africa

Answer: (c) — South Asia

Explanation: The International Education group at Cambridge University Press & Assessment (Cambridge) announced science teacher, Soma Mandal, as the regional

winner of the 2026 Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Awards in the South Asia region.

Soma was selected by the judges for her dedication to empowering pupils to participate in the 'worldwide fight against climate change'.

Q6. The 2026 UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize was awarded to:

- (a) Reporters Without Borders
- (b) Sudanese Journalists Syndicate
- (c) Committee to Protect Journalists
- (d) International Federation of Journalists

Answer: (b) — Sudanese Journalists Syndicate

Explanation: UNESCO has awarded the 2026 UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize to the Sudanese Journalists Syndicate.

The UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize is the only UN-recognized award honoring individuals or organizations defending press freedom under difficult conditions.

Established In: 1997

Q7. Indian journalists R.K. Anand and Suparna Sharma have won the Pulitzer Prize 2026 in which category?

- (a) Investigative Reporting
- (b) Public Service
- (c) Breaking News Reporting
- (d) Illustrated Reporting and Commentary

Answer: (d) — Illustrated Reporting and Commentary

Explanation: Indian journalists R.K. Anand and Suparna Sharma have won the prestigious Pulitzer Prize 2026 for their work highlighting digital surveillance and cyber fraud. They share the award with Natalie Obiko Pearson of Bloomberg in the Illustrated Reporting and Commentary category.

The Pulitzer Prizes, administered by Columbia University, are regarded as among the highest honours in journalism, literature and music composition, recognising excellence in reporting and storytelling.

The Pulitzer Prizes, established in 1917 by the will of Joseph Pulitzer, are among the most esteemed awards in journalism and the arts.

These awards span various categories, including journalism, books, drama, and music

It is administered by Columbia University and named in honor of newspaper publisher Joseph Pulitzer.

The awards are given in 23 categories, with the majority receiving the \$15,000 cash prize and certificate.

The Public Service category is the only exception, receiving a gold medal instead

Journalism

Public Service: The Washington Post

Illustrated Reporting and Commentary: Anand RK and Suparna Sharma, contributors, and Natalie Obiko Pearson of Bloomberg

Q8. Sankhadeep Banerjee recently won the Photojournalism category of the ACJ Journalism Awards for which photograph?

- (a) Silent Protest
- (b) Protestors at rest

- (c) Midnight March
- (d) Voices of Resistance

Answer: (b) — Protestors at rest

Explanation: The Indian Express photographer Sankhadeep Banerjee has won the Photojournalism category of the Asian College of Journalism (ACJ) Journalism Awards 2025, for his image titled "Protestors at rest".

The photograph, captured in Mumbai last year, shows a bird's-eye view of hundreds of Maratha quota protestors lying across the floor of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus at midnight, offering a powerful visual of pause amid a prolonged agitation.

Q9. The Andaman and Nicobar administration set a new Guinness World Record by unfurling the world's largest underwater national flag measuring approximately 60 × 40 metres at:

- (a) Elephant Beach
- (b) Radhanagar Beach
- (c) Marina Beach
- (d) Corbyn's Cove Beach

Answer: (b) — Radhanagar Beach

Explanation: The Andaman and Nicobar administration set a new Guinness World Record by unfurling the world's largest underwater national flag at Radhanagar beach.

The massive Tricolour, measuring approximately 60 by 40 metres.

Q10. Barkha Subba won the 2026 Whitley Awards for her work related to:

- (a) Guardians of the Skimmer initiative
- (b) Coral reef protection in Lakshadweep
- (c) Mangrove restoration in Sundarbans
- (d) Conservation of Himalayan Salamander

Answer: (d) — Conservation of Himalayan Salamander

Explanation: Barkha Subba and Parveen Shaikh have won the prestigious 2026 Whitley Awards from India, for their work on protecting the habitat of the Himalayan Salamander and community led protection of the nesting sites of Indian Skimmer on the Chambal river.

Barkha, is a scientific adviser at Darjeeling based Federation of Societies for Environmental Protection will lead the first coordinated grassroots effort to secure the future of the Himalayan salamander in Darjeeling.

Q11. _____ has been selected for the Karnataka Lalithakala Academy's Honorary Award for 2024–25.

- (a) K. S. Radhakrishnan
- (b) M. G. Doddamani
- (c) Anish Kapoor
- (d) Jatin Das

Answer: (b) — M. G. Doddamani

Explanation: Kalaburagi-based/Karnataka artist M. G. Doddamani has been selected for the Karnataka Lalithakala Academy's Honorary Award for 2024-25, in recognition of his contribution to the visual arts.

The award carries a cash prize of ₹50,000.

An accomplished artist and educator, Mr. Doddamani has been actively engaged in mentoring young artists and contributing to contemporary art discourse.

Q12. CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) were recognized by the India Book of Records and Asia Book of Records for establishing which record title?

- (a) First Smart Highway Built with Solar Panels
- (b) First AI-Based Road Safety Monitoring System
- (c) First Plastic-Free National Highway Corridor
- (d) First Roadblock Section Constructed Using Technical Textile Geocell Made from End-of-Life Plastic

Answer: (d) — First Roadblock Section Constructed Using Technical Textile Geocell Made from End-of-Life Plastic

Explanation: CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI), in collaboration with Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), has been recognized by the India Book of Records and Asia Book of Records for establishing the record titled "First Roadblock Section Constructed Using Technical Textile Geocell Made from End-of-Life Plastic."

The record recognition by Asia Book of Records acknowledges the novelty and impact of this first-of-its-kind demonstration in road engineering.

Q13. Which water board from India was recognised among the top five water utilities at the Global Water Summit 2026?

- (a) Delhi Jal Board
- (b) Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board
- (c) Bengaluru Water Supply and Sewerage Board
- (d) Hyderabad Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board

Answer: (c) — Bengaluru Water Supply and Sewerage Board

Explanation: The Bengaluru Water Supply and Sewerage Board (BWSSB) has been recognised as one of the top five water utilities at the Global Water Summit 2026 being held in Madrid, Spain.

"BWSSB was listed among the top five "Utility of the Year" category, considered one of the highest recognitions in the international water sector.

Its flagship Cauvery Stage-V Drinking Water Project, implemented to address Bengaluru's growing water demand, also secured a place among the Top 5 global projects under the "Water Project of the Year" category,

Q14. Consider the following statements regarding the International Booker Prize: It is awarded annually for translated works of fiction published in the UK and/or Ireland. It recognises both authors and translators equally. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Taiwan Travelogue by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ, translated by Lin King won the 2026 International Booker Prize.

It is awarded annually.

It was established in 2005 as the Man Booker International Prize.

It celebrates the best works of long-form fiction or collections of short stories translated into English and published in the UK and/or Ireland.

It recognises the vital work of translators, with the £50,000 prize money divided equally between authors and translators.

In addition, shortlisted authors and translators each receive £2,500.

This prize aims to encourage more reading of quality fiction from all over the world.

Q15. The Prime Minister was recently conferred with the prestigious Agricola Medal by which organization?

- (a) UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- (b) FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization
- (c) WHO – World Health Organization
- (d) IFAD – International Fund for Agricultural Development

Answer: (b) — FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization

Explanation: The Prime Minister was recently conferred with the prestigious FAO Agricola Medal by the Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations.

It is the highest honour conferred by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations.

It is awarded to distinguished individuals who have played an exceptional role in advancing efforts toward global food security, improved nutrition and agricultural development.

Q16. The 'Royal Order of the Polar Star, Degree Commander Grand Cross' conferred upon Prime Minister Narendra Modi is the highest honour of which country?

- (a) Sweden
- (b) Denmark
- (c) Norway
- (d) Finland

Answer: (a) — Sweden

Explanation: The Prime Minister was conferred with Sweden's highest honor for a foreign head of government, the 'Royal Order of the Polar Star, Degree Commander Grand Cross'.

This is Prime Minister Modi's 31st international honour.

The Royal Order of the Polar Star (Nordstjärneorden) is a prestigious Swedish order of chivalry.

It is the premier state distinction used by the Scandinavian nation to honor foreign heads of government, royalty, and individuals for outstanding public service, breakthrough institutional achievements, and the successful execution of public duties that advance Swedish interests globally.

Q17. The Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit awarded by Norway became Prime Minister Narendra Modi's _____ international honour.

- (a) 30th
- (b) 31st
- (c) 32nd
- (d) 33rd

Answer: (c) 32nd

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with Norway's highest civilian honour, the Grand Cross of

the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit, for his contribution to advancing the India-Norway relationship and his leadership. This is Prime Minister Modi's 32nd international honour. King Harald V of Norway conferred upon PM Modi the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.

Q18. Which state has been selected as the 'Best Tourism Promotion State' by the Global Travel Market (GTM) 2026?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (c) — Andhra Pradesh

Explanation: The Andhra Pradesh Tourism Department has been selected as the 'Best Tourism Promotion State' by the Global Travel Market (GTM 2026), one of South India's largest travel and trade expos.

As part of this recognition, Tourism, Culture and Cinematography Minister Kandula Durgesh has been officially invited to receive the 'Metro Expedition – GTM Tourism Award 2026',

Q19. Who was honoured with the Jal Champion Award 2026 by WaterAid International?

- (a) Bisathi Bharath
- (b) Rajendra Singh
- (c) Sonam Wangchuk
- (d) M. S. Swaminathan

Answer: (a) — Bisathi Bharath

Explanation: Social worker Bisathi Bharath from Anantapur district, Andhra Pradesh has been honoured with the prestigious Jal Champion Award 2026 by WaterAid International

in recognition of his outstanding contribution towards Water Conservation, WASH (Water, Sanitation and Hygiene) initiatives, and promoting safe drinking water awareness among communities and youth across India.

Q20. The Order of Mapungubwe is the highest civilian honour of:

- (a) India
- (b) South Africa
- (c) Kenya
- (d) Nigeria

Answer: (b) — South Africa

Explanation: Professor Salim Abdool Karim and Professor Keertan Dheda, two Indian-origin public health scientists, received South Africa's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mapungubwe in Pretoria.

President Cyril Ramaphosa conferred the award during a formal ceremony.

The Order of Mapungubwe is a South African national honour awarded to citizens for excellence and exceptional achievement.

Q21. The Indian Haj Mission received how many Labbaytum Awards for Haj 2026?

- (a) One
- (b) Two
- (c) Three
- (d) Four

Answer: (b) — Two

Explanation: For the first time, the Indian Haj Mission has received two prestigious Labbaytum Awards from the Saudi Ministry of Hajj and Umrah for excellence in Haj coordination and communication.

The core phase of Haj 2026 reflects the seamless coordination between the Ministry of Minority Affairs, the Haj Committee of India, and the Indian Haj Mission, led by India's Ambassador to Saudi Arabia and the Consul General in Jeddah.

Q22. 'Samadhan Didi', recently launched by the Government of India, is primarily associated with:

- (a) Digital payments
- (b) Healthcare consultations
- (c) Public grievance redressal
- (d) Online education

Answer: (c) — Public grievance redressal

Explanation: In a first-of-its-kind initiative, the Government of India launched "Samadhan Didi", an AI enabled, voice first chatbot for the Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS), enabling citizens to register grievances simply by speaking in their preferred language. The chatbot is designed to help citizens lodge grievances with ease, particularly those who are unsure where to submit a complaint or whom to address it to, and those who are unable to draft complaints in Hindi or English.

Q23. The ToFEI application recently launched by the Government of India is:

- (a) A digital platform for monitoring tobacco-free guidelines in educational institutions
- (b) An online portal for tobacco product licensing
- (c) A mobile application for tobacco farmers
- (d) A platform for tobacco taxation management

Answer: (a) — A digital platform for monitoring tobacco-free guidelines in educational institutions

Explanation: Ahead of World No Tobacco Day 2026, Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava launched the pilot version of the Tobacco-Free Educational Institutions (ToFEI) Application and released a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for tobacco product sample collection, reinforcing the Centre's efforts to combat tobacco and nicotine addiction among youth.

The ToFEI application is a digital platform aimed at strengthening the implementation and monitoring of tobacco-free guidelines across schools and colleges.

Q24. The 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan' is scheduled to be carried out across the country during:

- (a) May 1 to May 31
- (b) June 1 to June 30
- (c) July 1 to July 31
- (d) August 1 to August 31

Answer: (b) — June 1 to June 30

Explanation: 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan' to be carried out across the country from June 1 to June 30

The Khet Bachao Abhiyan to be made a comprehensive national campaign connecting farms, farmers and villages.

Obituary

Q1. Ted Turner, who recently passed away, is best known for founding:

- (a) BBC
- (b) Fox News
- (c) Al Jazeera
- (d) CNN

Answer: (d) — CNN

Explanation: Ted Turner, media pioneer and the outspoken businessman who reshaped global television news by launching CNN in 1980, has died at the age of 87.

Turner helped revolutionize how audiences consumed news by creating the world's first 24-hour television news network.

Nicknamed "Captain Outrageous" and "The Mouth of the South,"

Q2. J. Craig Venter is best known for:

- (a) Discovery of DNA double helix structure
- (b) Mapping the first draft of the human genome
- (c) Development of CRISPR gene editing
- (d) Cloning of Dolly the sheep

Answer: (b) — Mapping the first draft of the human genome

Explanation: J. Craig Venter, who mapped the first draft of the human genome and helped scientists understand how genes shape our lives, died. He was 79.

The J. Craig Venter Institute, a genomics research group with locations in La Jolla, California, and Rockville, Maryland

Q3. P. L. Alexander, who recently passed away, served as the Director General of Police (DGP) of which state?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (c) — Kerala

Explanation: Former Kerala Director General of Police (DGP) P.J. Alexander passed away, He was 92

Dr. Alexander became Inspector General (IG) in 1983 and later held important positions such as Crime IG and Director of the Institute of Management in Government (IMG).

Q4. (b) C. Khanduri, who recently passed away, was a former Chief Minister of:

- (a) Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Uttarakhand
- (c) Haryana
- (d) Punjab

Answer: (b) — C. Khanduri, who recently passed away, was a former Chief Minister of:

Explanation: Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister and senior BJP leader B C Khanduri passed away

Born in Dehradun in 1934,

A former army officer, Khanduri served as Uttarakhand chief minister twice — from 2007 to 2009 and again from 2011 to 2012. He was also a prominent BJP leader and represented the Garhwal constituency in the 16th Lok Sabha.

Mr. Khanduri, popularly known as "General Sahab",

Q5. S "Soma" Somasegar, who recently passed away, was associated with which technology company?

- (a) Apple
- (b) Google
- (c) Microsoft
- (d) IBM

Answer: (c) — Microsoft

Explanation: Indian-origin tech veteran "Soma" Somasegar, a former Microsoft executive and managing director at Madrona Venture Group, has died at the age of 59

In 2008, he received the Asian American Engineer of the Year Award.

National

Q1. The apnoea test is primarily used to determine:

- (a) Cardiac arrest
- (b) Lung infection
- (c) Kidney failure
- (d) Brain death

Answer: (d) — Brain death

Explanation: The Supreme Court of India has agreed to examine a medical plea alleging that the apnoea test, used as a primary assessment for brain death in Kerala, may be medically inconclusive and potentially dangerous.

The apnoea test is a mandatory clinical procedure used to determine if a patient is brain-dead (death by neurologic criteria).

It specifically checks if the brainstem—the part of the brain that controls automatic functions like breathing—is still functioning.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding the Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act: The MTP (Amendment) Act, 2021 increased the upper gestation limit for certain categories of women from 20 to 24 weeks. The MTP Act was first enacted in 1971. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: The Supreme Court of India observed that the Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act needs further amendment to address the rising cases of unwanted pregnancies, especially among minors.

The MTP Act is a crucial social and healthcare legislation in India that provides a legal framework for the termination of certain pregnancies by registered medical practitioners.

Origin:

The Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act was first enacted in 1971 based on the recommendations of the Shantilal Shah Committee.

Upper Gestation Limit:

Increased from 20 to 24 weeks for special categories of women, including survivors of rape, victims of incest, minors, and differently-abled women.

The limit remains 20 weeks for general cases.

Medical Opinion Requirements:

Up to 20 weeks: Opinion of one registered medical practitioner

20 to 24 weeks: Opinion of two registered medical practitioners

Q3. The authority of the Election Commission of India (ECI) to enforce the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) is derived from which Article of the Constitution of India?

- (a) Article 32
- (b) Article 226
- (c) Article 324
- (d) Article 356

Answer: (c) — Article 324

Explanation: Questions have been raised regarding whether Prime Minister on public media violated the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) by using state resources for partisan messaging.

The Model Code of Conduct is a set of guidelines issued by the Election Commission of India (ECI) to regulate the conduct of political parties and candidates during elections. It is not a statutory law (passed by Parliament) but a consensus-based document that derives its authority from the EC's constitutional powers under Article 324.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the Supreme Court: Parliament has the authority to increase the sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court. Increasing the number of Supreme Court judges requires a Constitutional Amendment. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Union Cabinet approved an increase in the number of judges of the Supreme Court from 34, which includes the Chief Justice of India, to a total 38.

Legislative Amendment: Since the limit is set by the 1956 Act, any increase requires an Amendment Bill to be passed by both Houses of Parliament (Simple Majority) and receive Presidential Assent.

The Proposal: Usually, the Chief Justice of India (CJI) writes to the government citing the backlog of cases and the need for more benches.

Q5. Under Section 3 of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, intentionally preventing the singing of the National Anthem may lead to imprisonment for up to:

- (a) One year
- (b) Two years
- (c) Three years
- (d) Five years

Answer: (c) — Three years

Explanation: The Union Cabinet gave the go-ahead to amend The Prevention of Insults To National Honour Act, 1971 to make any insult or obstruction to the singing of National Song Vande Mataram a punishable offence.

At present, insults to the National Anthem Jana Gana Mana, the National Flag and the Constitution of India is mentioned

in the 1971 Act and is punishable by an imprisonment of up to three years or a fine or both.

Q6. Consider the following statements regarding Kasturi Cotton Bharat: It is a certification and branding initiative for lint cotton bales. It focuses only on domestic cotton markets. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Centre approved Rs 5,659.22 crore for the Mission for Cotton Productivity for five years (2026–27 to 2030–31). The scheme was announced in the Union Budget 2025-26.

Kasturi Cotton Bharat

Kasturi Cotton Bharat focuses on three pillars: Traceability, Certification, and Branding to enhance the value of Indian cotton.

The objective is to enhance the global perception and value of Indian cotton by positioning 'Kasturi Cotton Bharat' as a high-quality, competitively priced product in both domestic and international markets.

Kasturi Cotton Bharat is a certification and branding initiative for lint cotton bales after processing.

Q7. What is meant by "duty-free import" in the context of international trade?

- (a) Import of goods without compliance with customs procedures
- (b) Temporary relaxation from quantitative import restrictions
- (c) Exemption from payment of customs duty for a specified period
- (d) Import of goods exclusively through government-approved agencies

Answer: (c) — Exemption from payment of customs duty for a specified period

Explanation: The Union Government has extended the duty-free import of yellow peas and black gram until March 2027. Yellow peas are a pulse commodity used in food processing, while black gram, also called urad, is a major pulse crop in India.

Duty-free import means exemption from customs duty for a notified period.

Q8. Consider the following statements regarding the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS): The government will provide 100% guarantee coverage to MSMEs under the scheme. Non-MSMEs and airlines will receive 20% credit guarantee coverage. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Union Cabinet approved the fifth edition of its Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, under which it will provide additional credit guarantees to micro,

small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and non-MSMEs, including airline companies.

Under the scheme, the government will provide 100% coverage to MSMEs and 90% to non-MSMEs and airlines for loans they take for additional credit up to 20% of the peak working capital utilised during the fourth quarter of 2025-26 (capped at Rs.100 crore).

For airlines, the loans can be for up to 100% of their peak working capital, but this is capped at ₹1,500 crore per borrower, subject to satisfying certain specific conditions.

Q9. What is the new Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) for sugarcane for the sugar season 2026–27, approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)?

- (a) ₹350 per quintal
- (b) ₹355 per quintal
- (c) ₹365 per quintal
- (d) ₹375 per quintal

Answer: (c) — ₹365 per quintal

Explanation: The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs, increased the Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) of sugarcane for the sugar season 2026-27 (October-September) by ₹10 for a quintal from the last crop year. The new price will be ₹365 per quintal for a basic sugar recovery rate of 10.25%.

The FRP is higher by 100.5% over production cost, the government claimed.

Q10. Consider the following statements regarding Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK): It covers children from birth up to 18 years of age. The programme includes free treatment including surgeries at tertiary level. It excludes newborn screening at delivery points. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Recently, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare released the Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) 2.0 Guidelines.

It was launched in February, 2013 under the National Rural Health Mission.

This program involves screening of children from birth to 18 years of age for four Ds- Defects at birth, Diseases, Deficiencies and Development delays.

Under this programme, its screening spans 32 common health conditions for early detection and free treatment and management, including surgeries at tertiary level.

Comprehensive newborn screening – at delivery points to screen birth defects of the newborn

Q11. Consider the following statements regarding the Incentive Scheme for Promotion of Critical Mineral Recycling: The scheme provides a 20% capital subsidy on plant and machinery for eligible projects. Operational support under the scheme will be provided in tranches, with 40% in the second year and 60% in the fifth year. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only

- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: About Incentive Scheme for Promotion of Critical Mineral Recycling

It is part of the National Critical Mineral Mission (NCMM), which is aimed at building the domestic capacity of and supply chain resilience in critical minerals.

Time Period: The Scheme will have a tenure of six years from Financial Year 2025-26 to Financial Year 2030-31

The incentives include a 20% capital subsidy on plant and machinery for projects that commence production within the stipulated timeframe and an operational subsidy tied to incremental sales.

The operational support will be provided in tranches 40% in the second year and 60% in the fifth year on meeting specific sales thresholds.

Q12. Consider the following statements regarding the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act (FEOA): The offence involved should be ₹100 crore or more. Punishment under the Act ranges from 3–7 years imprisonment and may extend up to 10 years in serious cases. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Who is a Fugitive Economic Offender (FEO)?

Person:

Against whom arrest warrant issued

Involves ₹100 crore+ offence

Left India or refuses to return to avoid prosecution

Punishment under PMLA, 2002

3–7 years imprisonment

Up to 10 years (serious cases)

Q13. 'Padma Doree' is best described as:

- (a) Agricultural scheme
- (b) Textile fusion initiative
- (c) Digital platform
- (d) Financial inclusion program

Answer: (b) — Textile fusion initiative

Explanation: The North Eastern Handicrafts and Handlooms Development Corporation (NEHDC) officially launched

'Padma Doree', a cross-regional initiative merging Northeast India's Eri silk with Madhya Pradesh's Chanderi traditions.

It represents a blend of fiber and finesse, combining the warmth and durability of Eri silk with the delicate motifs and sheer texture of Chanderi.

Uses Eri Silk, known as Ahimsa silk because it is processed without killing the silkworm, blended with the traditional cotton and silk zari work of Chanderi.

Q14. Under the Citizenship (Amendment) Rules, 2026, a minor child holding an Indian passport:

- (a) Can hold dual passports until the age of 18
- (b) Cannot simultaneously hold the passport of another country

- (c) Must apply for OCI status immediately
- (d) Can hold multiple foreign passports with permission

Answer: (b) — Cannot simultaneously hold the passport of another country

Explanation: The Union Home Ministry notified the Citizenship (Amendment) Rules, 2026 on May 1, 2026, to modernize the Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) framework.

Key Features:

Ban on Dual Passports for Minors: A new proviso to Rule 3 mandates that a minor child cannot hold the passport of any other country at any time while holding an Indian passport.

Introduction of e-OCI: Applicants can now be issued an electronic OCI registration (Form XXIX) alongside or instead of physical cards.

Q15. Which organisation launched the Central Prabhar Officer (CPO) Portal?

- (a) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) NITI Aayog
- (c) Ministry of Rural Development
- (d) Digital India Corporation

Answer: (b) — NITI Aayog

Explanation: NITI Aayog launched the Central Prabhar Officer (CPO) Portal, which is aimed at strengthening real-time governance, improving coordination among stakeholders and accelerating last-mile delivery under the Aspirational Districts and Blocks Programme (ADP/ABP).

The portal was formally launched by Ms. Nidhi Chhibber, CEO, NITI Aayog.

Q16. NLEAP initiative stands for:

- (a) National List of Essential Assistive Products
- (b) National Livelihood and Employment Assistance Programme
- (c) National Legal Empowerment Action Plan
- (d) National Learning Enhancement and Accessibility Programme

Answer: (a) — National List of Essential Assistive Products

Explanation: The Bureau of Indian Standards BIS has published several standards for medical assistive technologies as a part of the National List of Essential Assistive Products NLEAP initiative brought about by Indian Council of Medical Research.

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) has published six new standards for assistive products, ranging from elbow crutches to portable wheelchair ramps, as the country moves to align its disability-aid industry with international benchmarks.

Q17. Which of the following is a key property of Dimethyl Ether?

- (a) Low cetane number
- (b) High particulate emissions
- (c) High sulfur content
- (d) High cetane number

Answer: (d) — High cetane number

Explanation: Properties of Dimethyl Ether

High Cetane Number: It has a very high cetane number, which is a measure of the fuel's ignitability in compression ignition engines.

Under normal atmospheric conditions, DME is a colorless gas.

It burns cleaner, emitting minimal amounts of soot, nitrogen oxides (NOx), sulfur oxides (SOx), and particulate matter.

Q18. The term "JANANI" stands for:

- (a) Joint Action for Neonatal and Nutritional Integration
- (b) Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care
- (c) Justice and Nutrition Network for Integrated Care
- (d) Jan Arogya Network for Newborn and Infant Care

Answer: (b) — Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care

Explanation: The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has launched JANANI (Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care) as a significant step towards strengthening maternal and child healthcare services in the country.

JANANI is a digital platform designed to comprehensively monitor and maintain digital health records of women during their reproductive age.

Q19. The "Run for Sun" Marathon was organised by which ministry?

- (a) Ministry of Power
- (b) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (c) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)
- (d) Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: (c) — Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)

Explanation: The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) organised the 'Run for Sun' Marathon, on the occasion of International Sun Day, as a tribute to the 'Saur Shakti' lighting the world.

The event celebrated over 1,50,000 MW of solar energy installed capacity and the transformative progress under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PM-SGBMY), under which 30 lakh solar rooftop installations have been completed, with the highest single-month number -- 2.7 lakh of them -- completed in April 2026.

Q20. Consider the following statements regarding the Koh-i-Noor diamond: Maharaja Ranjit Singh brought the diamond to Punjab in 1813. The British East India Company acquired the diamond through the Treaty of Lahore. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Koh-i-Noor is called the 'blood diamond' because at almost every step of its journey, the repatriation of the diamond happened through war, invasion, and surreptitious treaties.

Discovery: The diamond is believed to have been found in the Kollur mines in Golconda (modern-day India).

1813: The Koh-i-Noor diamond came to Punjab to Maharaja Ranjit Singh, after the Afghan ruler Shah Shuja was forced to surrender it.

1849: The British East India Company, following the annexation of Punjab, acquired the diamond by getting the 10-year-old king to sign the Treaty of Lahore.

Q21. Consider the following statements regarding the “Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin)” (VB-G RAM G): Under the scheme, the Centre will bear 100% of the wage bill for all states. It aims to replace the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). It aims to provide a statutory guarantee of 150 days of wage employment. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: The Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin): VB—G RAM G Act 2025, which aims to repeal the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) 2005 and provides for a new rural job guarantee programme, will become effective on July 1, 2026.

The Union Ministry of Rural Development issued a notification to this effect.

The more than two-decade-old MGNREGA, enacted by the UPA government, will thus cease to exist from July 1.

VB G RAM G aims to provide a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment in every financial year to every rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work, with the “objective to promote empowerment, growth, convergence and saturation for a prosperous and resilient rural Bharat”.

Q22. The Bharatiya Bhasha Summer Camp 2026 will be organised by the:

- (a) Ministry of Culture
- (b) Ministry of Education
- (c) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (d) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Answer: (b) — Ministry of Education

Explanation: The Ministry of Education will organise Bharatiya Bhasha Summer Camp 2026 in all schools across the country during summer vacation.

The week-long camp will provide students an engaging opportunity to learn basic communication skills in various Indian languages through interactive activities focused on self-introduction, vocabulary building, real-life conversations and cultural appreciation.

Q23. Consider the following statements regarding the Prime Minister’s Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP): It is administered by the Ministry of MSME. It is limited only to the manufacturing sector. Any individual above 18 years of age is eligible. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: About Prime Minister’s Employment Generation Programme

It is a central sector scheme launched in August 2008.

It is a credit-linked subsidy scheme administered by the Ministry of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME).

It aims to create self-employment opportunities for first-generation entrepreneurs and promote sustainable livelihoods in the manufacturing and services sectors, especially in rural areas. Any individual above 18 years of age is eligible.

Q24. ISO TC 20 / SC 14 is associated with:

- (a) Artificial Intelligence Standards
- (b) Space Systems and Operations
- (c) Nuclear Safety Standards
- (d) Maritime Security Standards

Answer: (b) — Space Systems and Operations

Explanation: Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), the National Standards Body of India, organised the 35th Plenary and Working Groups meetings of the ISO TC 20 / SC 14 ‘Space Systems and Operations’ subcommittee of International Organisation for Standardisation (ISO) at New Delhi.

Q25. Consider the following statements regarding Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY): PMGSY was launched in December 2000 as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme. The scheme is implemented by the Ministry of Rural Development. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: The silver jubilee celebrations marking 25 years of the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) and the national launch of PMGSY-IV held in Bhairunda of Madhya Pradesh’s Sehore district.

About PMGSY

Ministry: Ministry of Rural Development

Type: Launched in December 2000 as Centrally sponsored scheme

Q26. The “Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar” (SSSS) campaign was launched in:

- (a) 2020
- (b) 2021
- (c) 2022
- (d) 2023

Answer: (c) — 2022

Explanation: The “Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar” campaign was launched in 2022 as a 75-day inter-ministerial initiative aimed at cleaning and reducing marine litter across coastal areas of the country.

The campaign has since been conducted annually during the week of International Coastal Cleanup Day

Q27. The “Su Sahay” chatbot recently seen in news is:

- (a) A satellite-based navigation platform
- (b) An AI-powered assistance chatbot integrated with the Supreme Court website

- (c) A digital agriculture monitoring system
- (d) A national cyber fraud reporting application

Answer: (b) — An AI-powered assistance chatbot integrated with the Supreme Court website

Explanation: CJI Surya Kant announces 'One Case One Data' initiative, launches AI chatbot 'Su Sahay'

The "One Case One Data" initiative, will integrate multi-level information from all the high courts, district courts, and taluka courts into a unified system.

The CJI also announced the launch of "Su Sahay", an Artificial Intelligence-powered assistance chatbot integrated with the Supreme Court website to facilitate easier access to justice and court-related services for litigants.

Q28. Which of the following are part of the Jan Suraksha Schemes? Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY) Atal Pension Yojana (APY) Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: The three flagship Jan Suraksha Schemes— Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY), Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY), and Atal Pension Yojana (APY)—completed 11 years of providing affordable social security.

The Jan Suraksha Schemes were launched by Prime Minister of India on May 9, 2015, to create a universal social security system for all Indians.

Aimed primarily at the unorganized sector and vulnerable populations, these schemes provide low-cost life insurance, accidental insurance, and old-age pension support through a seamless, digitized framework.

Q29. Consider the following statements regarding Section 18 of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989: It excludes the application of anticipatory bail in cases where the Act is attracted. It is related to preventive detention provisions. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Supreme Court in May 2026 held that the statutory bar under Section 18 of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, cannot be applied mechanically to deny anticipatory bail.

The Court stated that judges must examine the FIR, the supporting material, and the nature of allegations before deciding whether a prima facie offence under the Act exists. Section 18 of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, excludes the application of Section 438 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973, in cases where the Act is attracted.

Anticipatory bail is a pre-arrest legal remedy under Section 438 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973.

Q30. SEHAT Mission primarily seeks to strengthen the linkage between :

- (a) industrial growth and foreign trade
- (b) agricultural transformation and public health outcomes
- (c) defence production and food security
- (d) climate finance and renewable energy

Answer: (b) — agricultural transformation and public health outcomes

Explanation: Recently, the Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare and Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare launched the 'SEHAT Mission' in Delhi. SEHAT (Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation) is a national mission-mode programme designed to translate agricultural advancements into tangible health outcomes for the people of India.

Q31. The IP Catalyst initiative was recently launched by:

- (a) NITI Aayog
- (b) Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- (c) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
- (d) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade

Answer: (c) — Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Explanation: Recently, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India launched IP Catalyst initiative along with its digital platform. It is being implemented by Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) Pune, supported by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. It is designed to create a comprehensive digital ecosystem that supports the full innovation lifecycle — from research and patent creation to commercialization, licensing and market deployment.

Q32. Which of the following risks are covered under the Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP)? Hull and machinery risks Cargo risks Protection and Indemnity (P&I) risks War risks Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (d) — 1, 2, 3 and 4

Explanation: The Department of Financial Services (DFS) formally inaugurated India's domestic insurance pool, that is, the Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP) which holds a sovereign guarantee of ₹12,980 crore that seeks to accord a continuous stream of maritime insurance coverages. The pool would cover all risks associated with maritime operations as hull and machinery, cargo, protection and indemnity (P&I) and war risk for Indian-flagged vessels, those owned by India and having either their destination or origin in India.

The Union Cabinet had accorded their approval for setting up of the Maritime Insurance Pool April 18 this year.

Q33. PATSAN, associated with the Jute Crop Information System (JCIS), is a:

- (a) Mobile-based agricultural monitoring and forecasting platform
- (b) Satellite-enabled geospatial launch and tracking platform
- (c) Digital portal for promotion and export of jute products
- (d) Web-based analytics and production assessment platform

Answer: (d) — Web-based analytics and production assessment platform

Explanation: The National Jute Board has expanded the implementation of the Jute Crop Information System (JCIS), a technology-driven platform developed with ISRO to modernize crop monitoring.

The National Jute Board is the apex body under the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India, responsible for the overall development of the jute sector.

Established In: The board is governed by the National Jute Board Act, 2008, and was formally enacted on February 12, 2009.

Digital Tools:

BHUVAN JUMP: A mobile application used by the I-CARE field network for large-scale collection of geo-tagged field data.

PATSAN: A web-based analytics platform that provides surveillance and production assessments for stakeholders and government officials.

Q34. Consider the following statements regarding the Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects: The scheme provides a maximum financial incentive of 20% of the cost of Plant and Machinery. The scheme is limited only to indigenous technologies. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved a Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects with a financial outlay of Rs.37,500 crore.

The Scheme marks a major step towards accelerating India's coal/lignite gasification programme, advancing the national target of gasifying 100 Million Tonnes (MT) of coal by 2030. The Government has also extended coal linkage tenure up to 30 years under the "Production of Syngas leading to Coal Gasification" sub-sector in the Non-Regulated Sector (NRS) linkage auction framework.

Financial incentive provided at a maximum of 20% of the cost of Plant and Machinery. Incentive under this Scheme is in addition to, and does not restrict access to, incentives under the commercial coal mining regime or schemes of other Central/State Government ministries.

Q35. Consider the following crops in the context of the Minimum Support Price (MSP) for Kharif Marketing Season 2026–27: Moong Bajra Maize Tur/Arhar The expected margin

to farmers over their cost of production was estimated to be more than 50% for which of the above crops?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Answer: (c) — 1, 2, 3 and 4

Explanation: The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved the increase in the Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for 14 Kharif Crops for Marketing Season 2026-27. Government has increased the MSP of Kharif Crops for Marketing Season 2026-27, to ensure remunerative prices to the growers for their produce.

The expected margin to farmers over their cost of production are estimated to be highest in case of Moong (61%) followed by Bajra (56%), Maize (56%) and Tur/Arhar (54%).

Q36. The K. Radhakrishnan Committee was constituted to recommend reforms related to:

- (a) Civil services examination
- (b) Judicial appointments
- (c) NEET examination system
- (d) Electoral reforms

Answer: (c) — NEET examination system

Explanation: About K. Radhakrishnan Committee

Recommendations:

Transition to CBT: Shift the exam from Pen-and-Paper to a Computer-Based Test (CBT) format to eliminate physical booklet leaks.

Implement Computer-assisted Secure PPT where encrypted papers are sent digitally and printed locally just before the exam.

Significantly increase the number of state-of-the-art computer labs and testing centers across India.

Consider conducting NEET in multiple sessions or stages to reduce the pressure and risk associated with a single-day event.

Conduct regular third-party audits of the testing software, storage protocols, and personnel involved in the examination chain.

Q37. The newly launched Country Strategic Opportunities Programme (COSOP) between India and IFAD covers which of the following periods?

- (a) 2024–2030
- (b) 2025–2032
- (c) 2026–2033
- (d) 2027–2035

Answer: (c) — 2026–2033

Explanation: The Government of India and the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) launched a new eight-year Country Strategic Opportunities Programme (COSOP) for the period 2026–2033.

COSOP is a strategic investment and development framework that defines the long-term partnership between a host country and IFAD.

Organizations Involved: International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD).

Q38. Who is the Chairperson of the Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee?

- (a) Justice Surya Kant
- (b) Justice Aravind Kumar
- (c) Justice B.R. Gavai
- (d) Justice Sanjiv Khanna

Answer: (b) — Justice Aravind Kumar

Explanation: Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has constituted a high-powered 'Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee' headed by Supreme Court Justice Aravind Kumar.

The Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee is a high-level expert panel formed to overhaul the physical and digital landscape of the Indian judiciary.

Q39. The headquarters of the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) is located in:

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Chennai
- (c) Kolkata
- (d) New Delhi

Answer: (d) — New Delhi

Explanation: Recently, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) prohibited export of raw, white and refined sugar with immediate effect till September 30 amid the ongoing West Asia conflict.

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) is an attached office of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. Headquarter: It is located in New Delhi.

Q40. Parliamentary privileges of Members of Parliament are primarily provided under:

- (a) Article 32
- (b) Article 105
- (c) Article 123
- (d) Article 368

Answer: (b) — Article 105

Explanation: Congress Chief Whip in the Rajya Sabha moved a formal privilege notice against Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

A Privilege Notice is a specific institutional mechanism available to Members of Parliament (MPs) to raise a question of privilege when they believe an individual, minister, or organization has breached the defined rights, immunities, and privileges of the House, its committees, or its members.

Grounded firmly in Article 105 (for Parliament and its members) and Article 194 (for State Legislatures) of the Constitution of India.

Q41. India has been nominated as the Chair of the Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB) for a term spanning:

- (a) April 2025 to April 2027
- (b) April 2026 to April 2028
- (c) January 2026 to January 2028
- (d) April 2027 to April 2029

Answer: (b) — April 2026 to April 2028

Explanation: India has been nominated as the Chair of the Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB) for a two-year term from April 2026 to April 2028.

The CCDB is the technical heart of the Common Criteria Recognition Arrangement (CCRA).

While other committees handle high-level policy, the CCDB is responsible for the technical management and evolution of the standards used to evaluate the security of Information Technology (IT) products worldwide.

Q42. Who has been appointed as the Chairperson of the Parliamentary Committee on Empowerment of Women for 2026–27?

- (a) Daggubati Purandeswari
- (b) Meenakshi Lekhi
- (c) Smriti Irani
- (d) Kanimozhi Karunanidhi

Answer: (a) — Daggubati Purandeswari

Explanation: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla officially reconstituted the Parliamentary Committee on Empowerment of Women for the year 2026–27.

Senior Lok Sabha MP Daggubati Purandeswari has been appointed as the Chairperson of the panel.

The Committee on Empowerment of Women is a prestigious Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) in the Indian Parliament.

Q43. Project Saksham is an initiative launched by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) in partnership with:

- (a) Tata Trusts
- (b) Vertis Foundation
- (c) NASSCOM Foundation
- (d) SEWA Foundation

Answer: (b) — Vertis Foundation

Explanation: National Highway Authority of India (NHAI) in partnership with the Vertis Foundation is empowering rural women through structured skill development for sustainable livelihood opportunities through Project Saksham.

Project Saksham operates through a network of 12 training centres across the country, providing access to underserved communities to industry-relevant skills and pathways into the formal workforce.

Q44. Under the new CBSE policy for Class 9 students, at least how many of the three languages must be native Indian languages?

- (a) One
- (b) Two
- (c) Three
- (d) None

Answer: (b) — Two

Explanation: For Class 9 CBSE students, what is set to change immediately is that starting July 1, they will have to study three languages, with at least two of them being "native Indian languages".

In its May 15 circular, the CBSE said that students wishing to study a foreign language may do so only if the other two languages are native Indian languages, or as an additional fourth language.

The new NCERT syllabus includes the study of three languages – R1, R2 and R3 – at the secondary stage. The third language will not be part of the Class 10 Board examination.

Q45. Consider the following statements regarding Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Gramin (PMAY-G): It aims to provide pucca houses to homeless rural families. It also targets families living in kutcha or dilapidated houses. PMAY-G was launched in 2016. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: Shivraj Singh Chouhan is scheduled to attend the “Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Gramin (PMAY-G) Beneficiary Conference & Maha Awas Abhiyan State-Level Award Distribution Ceremony” in May 2026 in Satara, Maharashtra.

The scheme aims to provide pucca houses to homeless rural families and those living in kutcha or dilapidated houses, ensuring housing for all.

Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Gramin: It was launched in 2015 as Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Urban and in 2016 as Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Gramin.

Q46. The SHE-MART initiative was launched by which ministry?

- (a) Ministry of Women and Child Development
- (b) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- (c) Ministry of Rural Development
- (d) Ministry of MSME

Answer: (c) — Ministry of Rural Development

Explanation: The Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD) convened a high-level national consultation in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, to finalize the operational guidelines for the newly launched SHE-MART initiative.

SHE-MART (Self Help Entrepreneurs – Marketing Avenues for Rural Transformation) is a revolutionary socio-economic initiative designed to build women-led rural marketing and supply chain aggregation

Q47. The Judges Inquiry Committee operates in tandem with which Article of the Constitution for Supreme Court judges?

- (a) Article 32
- (b) Article 124(4)
- (c) Article 136
- (d) Article 356

Answer: (b) — Article 124(4)

Explanation: The three-member Judges Inquiry Committee submitted its formal investigation report to Lok Sabha Speaker concerning misbehavior allegations against sitting judge Justice Yashwant Varma.

The Judges Inquiry Committee is a high-level, ad-hoc statutory judicial tribunal constituted to investigate specific allegations of proved misbehavior or incapacity against a judge of the Supreme Court or a High Court.

Operates in tandem with Article 124(4) (for Supreme Court judges) and Article 217(1)(b) (for High Court judges) of the Constitution of India.

Q48. The Ayush Anudan Portal is mainly designed to:

- (a) Promote online AYUSH consultations
- (b) Manage grant proposals under Central Sector Schemes

- (c) Conduct digital health surveys
- (d) Provide telemedicine services

Answer: (b) — Manage grant proposals under Central Sector Schemes

Explanation: Recently, the Union Minister of State (IC) for Ayush and Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare launched the Ayush Anudan Portal.

It is developed by the Ministry of Ayush under the Ayush Grid initiative.

It is a digital platform to streamline the submission, processing, and monitoring of funding proposals under Central Sector Schemes of the Ministry of Ayush.

Eminent Personality

Q1. Consider the following statements about the Battle of Haldighati: It was fought in 1576. The Mughal forces were led by Man Singh I of Amber. The battle resulted in a decisive victory for Maharana Pratap. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Born: May 9, 1540, in Kumbhalgarh Fort, Mewar (present-day Rajasthan).

Parents: Father – Maharana Udai Singh II; Mother – Rani Jaiwanta Bai.

Famous Battle: Battle of Haldighati (1576) – Between Maharana Pratap of Mewar and Mughal forces led by Man Singh I of Amber, under Emperor Akbar.

Tactically inconclusive, but Mughals captured much of Mewar.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding the Revolt of 1857: The revolt officially began in Meerut. It broke out on 10th May 1857. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: 10th May The Revolt of 1857

India marked the 169th anniversary of the Revolt of 1857, which officially broke out in Meerut on this day in 1857.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding R. K. Narayan: His first mythological work was Gods, Demons and Others. He received both the Padma Bhushan and Padma Vibhushan awards. He won the Nobel Prize in Literature. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: R. K. Narayan, one of India's most celebrated English-language authors, passed away on May 13, 2001,

Born in 1906, Narayan was an Indian writer known for his works set in the fictional South Indian town of Malgudi. His first mythological work was published in 1964, 'Gods, Demons and Others', a short story collection from Hindu epics.

Awards and honours : He won several awards and honours for his significant contribution to the literary world such as Sahitya Akademi Award, Padma Bhushan, Padma Vibhushan, AC Benson Medal, and multiple nominations for the Noble Prize in Literature.

He was also nominated for the upper house of the Indian Parliament for a six-year term starting in 1989 for his outstanding contribution to Indian English literature.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed: He served as the 8th President of India from 1974 to 1977. He proclaimed the National Emergency in 1975 on the advice of the Prime Minister. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: President paid tributes to former President, Shri Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed on his birth anniversary. He was a distinguished lawyer, politician, and the 5th President of India (From 1974 till his death in 1977). As President: Notable for his decision to proclaim Emergency by the advice of the then Prime Minister in 1975.

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding the Komagata Maru incident: The Komagata Maru incident took place in 1914. The passengers aboard the ship were attempting to migrate to England. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Komagata Maru incident was a 1914 maritime standoff involving a Japanese steamship chartered by Punjabi entrepreneur Gurdit Singh. The vessel carried 376 passengers—340 Sikhs, 24 Muslims, and 12 Hindus—who were British subjects attempting to emigrate to Canada to build new lives.

Q6. Neelam Sanjiva Reddy served as President of India from:

- (a) 1969–1974
- (b) 1977–1982
- (c) 1982–1987
- (d) 1972–1977

Answer: (b) — 1977–1982

Explanation: Neelam Sanjiva Reddy served as the sixth President of India from July 25, 1977, to July 25, 1982. Born on May 19, 1913, in Illur, Andhra Pradesh.

Q7. Veer Gundadhar is associated with which tribal uprising against British rule?

- (a) Santhal Rebellion
- (b) Kol Rebellion
- (c) Bhil Movement
- (d) Bhumkal Rebellion

Answer: (d) — Bhumkal Rebellion

Explanation: Union Home Minister inaugurated the Shaheed Veer Gundadhar Seva Dera Jan Suvidha Kendra in Bastar, Chhattisgarh.

Veer Shaheed Gundadhar was a legendary tribal revolutionary leader from the Bastar region who led the historic Bhumkal Rebellion of 1910 against the oppressive British colonial empire.

Q8. Piru Singh Shekhawat, recently seen in news, was posthumously awarded the:

- (a) Ashoka Chakra
- (b) Maha Vir Chakra
- (c) Param Vir Chakra
- (d) Kirti Chakra

Answer: (c) — Param Vir Chakra

Explanation: Piru Singh Shekhawat was born on May 20, 1918, in Bagadu village, Jhunjhunu district, Rajasthan.

After Indian independence, when the 1947-48 war between India and Pakistan broke out in Jammu and Kashmir, Piru Singh Shekhawat was serving in the 6th Rajputana Rifles Battalion of the Indian Army.

Piru Singh Shekhawat was posthumously awarded the Param Vir Chakra

State

Ladakh

Q1. The high-altitude Mahey Tokpo-Raldho irrigation canal was inaugurated in:

- (a) Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Uttarakhand
- (c) Ladakh
- (d) Sikkim

Answer: (c) — Ladakh

Explanation: Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena inaugurated the high-altitude irrigation canal in Changthang region, constructed at an altitude of over 14,000 feet,

The Mahey irrigation canal, along with the mass plantation drive, will immensely benefit the people of Changthang

Jammu & Kashmir

Q1. The Panzath Nag festival is primarily associated with:

- (a) Snow harvesting
- (b) Silk production
- (c) Apple cultivation
- (d) Ecological conservation

Answer: (d) — Ecological conservation

Explanation: The centuries-old community-led spring cleaning and fish-catching festival at Panzath Nag in Jammu and Kashmir's Anantnag district was recently observed with participation from thousands of villagers.

The Panzath Nag festival is a traditional community-driven ecological conservation practice in which villagers collectively clean a natural spring and surrounding water channels while participating in controlled traditional fish-catching activities.

Q2. The Mougari Mela generally falls during:

- (a) January–February
- (b) March–April
- (c) May–June
- (d) September–October

Answer: (c) — May–June

Explanation: Mougari Mela is one of the famous Melas of Udhampur District which is organised with great religious fervour and gaiety every year on the eve of first Jyeshth and lasts till the 3rd Jyeshth, which generally falls in May-June, The historic 3-day annual Mougari Mela also known as Shiv-Parvati Mela

Delhi

Q1. India's first portable bedside MRI system has been introduced by:

- (a) PGIMER Chandigarh
- (b) AIIMS New Delhi
- (c) NIMHANS Bengaluru
- (d) Tata Memorial Hospital

Answer: (b) — AIIMS New Delhi

Explanation: In a first, AIIMS New Delhi has introduced India's first portable bedside MRI system.

The ultra-low-field device can be wheeled directly to a patient's bedside, enabling rapid brain imaging for critically ill patients in ICUs, emergency settings, and neurosurgical care.

Q2. The Aftercare Scheme for Young Persons will be implemented under which Act?

- (a) Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012
- (b) Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986
- (c) Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015
- (d) Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009

Answer: (c) — Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015

Explanation: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the Aftercare Scheme for Young Persons to provide continued support to youth leaving institutional care after they turn 18 by assisting them with higher education, skill development, and employment opportunities.

The primary objective of the scheme is to provide continued support, guidance and opportunities to youth leaving institutional care so they can move towards independent, secure and dignified lives.

The scheme will be implemented under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding Project MATE: It is an adolescent well-being initiative developed by AIIMS New Delhi. The initiative targets students from Classes 6 to 8. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only

- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) in collaboration with the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) organised the Mind Activation Through Education MATE Counselors' Conclave in New Delhi.

The event marks the expansion of Project MATE, which is an adolescent well-being initiative developed by AIIMS New Delhi.

The Project MATE modules will be implemented from July this year for students of Classes 6 to 8.

Q4. India's first International Ophthalmology Research Conference was hosted in which city?

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Bengaluru
- (c) New Delhi
- (d) Hyderabad

Answer: (c) — New Delhi

Explanation: The Department of Ophthalmology at Army Hospital (Research & Referral), New Delhi, in collaboration with All-India Ophthalmological Society, is set to host India's first International Ophthalmology Research Conference at Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantonment on May 09 & 10, 2026.

This two-day academic event, named All-India Ophthalmological Society - Armed Forces Ophthalmology Update (AIOS-AFOU 2026), will be inaugurated by Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth.

Q5. The 'Metro Monday' initiative was launched in which city?

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Bengaluru
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Chennai

Answer: (c) — Delhi

Explanation: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the 'Metro Monday' initiative, joining ministers and government officials in using public transport as part of a campaign focused on sustainable mobility and fuel conservation.

Q6. India's first 'SkyCast' System was recently inaugurated at:

- (a) Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai
- (b) Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru
- (c) Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi
- (d) Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad

Answer: (c) — Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi

Explanation: Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated India's first 'SkyCast' System at Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGI), New Delhi.

SkyCast is a next-generation, integrated atmospheric remote sensing system designed for aviation weather monitoring. It brings together multiple real-time measurements of fog, aerosols, turbulence, moisture, and visibility into a single, comprehensive aviation weather intelligence framework.

Uttar Pradesh

Q1. The theme of Census-2027 is:

- (a) Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas
- (b) Digital Bharat, Strong Bharat
- (c) Jan Seva, Jan Bhagidari
- (d) Hamari Janaganana, Hamara Vikas

Answer: (d) — Hamari Janaganana, Hamara Vikas

Explanation: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched the first phase of Census-2027 under the theme "Hamari Janaganana, Hamara Vikas", formally beginning house listing and housing census operations at a programme. The exercise marks the beginning of India's first digital census, which the State government said would support data-driven planning and welfare delivery.

Q2. SATHI-BHU, recently seen in the news, has been established primarily to

- (a) promote commercial manufacturing of defence equipment
- (b) provide a national shared scientific infrastructure for advanced research and innovation
- (c) develop nuclear energy technologies for strategic purposes
- (d) offer financial assistance to agricultural start-ups

Answer: (b) — provide a national shared scientific infrastructure for advanced research and innovation

Explanation: Union Minister of State Jitendra Singh visited the Banaras Hindu University (BHU) and inspected the interdisciplinary facility "SATHI" set up with the support of Department of Science & Technology, Govt of India. SATHI-BHU has been established with the support of nearly Rs. 72 crores from the Department of Science & Technology.

Q3. The National Test House (NTH), recently seen in news, established an advanced Shoe Testing Laboratory in:

- (a) Kanpur
- (b) Agra
- (c) Ghaziabad
- (d) Chennai

Answer: (c) — Ghaziabad

Explanation: The National Test House (NTH) of Northern Region in Ghaziabad, under the Department of Consumer Affairs, has established a state-of-the-art Shoe Testing Laboratory. The laboratory will significantly enhance NTH's capability to provide comprehensive, reliable and high-precision footwear testing services for MSMEs, manufacturers, exporters, consumers and regulatory authorities across the country.

Q4. 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika', recently inaugurated in Lucknow, is a:

- (a) Naval training academy
- (b) Open-air naval museum
- (c) Naval dockyard
- (d) War memorial cemetery

Answer: (b) — Open-air naval museum

Explanation: Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh in Lucknow jointly with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi

Adityanath inaugurated the 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika', an open-air naval museum.

The museum as "a symbol of patriotism and military pride, showcasing the glorious tradition of the Indian Navy's valour, bravery and service to the nation".

Madhya Pradesh

Q1. The one-member inquiry commission into the Bargi Dam cruise accident is headed by:

- (a) Justice Ranjan Gogoi
- (b) Justice Sanjay Dwivedi
- (c) Justice A.K. Sikri
- (d) Justice U.U. Lalit

Answer: (b) — Justice Sanjay Dwivedi

Explanation: The Madhya Pradesh government has set up a one-member inquiry commission headed by retired High Court judge Sanjay Dwivedi to conduct a judicial investigation into the Bargi Dam cruise accident that took place on April 30 in Jabalpur.

The commission will submit its report to the government within three months.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding Bargi Dam: It is built on the Narmada River. It is located in Jharkhand. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Bargi Dam is one of the most significant multipurpose river valley projects in Central India.

It serves as a vital source of water for drinking, irrigation, and hydropower, while also functioning as a major eco-tourism hub in the Jabalpur district, Madhya Pradesh.

Q3. The unique Sarpabandha inscriptions are preserved at which historical site?

- (a) Konark Sun Temple
- (b) Bhojshala complex
- (c) Khajuraho Temples
- (d) Nalanda Mahavihara

Answer: (b) — Bhojshala complex

Explanation: The Indore Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court delivered a historic 242-page verdict declaring the disputed Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Mosque complex in Dhar district a Hindu temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati).

The Bhojshala complex is an 11th-century protected historical monument that originally served as a premier center for Sanskrit learning and a temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati).

Sarpabandha Inscriptions: The site uniquely preserves two Sarpabandha (serpentine chart) pillar inscriptions.

Q4. The Urtan and Dhirauli coal mines are located in:

- (a) Jharkhand
- (b) Odisha
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Chhattisgarh

Answer: (c) — Madhya Pradesh

Explanation: The Ministry of Coal announced the commencement of coal production from the Urtan and Dhirauli coal mines in Madhya Pradesh.

The Urtan and Dhirauli mines are freshly operationalized, high-capacity coal blocks allocated to private players under the government's liberalized commercial coal mining framework.

Odisha

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding Rupa

Tarakasi: The craft received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2024. It mainly involves stone carving techniques. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Cuttack's centuries-old Rupa Tarakasi, silver filigree industry is getting impacted by the soaring prices and fresh import curbs push on silver.

The famed handicraft work received a geographical indication (GI) tag in 2024

It is one of the most exquisite silver crafts.

In Odia, "tara" means wire and "kasi" means to design.

Origin: While the exact origin of the filigree art in Cuttack is not clear, it is known to have existed as far back as the 12th century.

Jharkhand

Q1. Hazaribag has been notified as India's first:

- (a) Marine fisheries cluster
- (b) Pearl farming cluster
- (c) Inland salt production hub
- (d) Aquaculture export zone

Answer: (b) — Pearl farming cluster

Explanation: Hazaribag in Jharkhand has been notified as India's first pearl farming cluster under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY).

The cluster has received an investment of ₹22 crore under a joint initiative of the Central government and the Jharkhand government.

Chhattisgarh

Q1. The Baiga tribe became the first community in India to receive:

- (a) Forest Reserve Status
- (b) Habitat Rights
- (c) Tribal Autonomy Status
- (d) Scheduled Area Status

Answer: (b) — Habitat Rights

Explanation: 13 children belonging to the Baiga tribe, a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group, were recently rescued from bonded labour in Chhattisgarh's Kabirdham district.

They are found in central India, primarily in the state of Madhya Pradesh, and in smaller numbers in the surrounding states of Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and Jharkhand.

The Baiga tribe primarily speaks Baigani, a dialect of Chhattisgarhi heavily influenced by Gondi and Hindi.

The Baiga tribe is the first community in India to be granted habitat rights, reflecting their deep connection with forests.

Odisha

Q1. KaWaCHaM, recently seen in the news, is primarily related to

- (a) cybersecurity management
- (b) disaster early warning dissemination
- (c) coastal shipping regulation
- (d) climate finance monitoring

Answer: (b) — disaster early warning dissemination

Explanation: Odisha is set to adopt a customised version of the Kerala Warnings, Crisis and Hazard Management system (KaWaCHaM), the State's technologically advanced Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS), to strengthen disaster preparedness along the cyclone-prone coastline of Odisha.

The name 'KaWaCHaM' means 'shield' in Malayalam, symbolising protection for communities against disasters.

Q2. The Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site is located in which state?

- (a) Odisha
- (b) Chhattisgarh
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) West Bengal

Answer: (a) — Odisha

Explanation: Union Minister Dharmendra

Pradhan inaugurated the Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site in Sambalpur district of Odisha to preserve the region's prehistoric heritage and promote eco-tourism.

The Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site is located in the Naktideul Forest Range of Sambalpur district in Odisha.

The site contains ancient rock paintings and stone inscriptions believed to be over 20,000 years old, indicating evidence of early human habitation from the Old Stone Age to the Neolithic period.

West Bengal

Q1. Who has been appointed as the Chief Minister of West Bengal?

- (a) Dilip Ghosh
- (b) Suwendu Adhikari
- (c) Nisith Pramanik
- (d) Agnimitra Paul

Answer: (b) — Suwendu Adhikari

Explanation: Bharatiya Janata Party leader Suwendu Adhikari was sworn in as the Chief Minister of West Bengal. West Bengal Governor R. N. Ravi administered the oath of office and secrecy.

Q2. Under the proposed Annapurna Bhandar scheme, eligible women are expected to receive: प्रस्तावित 'अन्नपूर्णा भंडार योजना' के तहत, पात्र महिलाओं को निम्नलिखित प्राप्त होने की उम्मीद है:

- (a) ₹1,500 per month
- (b) ₹1,700 per month
- (c) ₹2,500 per month
- (d) ₹3,000 per month

Answer: (d) — ₹3,000 per month

Explanation: West Bengal announced the proposed Annapurna Bhandar scheme on 11 May 2026 after the first cabinet meeting of the new BJP government. The scheme is linked to financial support for eligible women in the state and is scheduled for rollout from 1 June 2026. The Annapurna Bhandar scheme is a state welfare initiative for women in West Bengal. Eligible women are expected to receive Rs 3,000 per month through direct bank transfers.

Q3. Who took oath as the Pro-Tem Speaker of the West Bengal Assembly?

- (a) Dilip Ghosh
- (b) Tapas Roy
- (c) Biman Banerjee
- (d) Mukul Roy

Answer: (b) — Tapas Roy

Explanation: Senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader and MLA from Maniktala, Tapas Roy, took oath as the Pro-Tem speaker of the West Bengal Assembly. Governor R.N. Ravi administered the oath to Mr. Roy at the Lok Bhavan

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the Matua community: The Matua sect is monotheist in nature. The Matua movement originated in southern India. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Most of the Matuas, who migrated from neighbouring Bangladesh during different time-periods do not have sufficient documents to apply for citizenship under the CAA.

The Matua community, a marginalized Hindu sect with roots in the 19th century, holds a significant socio-religious presence in the Bengal region, particularly across Bangladesh and West Bengal.

Founded by Harichand Thakur in the 1860s, the Matua movement arose as a response to the deep-seated caste discrimination present within Hindu society at the time.

The Matua sect is monotheist.

Q5. Rathindra Bose was elected as the Speaker of which Legislative Assembly?

- (a) Assam Legislative Assembly
- (b) West Bengal Legislative Assembly
- (c) Odisha Legislative Assembly
- (d) Tripura Legislative Assembly

Answer: (b) — West Bengal Legislative Assembly

Explanation: Rathindra Bose, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA from the Cooch Behar Dakshin Assembly seat, was elected as the Speaker of West Bengal Legislative Assembly. Mr. Bose was elected the Speaker of the 18th West Bengal Legislative Assembly unanimously through a voice vote.

Sikkim

Q1. Which state has been declared India's first fully paperless State judiciary?

- (a) Goa
- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (b) — Sikkim

Explanation: Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant declared Sikkim as the country's first fully paperless State judiciary, marking a decisive shift in court administration and adjudicatory processes towards a digitised, technology-driven framework.

The development coincides with Sikkim's 50th Statehood anniversary, Sikkim celebrates its Statehood Day on May 16

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding Sikkim: The 36th Constitutional Amendment led to the formation of Sikkim as a state. Sikkim shares borders with Nepal, Bhutan and China. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Sikkim commemorates its statehood day annually on May 16 to acknowledge its integration with India and its emergence as the 22nd state in the country in 1975.

The state of Sikkim was formed by the 36th Amendment of the Constitution of India in 1975.

Borders: Tibet Autonomous Region of China to the north and northeast, Bhutan to the southeast, Indian state of West Bengal to the south and Nepal to the west.

Assam

Q1. Who recently took oath as the Chief Minister of Assam for a second consecutive term?

- (a) Sarbananda Sonowal
- (b) Himanta Biswa Sarma
- (c) Bhupen Kumar Borah
- (d) Dilip Saikia

Answer: (b) — Himanta Biswa Sarma

Explanation: Himanta Biswa Sarma was sworn in as the Chief Minister of Assam for the second consecutive term, Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath of office to Mr. Sarma.

He was sworn in as the CM for a second consecutive time on May 12, 2026, making him the first non-Congress leader to hold the post, twice in a row.

Q2. India's first riverine lighthouses are being constructed along which river?

- (a) Ganga
- (b) Brahmaputra
- (c) Godavari
- (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (b) — Brahmaputra

Explanation: Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal laid the foundation stones for India's first riverine lighthouses along the Brahmaputra River on National Waterway-2 in Assam.

Nagaland

Q1. Which state launched the '100 Days Ayushman Student Coverage Mission'?

- (a) Manipur
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (c) — Nagaland

Explanation: Nagaland Health Protection Society Launches '100 Days Ayushman Student Coverage Mission' to Expand Youth Health Coverage

Arunachal Pradesh

Q1. Etor Gidi is a traditional festival associated with which community?

- (a) Bodo
- (b) Adi
- (c) Khasi
- (d) Naga

Answer: (b) — Adi

Explanation: Etor Gidi is an agro-based traditional festival of the Adi community in Arunachal Pradesh.

It is celebrated at the beginning of the farming season (generally falls in Mid May) and is associated with agricultural rituals, communal participation, and village-level customs.

Manipur

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding the Thadou tribe: Jhum cultivation is predominant among them.

Traditionally, they practiced an animistic religion centred on nature spirits and Pathen. Almost all Thadou people today follow Buddhism. Which of the statement/s given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Three Thadou Tribe Church Leaders were shot dead and several others injured after unidentified armed men ambushed their vehicles in Manipur's Kangpokpi district recently.

The Thadous are the second-largest tribe in Manipur, preceded only by the Meiteis, or Manipuris.

The Thadou share many cultural affinities with the many other tribal groups who live near them.

Thadous share a common culture with all the Chin-Kuki-Mizo community.

The Thadou language belongs to the Tibeto-Burman family of the Sino-Tibetan languages.

Jhum (slash-and-burn) agriculture is predominant.

Mizoram

Q1. Which state has launched the "Khuarel" mobile application for disaster management?

- (a) Nagaland
- (b) Manipur
- (c) Mizoram
- (d) Tripura

Answer: (c) — Mizoram

Explanation: Mizoram has launched the "Khuarel" mobile application, a real-time disaster incident reporting and management system designed to enhance coordination and information flow during emergencies.

The app would allow citizens to quickly report disaster incidents while enabling authorities, including the State and District Disaster Management Authorities (SDMA & DDMA), to respond more efficiently.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding ginger cultivation: Ginger does not tolerate frost or prolonged drought. Ginger grows best in poorly drained clayey soils. Ginger supplementation may help reduce fasting blood sugar levels. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: Recently, the Union Minister for Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) launched the ₹189.79-crore Mizoram Ginger Mission.

It requires a warm and humid climate (up to an altitude of 1500m).

The crop performs well in a temperature range of 19°C-28°C.

It requires moderate to high rainfall of about 1,500–2,500 mm per year or reliable irrigation.

Ginger does not tolerate frost or prolonged drought.

It requires loose, fertile, well-drained loam or sandy-loam soils rich in organic matter.

India is the largest producer of ginger and mainly in Kerala, Orissa, Meghalaya, West Bengal, and Arunachal Pradesh.

Ginger supplementation significantly reduces the levels of fasting blood sugar, hemoglobin A1c, apolipoprotein B etc.

Tripura

Q1. Which state became the first in India to complete all Priority Areas under Deregulation Phase-II?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Tripura
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Telangana

Answer: (b) — Tripura

Explanation: Tripura has created history by becoming the first State in India to complete all Priority Areas under Deregulation Phase-II of the national Compliance Reduction and Deregulation initiative led by the Cabinet Secretariat of the Government of India.

Deregulation Phase-II began in January 2026 and included Digital Governance as one of its sectors.

Rajasthan

Q1. The Yashoda programme is associated with the partnership initiative between India and which country?

- (a) Japan
- (b) Norway
- (c) Denmark
- (d) Finland

Answer: (b) — Norway

Explanation: Rajasthan's breast milk donation programme includes the Mother Milk Bank at Barmer District Hospital, the state-run human milk bank Jeevan Dhara in Jaipur, and the Yashoda programme under the Norway-India Partnership Initiative.

Human milk banks collect, screen, process, store, and distribute donated breast milk for newborns who cannot receive milk from their mothers.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding Kumbhalgarh Fort: It was built by Maharana Pratap in the 16th century. It has been recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site under the Hill Forts of Rajasthan. It is popularly known as the "Great Wall of India." Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 2 and 3 only

Explanation: Kumbhalgarh Fort Wall in Rajasthan, often called the Great Wall of India, has been named the second-longest surviving wall in the world by a UNESCO survey. It is located in the Rajsamand district of Rajasthan. It is strategically located in the western Aravalli hills. Spanning over 36 kilometers, its walls are second only to the Great Wall of China, earning it the moniker "the Great Wall of India." The fort has also been designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site as part of the group of Hill Forts of Rajasthan.

Q3. India's first SME-led Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT facility has been established by:

- (a) Tata Electronics
- (b) Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd.
- (c) Vedanta Semiconductors
- (d) Bharat Electronics Limited

Answer: (b) — Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd.

Explanation: Rajasthan entered India's strategic semiconductor sector with the inauguration of its first Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT facility at Bhiwadi. It is India's first SME-led Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT (Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging / Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test) facility established by Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd.

Gujarat

Q1. Which of the following has been described as Indian Railways' first semi high-speed rail project?

- (a) Mumbai–Ahmedabad Bullet Train Project
- (b) Delhi–Meerut RRTS

- (c) Sarkhej–Dholera double line rail project
- (d) Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor

Answer: (c) — Sarkhej–Dholera double line rail project

Explanation: The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved a semi high-speed double line rail project linking Sarkhej in Ahmedabad to Dholera, which lies about 100 km away, for a total cost of approximately ₹20,667 crore. It will be Indian Railways' first semi high-speed project, planned with indigenously developed technology. The project will facilitate faster travel between Ahmedabad, the Dholera special investment region (SIR), the upcoming Dholera Airport, and the (NHMC).

Q2. Which of the following cities are situated on the banks of the Sabarmati River? Ahmedabad Gandhinagar Surat Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: The Sabarmati River in Ahmedabad city remains dry after authorities of the Vasna barrage halted water flow for repair works of its gates, causing inconvenience to many.

It is a monsoon-fed, west-flowing river flowing through Rajasthan and Gujarat.

It originates from the Dhebar Lake, situated in the southeast of the Aravalli Range in Rajasthan's Udaipur district.

The banks of the Sabarmati River have Indian cities like Ahmedabad and Gandhinagar.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding Somnath Temple: Mahmud Ghazni attacked the temple in the 11th century. The present Somnath Temple follows the Chalukya style of architecture. The Somnath pilgrimage site is associated with the confluence of the Kapila, Hiran and Saraswati rivers. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: About Somnath Temple
It is a Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Shiva.

About Somnath Temple

It is a Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Shiva.

The ancient temple's timeline can be traced from 649 BC but is believed to be older than that.

The temple faced several invasions, the most notable being by Mahmud Ghazni in the 11th century.

The present temple was reconstructed in the Chalukya style of Hindu temple architecture and completed in May 1951.

The site of Somnath has been a pilgrimage site from ancient times on account of being a Triveni Sangam: the confluence of three rivers, namely Kapila, Hiran, and Saraswati.

The ancient temple's timeline can be traced from 649 BC but is believed to be older than that.

Q4. The Vadinar Ship Repair Facility project will be jointly implemented by which two organisations?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority and Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Deendayal Port Authority and Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (c) Shipping Corporation of India and Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- (d) Paradip Port Authority and Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Answer: (b) — Deendayal Port Authority and Cochin Shipyard Limited

Explanation: The government approved the development of a state-of-the-art ship repair facility in Vadinar, Gujarat, with an investment of ₹1,570 crore.

The project will be jointly implemented by Deendayal Port Authority (DPA) and Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL).

The project is planned as a brownfield facility with a 650-metre jetty, two large floating dry docks, workshops and associated marine infrastructure.

Q5. Crystal Matrix Limited (CML) will establish its semiconductor facility in which state?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (c) — Gujarat

Q6. Suchi Semicon Private Limited (SSPL) will establish an OSAT facility in:

- (a) Ahmedabad
- (b) Surat
- (c) Gandhinagar
- (d) Bhavnagar

Answer: (b) — Surat

Explanation: The Union cabinet approved support worth a combined ₹3,936 crore in support for two new semiconductor plants by Crystal Matrix Ltd and Suchi Semicon Pvt Ltd.

Suchi Semicon Private Limited (SSPL) will be setting up an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in Surat, Gujarat for manufacturing discrete semiconductors

Crystal Matrix Limited (CML) will establish an integrated facility for compound semiconductor fabrication and ATMP in Dholera, Gujarat.

Q7. A module titled 'Modi Tattva' has been introduced in which university?

- (a) University of Delhi
- (b) Banaras Hindu University
- (c) Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda
- (d) University of Mumbai

Answer: (c) — Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda

Explanation: A first-of-its-kind module on Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership philosophy has been added to the sociology syllabus of the Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, one of western India's oldest public universities.

The module, titled 'Modi Tattva', forms part of a paper on the 'Sociology of Patriotism', under the university's BA and MA programmes in Sociology.

Q8. The newly built 'Million Minds Tech Park' and 'GREMI City Campus' inaugurated by Amit Shah are located in which state?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Karnataka

Answer: (b) — Gujarat

Explanation: Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, Shri Amit Shah, inaugurated the newly built 'Million Minds Tech Park' and 'GREMI City Campus' in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.

the 'Million Minds Tech Park', developed across 13.5 lakh square feet at a cost of nearly Rs. 1,100 crore, will in its first phase provide a state-of-the-art work environment for 9,000 highly skilled professionals.

Q9. Madhur Dairy Unit-2 is located in which state?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Haryana

Answer: (c) — Gujarat

Explanation: Hon'ble Union Home and Cooperation Minister Shri Amit Shah inaugurated the state-of-the-art automated milk processing and packaging plant of Madhur Dairy Unit-2 at Dashela in Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

The plant, built over 15 acres at a cost of around ₹128 crore, currently has the capacity to process 2.5 lakh litres of milk per day, which will be expanded to 5 lakh litres per day in the future.

Maharashtra

Q1. The 2nd edition of WAVES Doc Bazaar will be held in:

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Kolkata
- (c) Mumbai
- (d) Chennai

Answer: (c) — Mumbai

Explanation: The 2nd edition of WAVES Doc Bazaar will return from June 16 to 18, 2026, alongside the 19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF), at the NFDC Complex, Mumbai.

Q2. Operation WHITE STRIKE was conducted by:

- (a) Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)
- (b) National Investigation Agency (NIA)
- (c) Research and Analysis Wing (RAW)
- (d) Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

Answer: (d) — Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

Explanation: The Operation WHITE STRIKE led to the seizure of 349 kg of high-grade cocaine worth ₹1,745 crore in the Mumbai logistics corridor.

A large-scale anti-narcotics operation conducted by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) targeting an international cocaine trafficking syndicate operating through India's logistics networks.

Q3. The 'Kasa Kay?' campaign mainly aims to strengthen:

- (a) Urban transport

- (b) Digital governance
- (c) Healthcare awareness in rural areas
- (d) Agricultural exports

Answer: (c) — Healthcare awareness in rural areas

Explanation: The Maharashtra government has launched the 'Kasa Kay?' public awareness campaign under the 'Majhe Gaav, Arogya Sampanna Gaav' initiative to strengthen healthcare awareness in rural areas.

The programme focuses on preventive healthcare, sanitation, nutrition, clean drinking water and disease control.

Q4. The Bamboo Research and Training Centre (BRTC), recently in the news, is located in which state?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh
- (b) Odisha
- (c) Chhattisgarh
- (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (d) — Maharashtra

Explanation: The Bamboo Research and Training Centre – BRTC at Chichpalli in Maharashtra's Chandrapur district has received approval from the All India Council for Technical Education – AICTE to launch a three-year Diploma in Bamboo Technology from the 2026-27 academic year.

With this approval, BRTC has become the first institution in India to secure AICTE recognition for a standalone diploma programme in Bamboo Technology.

Telangana

Q1. The 'TG Organics' mobile app is launched by which state government?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Telangana
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (b) — Telangana

Explanation: The Telangana government in a few days will launch a mobile app (TG Organics) to connect organic farmers with customers.

People can select vegetables, fruits, or pulses they want, to get a list of the organic farmers concerned in a selected radius, location of the farm, their phone number and other details. Farmers will get to decide the prices.

Q2. 'Ippa Puvvu Panduga' is associated with:

- (a) Mango harvest
- (b) Mahua flower festival
- (c) Rice cultivation
- (d) Cotton harvest

Answer: (b) — Mahua flower festival

Explanation: The annual Mahua flower festival, locally known as 'Ippa Puvvu Panduga', was celebrated with traditional fervour in Jamidi village of Adilabad district, Telangana.

Mahua, scientifically known as *Madhuca indica*, holds immense cultural and economic value for Adivasi communities.

Its flowers are used for food, traditional beverages, and medicinal purposes, while also serving as a key source of livelihood.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding the Thousand Pillar Temple: The temple is entirely made of white marble. The temple reflects the Chalukya style of architecture. The temple is dedicated to Shiva, Vishnu and Surya Deva. Which of the statement/s given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 2 and 3 only

Explanation: The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) completed the 42-year-long restoration of the 12th-century dance pavilion (Kalyana Mandapam) at the Thousand Pillar Temple in Hanamkonda, Telangana.

The structure, which had sunk into the ground due to foundational failure, was rebuilt piece-by-piece using indigenous Kakatiya-era sandbox technology.

It is a Trikulatalaya, dedicated to a troika of deities: Lord Shiva, Vishnu, and Surya Deva.

Built By: Constructed in 1163 AD by the ruler Rudra Deva.

Depicts the typical Chalukya style of architecture.

Q4. PM MITRA Park in Warangal is significant because it is:

- (a) India's first cotton export zone
- (b) The country's first fully operational PM MITRA Park
- (c) Asia's largest silk park
- (d) India's first handloom-only park

Answer: (b) — The country's first fully operational PM MITRA Park

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi today inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of multiple infrastructure and industrial projects worth around Rs 9,400 crore at Hyderabad in Telangana.

Among the major projects unveiled today include, PM MITRA Park in Warangal, also known as the Kakatiya Mega Textile Park.

Built at an estimated cost of around 1,700 crore rupees, it is the country's first fully operational PM MITRA Park and is aimed at creating an integrated textile ecosystem under the Centre's "5F" vision – spanning farm, fibre, factory, fashion and foreign markets.

Q5. The 'Stand With Her' awareness campaign has been launched in which State?

- (a) Telangana
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (a) — Telangana

Explanation: The Telangana Police's Women Safety Wing has intensified the Statewide awareness campaign titled 'Stand With Her', calling on men to actively speak up against harassment and violence against women instead of remaining mute bystanders.

The campaign, led by Director General of Police (Women Safety Wing) Charu Sinha

Q6. The Scientific Conclave on Indian Pharmacopoeia 2026 was organized at:

- (a) AIIMS, New Delhi

- (b) IIT Hyderabad
- (c) NIPER Hyderabad
- (d) JIPMER Puducherry

Answer: (c) — NIPER Hyderabad

Explanation: Recently, the Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC) organized a Scientific Conclave & Interactive Session on Indian Pharmacopoeia 2026 at the National Institute of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPER), Hyderabad, Telangana.

It is an autonomous Institution of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Govt. of India.

It is created to set standards of drugs in the country.

Andhra Pradesh

Q1. "Startup Kadapa", recently seen in news, is an initiative of which state?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Telangana
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (a) — Andhra Pradesh

Explanation: "Startup Kadapa" is an ambitious project in Kadapa, Andhra Pradesh, aimed at nurturing entrepreneurial talent and providing a platform for youth to explore new opportunities.

The initiative is designed to support approximately 15,000 tech professionals in Kadapa who are currently working from home and seeking entrepreneurial platforms.

Q2. YUVA Sangam is an initiative of the:

- (a) Ministry of Culture
- (b) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- (c) Ministry of Education
- (d) Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: (c) — Ministry of Education

Explanation: YUVA Sangam is a flagship programme under Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat (EBSB), an initiative of the Ministry of Education, Government of India.

The programme is aimed at fostering national integration, cultural exchange, and experiential learning among youth across the country.

Q3. Which state became the first to operationalise an industry partnership under the PM-SETU scheme?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (d) — Andhra Pradesh

Explanation: The National Steering Committee (NSC) has approved the strategic investment plan for the Visakhapatnam ITI Cluster in Andhra Pradesh submitted by ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India under the Rs 60,000 crore PM-SETU scheme.

The approval marks the first-ever Strategic Investment Plan to be cleared under Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) and makes Andhra Pradesh the first state to operationalise an industry partnership under the scheme.

Karnataka

Q1. Kartavya-KAAMS, recently launched in Karnataka, is an:

- (a) AI and GIS-enabled facial recognition attendance system
- (b) blockchain-based taxation platform
- (c) satellite-based disaster monitoring network
- (d) digital agricultural marketplace

Answer: (a) — AI and GIS-enabled facial recognition attendance system

Explanation: The Department of School Education and Literacy (DSEL) has launched the 'Karnataka Advanced Attendance Management System (Kartavya-KAAMS) to identify and monitor the attendance of permanent teaching and non-teaching staff and officers.

The Kartavya-KAAMS is an artificial intelligence (AI) and geographic information system (GIS) enabled facial recognition mobile app.

It is mandatory for teaching and non-teaching staff to register attendance twice a day on the app from the place where they are on duty from the academic year 2026-27.

Q2. Ulsoor Lake was originally built by:

- (a) Hyder Ali
- (b) Tipu Sultan
- (c) Kempe Gowda II
- (d) Krishnadevaraya

Answer: (c) — Kempe Gowda II

Explanation: Ulsoor Lake, also known as Halasuru Lake, is a man-made lake located in Bangalore, Karnataka.

It is the largest and oldest lake in the entire city of Bangalore.

It was built by Kempe Gowda II, the founder of Bangalore, in 1648 and named after the nearby village of Halsur or Alasur.

Q3. Which State has recently introduced a first-of-its-kind grievance redressal mechanism for gig workers through the Integrated Public Grievance Redressal System (IPGRS) portal?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Telangana

Answer: (c) — Karnataka

Explanation: Karnataka government launches India's first digital grievance redressal system for gig workers

The mechanism — a first of its kind in India — has been developed by the Karnataka Platform-based Gig Workers' Board in collaboration with the Department of e-Governance.

Under The Karnataka Platform-Based Gig Workers (Social Security and Welfare) Act and Rules, every aggregator platform must constitute an Internal Dispute Resolution Committee (IDRC).

Kerala

Q1. Which organization has launched the pilot programme for Kavu nurseries?

- (a) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (b) Kerala State Biodiversity Board
- (c) National Biodiversity Authority
- (d) Zoological Survey of India

Answer: (b) — Kerala State Biodiversity Board

Explanation: The Kerala State Biodiversity Board has launched a pilot programme to restore sacred groves (kavus) across selected districts.

Kavu nurseries are specialized plant nurseries developed to propagate native, endemic, and threatened plant species found in sacred groves (kavus).

Q2. The Mangala Devi Kannagi Temple is located inside:

- (a) Bandipur Tiger Reserve
- (b) Periyar Tiger Reserve
- (c) Nagarhole Tiger Reserve
- (d) Mudumalai Tiger Reserve

Answer: (b) — Periyar Tiger Reserve

Explanation: The Chitra Pournami festival at the Mangala Devi Kannagi Temple on the Keralam – Tamil Nadu border held.

Located inside the Periyar Tiger Reserve, the temple will open to devotees from 6 a.m.

Q3. Who is set to become the next Chief Minister of Kerala?

- (a) Pinarayi Vijayan
- (b) K. Sudhakaran
- (c) V. D. Satheesan
- (d) Ramesh Chennithala

Answer: (c) — V. D. Satheesan

Explanation: Senior Congress leader V.D. Satheesan will be sworn in as Kerala's next Chief Minister,

The 61-year-old Mr. Satheesan, who led the Opposition in the Kerala Assembly from 2021 to 2026, will be the 13th person to hold the Chief Minister's position in the southern State.

Q4. Who has been sworn in as the pro tem Speaker of the 16th Kerala Assembly?

- (a) Pinarayi Vijayan
- (b) G. Sudhakaran
- (c) V. Sivankutty
- (d) A.N. Shamseer

Answer: (b) — G. Sudhakaran

Explanation: Ambalappuzha MLA G Sudhakaran was sworn in as pro tem Speaker of the 16th Kerala Assembly

Q5. The 'Oommen Chandy Aarogya Insurance Scheme' recently announced by the Kerala Government provides free annual health coverage of:

- (a) ₹5 lakh per family
- (b) ₹10 lakh per family
- (c) ₹25 lakh per family
- (d) ₹50 lakh per family

Answer: (c) — ₹25 lakh per family

Explanation: The Kerala Governor Rajendra Arlekar announced two key policy decisions of the new government which can have significant impact on the State's public health -- a new department for senior citizens' welfare And a health insurance scheme which provides free annual health coverage of Rs. 25 lakh for every family under the "Oommen Chandy Aarogya Insurance Scheme", one of the main guarantees under the five Indira Guarantees promised by the UDF government

Q6. . Operation Chakravayuh, recently seen in the news, is associated with:

- (a) Counter-terrorism operations
- (b) Anti-narcotics drive
- (c) Anti-piracy mission
- (d) Anti-smuggling of wildlife products

Answer: (b) — Anti-narcotics drive

Explanation: The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI), Kochi unit, has seized 24 kg of suspected narcotic drugs worth crores and arrested five persons as part of the intensified anti-narcotics drive in Kerala under Operation Chakravayuh.

The operation is part of sustained efforts to dismantle organised drug trafficking networks operating through international and domestic channels.

Tamil Nadu**Q1. Which of the following commissions recommended the order of precedence in government formation during a hung Assembly? Sarkaria Commission Punchhi Commission Administrative Reforms Commission Select the correct answer using the code below:**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Actor-turned-politician Vijay's swearing-in as Tamil Nadu Chief Minister has been delayed as Governor Rajendra Arlekar insisted on proof of majority before an invitation to form the government

A hung Assembly occurs when no single political party or pre-poll alliance secures an absolute majority of seats in the state legislature.

Governor's Role & Order of Precedence: Based on the norms established by the Sarkaria Commission (1983) and the Punchhi Commission (2007).

Q2. Governor _____ formally appointed _____ as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu.

- (a) Rajendra Arlekar, C. Joseph Vijay
- (b) R.N. Ravi, M.K. Stalin
- (c) Banwarilal Purohit, O. Panneerselvam
- (d) C.P. Radhakrishnan, Edappadi K. Palaniswami

Answer: (a) — Rajendra Arlekar, C. Joseph Vijay

Explanation: C Joseph Vijay was sworn in as Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, with nine others taking oath as ministers for his cabinet at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Chennai.

The Governor Rajendra Arlekar had formally appointed Vijay and invited him to form the government after he crossed the majority mark with support from Congress, CPI, CPI(M), VCK, and IUML.

Q3. Which of the following pairs related to the State Executive are correctly matched? Article 163 — Council of Ministers to aid and advise the Governor Article 166 — Conduct of the business of the State Government Article 177 — Rights of Ministers to participate in proceedings of the

State Legislature Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: The Chief Minister and the Council of Ministers, as outlined in Part VI of the Indian Constitution, form a key part of the state executive, alongside the Governor and Advocate General of State.

The following are the constitutional provisions:

Article 163 establishes that the Council of Ministers, headed by the Chief Minister, is responsible for aiding and advising the Governor in the exercise of most of the Governor's functions, except the discretionary ones.

Article 166 deals with the conduct of the business of the state government.

Rights of Ministers: Article 177 grants ministers including the Chief Minister the right to speak in, and participate in the proceedings of, the legislative assemblies and councils of the state, as well as any committee of the state legislature of which they may be named a member.

However, they do not have the right to vote unless they are members of a particular House of bicameral state legislature.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the Pro-tem Speaker: The Pro-tem Speaker functions only during the transitional phase of a newly constituted House. The Constitution explicitly lays down the procedure for appointment of the Pro-tem Speaker. Conventionally, the senior-most member of the House is appointed as the Pro-tem Speaker. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: Who is a Pro-tem Speaker?

A Pro-tem ("for the time being") Speaker is a temporary presiding officer appointed to fulfil specific constitutional and procedural requirements during the transition between two legislative assemblies.

The senior-most member of the House (usually by number of terms served) is chosen for the role. This is not a legal rule, and the government may recommend other members, too.

Q5. The "Singappan Special Task Force" has been constituted by which state government?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Telangana
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (d) — Tamil Nadu

Explanation: The Tamil Nadu government has ordered the formation of the "Singappan Special Task Force" to

strengthen women's safety and preventive protection measures in the state.

The special unit will function under the direct supervision of the Chief Minister.

Q6. Who was unanimously elected as the Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Assembly?

- (a) M.K. Stalin
- (b) J.C.D. Prabhakar
- (c) Ravishankar
- (d) Udhayanidhi Stalin

Answer: (b) — J.C.D. Prabhakar

Explanation: TVK legislator J.C.D. Prabhakar was unanimously elected as the Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

Mr. Ravishankar was elected unopposed, Deputy Speaker.

Q7. Which of the following is described as India's first mega greenfield shipyard project?

- (a) Cochin Shipyard Expansion Project
- (b) Vizhinjam Port Shipyard Project
- (c) Thoothukudi Mega Greenfield Shipyard Project
- (d) Kandla Maritime Industrial Corridor

Answer: (c) — Thoothukudi Mega Greenfield Shipyard Project

Explanation: India's maritime sector received a major boost with the signing of a landmark tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for the development of the country's first mega greenfield shipyard at Thoothukudi in Tamil Nadu. The agreement was signed, between HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering (HD KSOE), National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park, Tamil Nadu Limited (NSHIP-TN), and Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited (SMFCL) under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

Q8. Dearness Allowance (DA) is provided to government employees and pensioners mainly to:

- (a) Encourage savings
- (b) Offset the impact of inflation
- (c) Promote exports
- (d) Reduce income tax burden

Answer: (b) — Offset the impact of inflation

Explanation: What is Dearness Allowance (DA)?

DA is paid by the government to its employees as well as pensioners to offset the impact of inflation.

The effective salary of government employees requires constant enhancement to help them cope with increasing prices.

As the impact of inflation varies according to the location of the employee, the DA is calculated accordingly.

Q9. The Vellimalai Pumped Storage Hydroelectric Project, recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (c) — Tamil Nadu

Explanation: The 1,100 MW Vellimalai Pumped Storage Hydroelectric Project in the Kanniyakumari district has been granted Terms of Reference (ToR) clearance by the Union

Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change recently.

It is an 1100 MW pumped hydropower storage plant to be developed at Vellimalai in the Kanyakumari district of Tamil Nadu.

Puducherry

Q1. . Who has been appointed as the Chief Minister of Puducherry?

- (a) V. Narayanasamy
- (b) N. Rangasamy
- (c) K. Kailashnathan
- (d) Tamilisai Soundararajan

Answer: (b) — N. Rangasamy

Explanation: President Droupadi Murmu has appointed N Rangasamy as Chief Minister of Puducherry.

Following the appointment, Lieutenant Governor K Kailashnathan invited Mr Rangasamy to form a new government in the union territory.

Q2. Who has been appointed as the Protem Speaker of the 16th Puducherry Legislative Assembly?

- (a) N. Rangasamy
- (b) A. Anbalagan
- (c) V. Vaithilingam
- (d) K. Lakshminarayanan

Answer: (b) — A. Anbalagan

Explanation: Senior AIADMK legislator A. Anbalagan has been appointed as the Pro tem Speaker of the 16th Puducherry Legislative Assembly.

Q3. The Government of India recently notified two new Special Economic Zones (SEZs) — the IT/ITES SEZ and the Multi-Sector SEZ . These SEZs are located in which Union Territory?

- (a) Chandigarh
- (b) Jammu & Kashmir
- (c) Lakshadweep
- (d) Puducherry

Answer: (d) — Puducherry

Explanation: The Government of India notified two new Special Economic Zones (SEZs) in the Union Territory of Puducherry. The proposals were cleared by the Board of Approval for SEZs, functioning under the Department of Commerce.

First SEZ Developed by an Urban Local Body (ULB): One of the notified zones is an IT/ITES SEZ developed by the Oulgaret Municipality at Thattanchavady village (Oulgaret Taluk).

This marks a historic milestone as it is the first SEZ in India to be developed by a municipal body (Urban Local Body).

Multi-Sector SEZ by PIPDIC: The second project is a Multi-Sector SEZ developed by the Pondicherry Industrial Promotion Development and Investment Corporation (PIPDIC) at Karasur village (Villianur Taluk).

It aims to house diversified manufacturing and service industries to boost regional exports.

Defence

Q1. TARA is India's first indigenous:

- (a) Glide weapon system
- (b) Ballistic missile system
- (c) Anti-submarine drone
- (d) Hypersonic interceptor

Answer: (a) — Glide weapon system

Explanation: The DRDO and the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully conducted the maiden flight-trial of the Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation (TARA) weapon off the coast of Odisha.

TARA is a modular range extension kit and India's first indigenous glide weapon system.

It is designed to be fitted onto existing unguided warheads, converting them into advanced precision-guided weapons.

Q2. Yildirimhan Missile is an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) developed by which country?

- (a) Russia
- (b) Iran
- (c) Türkiye
- (d) China

Answer: (c) — Türkiye

Explanation: Türkiye has unveiled a prototype of an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) named Yildirimhan Missile as part of a push to become self-reliant and to gain a foothold as a key defence player in the Middle East and among its NATO allies.

It is an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) developed by Turkey.

It has a range of 6,000 km.

Q3. The Fast Patrol Vessel 'Achal' has been constructed by:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (d) Goa Shipyard Limited

Answer: (d) — Goa Shipyard Limited

Explanation: Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV) 'Achal' was commissioned into the Indian Coast Guard, bolstering the maritime force's operational capabilities 'Achal' is the fifth one in a series of eight FPVs being constructed by Goa Shipyard Ltd (GSL) for the coast guard.

Q4. The Indian Air Force conducted the "Op Sindoor Commemorative Run" from:

- (a) 01 May to 04 May 2026
- (b) 05 May to 08 May 2026
- (c) 07 May to 10 May 2026
- (d) 10 May to 13 May 2026

Answer: (c) — 07 May to 10 May 2026

Explanation: The Indian Air Force (IAF) conducted an 88 hours "Op Sindoor Commemorative Run" from 07 May to 10 May 26 at New Delhi.

The event commemorated the first anniversary of the 88-hours of successful air operations, carried out by the IAF, which demonstrated its capability to deliver decisive and precise strikes.

Q5. INS Sagardhwani was built by:

- (a) Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- (b) Goa Shipyard Limited
- (c) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Answer: (d) — Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Explanation: About INS Sagardhwani

It is an oceanographic research vessel which was commissioned in July 1994.

The meaning of the name 'Sagardhwani' is the sound/ voice of the sea.

It was built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE).

Q6. The Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) for the Indian Coast Guard are being built at:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Chowgule Shipyard
- (d) Cochin Shipyard

Answer: (c) — Chowgule Shipyard

Explanation: The Indian Coast Guard conducted the girder laying ceremony for the fourth, fifth and sixth Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) being built for the force at the Rassaim Yard of Chowgule Shipyard in Goa.

The ACVs are being manufactured under the Centre's Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative with around 50 per cent indigenous content.

Q7. The concept of the U.S. Golden Dome defence system is partly inspired by which country's defence shield?

- (a) Israel
- (b) China
- (c) Russia
- (d) France

Answer: (a) — Israel

Explanation: President Donald Trump's plan to put weapons in space — pitched as a "Golden Dome for America" missile defence program — is estimated to cost \$1.2 trillion over a 20-year period.

The concept for the missile system is at least partly inspired by Israel's multitiered defences, often collectively referred to as the "Iron Dome,"

The U.S. Golden Dome is envisioned to include ground- and space-based capabilities able to detect, intercept and stop missiles at all major stages of a potential attack.

Q8. The intercontinental ballistic missile Sarmat, known by NATO as "SS-29 Satan II", belongs to which country?

- (a) China
- (b) United States
- (c) Russia
- (d) France

Answer: (c) — Russia

Explanation: Russia conducted a test launch of the Sarmat super-heavy intercontinental ballistic missile from the Plesetsk Cosmodrome in the Arkhangelsk region.

The Sarmat is a liquid-fuelled intercontinental ballistic missile

It is known to NATO as SS-29 Satan II and is intended to replace the Soviet-era R-36M2 Voyevoda, which NATO designated as SS-18 Satan.

The missile is designed to carry multiple nuclear warheads and to penetrate missile defence systems.

Q9. The theme vision of Kalam & Kavach 3.0 is represented by "JAI", which stands for:

- (a) Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation
- (b) Justice, Awareness and Integrity
- (c) Joint Action and Intelligence
- (d) Jobs, Advancement and Inclusion

Answer: (a) — Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation

Explanation: Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth inaugurated the third edition of Kalam & Kavach at Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi on May 14, 2026

The event is centred around the strategic vision of Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation (JAI), along with emphasis on Indigenisation and International Collaboration (I²).

Q10. CINBAX-II is a bilateral military exercise between India and:

- (a) Myanmar
- (b) Cambodia
- (c) Indonesia
- (d) Malaysia

Answer: (b) — Cambodia

Explanation: The Indian Army contingent has departed to Cambodia for the second edition of India-Cambodia Bilateral Military Exercise CINBAX-II.

The exercise is scheduled to be conducted at Techo Sen Phnom Thom Mreas Prov Royal Cambodian Air Force Training Centre (Camp Basil), from 04 to 17 of this month.

Q11. INS Mahendragiri belongs to which class of warships?

- (a) Kolkata-class
- (b) Nilgiri-class
- (c) Shivalik-class
- (d) Talwar-class

Answer: (b) — Nilgiri-class

Explanation: Mahendragiri (Yard 12654), the sixth ship of Nilgiri-class (Project 17A) and fourth ship of the class built at Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDSL), was delivered to the Indian Navy on 30 Apr 2026 at MDSL, Mumbai.

Project 17A frigates are versatile multi-mission platforms designed to address current and emerging challenges in the maritime domain.

Q12. 'Op Netra 1.0' was conducted by:

- (a) Indian Air Force
- (b) Indian Navy
- (c) Indian Army
- (d) DRDO

Answer: (c) — Indian Army

Explanation: The Indian Army successfully concluded 'Op Netra 1.0,' a four-day high-altitude mega eye camp in Leh, Ladakh, which provided advanced surgical care to 950 patients.

'Op Netra 1.0' was an Advanced Surgical Eye Camp conducted by the Indian Army.

Q13. Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI) operates under which ministry?

- (a) Ministry of Heavy Industries
- (b) Ministry of Steel
- (c) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (d) Ministry of Defence

Answer: (d) — Ministry of Defence

Explanation: Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI), a premier Defence Public Sector Undertaking under the Ministry of Defence, marked a significant milestone with the inauguration of its state-of-the-art Aerospace Fasteners Facility at its Hyderabad plant.

The new facility is designed to ensure high precision, consistency and efficiency in the manufacture of aerospace-grade fasteners.

Q14. The Vikram VT-21 project has been developed by:

- (a) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (b) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
- (c) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (d) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

Answer: (c) — Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Explanation: The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) recently launched its Vikram VT 21 project with two Advanced Armoured Platforms wheeled and tracked.

An Advanced Armoured Platform (AAP), Vikram VT 21 is a modern military combat vehicle built with enhanced armour protection to withstand certain projectiles, blasts, and shrapnel plus which has improved mobility across varied terrains and integrated weapons and surveillance systems.

Q15. What is Project Deepak?

- (a) A railway connectivity project in Northeast India
- (b) A hydroelectric power project in Himachal Pradesh
- (c) A BRO project responsible for strategic road infrastructure in Himachal Pradesh
- (d) A defence missile development programme under DRDO

Answer: (c) — A BRO project responsible for strategic road infrastructure in Himachal Pradesh

Explanation: Recently, the Project Deepak of Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 66th Raising Day at Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.

It was initiated in 1962 by the Border Roads Organisation. The project has been instrumental in executing critical infrastructure works in some of the most challenging terrains of the country.

Q16. INS Sindhukesari belongs to which class of submarines?

- (a) Scorpene-class
- (b) Arihant-class
- (c) Kilo-class
- (d) Kalvari-class

Answer: (c) — Kilo-class

Explanation: The Indian Navy's Kilo-class submarine, INS Sindhukesari, recently arrived in Colombo for an Operational Turnaround (OTR).

It is a 3,000-tonne Kilo-class diesel-electric submarine of the Indian Navy.

It was commissioned on 19 December 1988.

Q17. NOTAMs are generally issued by:

- (a) Shipping authorities
- (b) Railway ministries
- (c) National aviation authorities
- (d) Meteorological departments only

Answer: (c) — National aviation authorities

Explanation: Notice to Airmen, also known as Notice to Air Mission, is a notice containing information concerning the establishment, condition, or change in any aeronautical facility, service, procedure, or hazard, the timely knowledge of which is essential to personnel concerned with flight operations.

In short, a NOTAM is a notification from an official body alerting airspace users to hazards along their route, both in the air and on the ground. NOTAMs are issued by national aviation authorities for a number of reasons,

Q18. What is MICA?

- (a) A surface-to-surface ballistic missile
- (b) A multi-mission air-to-air missile system
- (c) An anti-submarine warfare drone
- (d) A satellite communication system

Answer: (b) — A multi-mission air-to-air missile system

Explanation: European missile and related systems giant MBDA has signed an agreement with the Indian Air Force for the development of a local capability for the Maintenance, Repair, and Mid-Life Overhaul (MRO) of MICA Missiles. MICA is the multi-mission air-to-air missile system for the Rafale and the upgraded Mirage 2000 combat aircraft.

Q19. Which shipyard built the vessels Dunagiri, Agray and Sanshodhak for the Indian Navy?

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (d) Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: (c) — Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Explanation: The Indian Navy is set to commission three indigenous vessels — a stealth frigate, an anti-submarine warfare craft and a survey ship — in a fresh push to strengthen its operational edge in the Indian Ocean Region. The vessels — Dunagiri, Agray and Sanshodhak — were built by Kolkata-based Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) and were recently delivered to the navy.

Q20. "Operation Ragepill" is associated with the seizure of which banned synthetic stimulant drug in India?

- (a) Heroin
- (b) Methamphetamine
- (c) Captagon
- (d) Cocaine

Answer: (c) — Captagon

Explanation: Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced India's first-ever seizure of Captagon, a banned synthetic stimulant often referred to internationally as the "Jihadi Drug", in an operation valued at ₹182 crore. The seizure was made under "Operation Ragepill"

Captagon is a banned synthetic stimulant that has been linked internationally to organised crime networks and conflict zones in parts of West Asia.

Q21. Flying Wedge Defence & Aerospace (FWDA) established its first international manufacturing node for the AI-powered combat aircraft 'Kaal Bhairava' in which country?

- (a) France
- (b) Israel
- (c) Portugal
- (d) Germany

Answer: (c) — Portugal

Explanation: Flying Wedge Defence & Aerospace (FWDA), an Indian AI warfare company, announced the establishment of its first international manufacturing node in Portugal for its flagship autonomous combat aircraft, Kaal Bhairava.

India's first AI-powered combat aircraft, Kaal Bhairava will be manufactured in Portugal through a partnership with SKETCHPIXEL LDA, a European technology firm known for developing advanced fighter jet simulation systems for aircraft including the F-16.

Q22. ULPGM has been jointly developed by:

- (a) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (b) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Adani Defence & Aerospace
- (c) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) and Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)
- (d) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Tata Advanced Systems

Answer: (b) — Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Adani Defence & Aerospace

Explanation: The Indian Army has inducted the ULPGM and AGNIKAA VTOL-1 FPV Kamikaze Drone after successful trials in challenging operational environments, strengthening India's indigenous unmanned warfare capabilities.
ULPGM: ULPGM stands for Ultra Light Precision Guided Missile.

Developed jointly by:

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
Adani Defence & Aerospace

India's first indigenous loitering munition in its category.

Q23. ABHAY is described as India's first:

- (a) AI-based tax monitoring platform
- (b) Real-time notice verification system to combat cyber-enabled fraud
- (c) Deepfake video creation system
- (d) National biometric identification tool

Answer: (b) — Real-time notice verification system to combat cyber-enabled fraud

Explanation: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) recently launched an AI-based helpbot called "Abhay" for authentication of CBI notices. ABHAY (AI-Based Helpbot for Authentication of Your Notice) is an AI-powered notice verification system launched by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI).

Q24. Multilateral Exercise PRAGATI 2026 is being conducted in which state?

- (a) Assam
- (b) Meghalaya
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Tripura

Answer: (b) — Meghalaya

Explanation: The multilateral military exercise 'PRAGATI 2026' (Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region) commenced at Umroi Military Station with the participation of 12 friendly nations — Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Seychelles, Sri Lanka and Vietnam.

The objectives of the exercise include enabling seamless coordination among participating nations in joint operations, identifying common areas of cooperation, sharing expertise and establishing an institutionalised mechanism for exchange of best practices evolved through individual experiences.

Q25. ADITI, recently seen in the news, stands for:

- (a) Advanced Defence Innovation and Technology Initiative
- (b) Advanced Defence Technology Incubation
- (c) Applied Defence Technology Integration
- (d) Advanced Digital Technology Interface

Answer: (b) — Advanced Defence Technology Incubation

Explanation: Defence technology company Tonbo Imaging has bagged a contract from the Indian Navy under the ADITI 3.0 innovation framework to integrate and commission a High Power Microwave (HPM) system for naval platforms. The programme is supported by iDEX and the Defence Innovation Organisation (DIO) under the Ministry of Defence, Government of India.

ADITI (Advanced Defence Technology Incubation) is a Government of India initiative designed to enable the maturation, integration, and validation of advanced defence technologies prior to induction.

Q26. ULPGM-V3, recently seen in news, has been developed by:

- (a) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- (b) Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)
- (c) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (d) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)

Answer: (c) — Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Explanation: Recently, Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) has successfully completed the final development trials of Unmanned Aerial Vehicle Launched Precision Guided Missile (ULPGM)-V3 in Air-to-Ground and Air-to-Air modes.

It is a precision-guided air-to-surface missile launched from drones.

It has been developed by Research Centre Imarat Hyderabad as the nodal lab along with other DRDO laboratories.

Q27. The ship "Sanghmitra", recently launched as a Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV), derives its name from:

- (a) The daughter of King Ashoka
- (b) A Buddhist text
- (c) A freedom fighter
- (d) An ancient port city

Answer: (a) — The daughter of King Ashoka

Explanation: Yard 3039 (Sanghmitra), Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV), was launched at M/s GRSE, Kolkata

The construction of 11 NGOPVs is being undertaken concurrently at two shipyards (GSL, Goa and GRSE, Kolkata). These indigenously designed and built ships will augment the existing OPVs/ NOPVs for multi-domain operations, such as surveillance and defence in area of interest, search and rescue, protection of offshore assets, HADR, and anti-piracy missions.

These ships derive their names from India's heritage, with this ship being named 'Sanghmitra', after the daughter of King Ashoka.

Q28. Suryastra, recently tested by Nibe Limited, is India's first indigenous:

- (a) Ballistic missile defence system
- (b) Multi-calibre rocket launcher system
- (c) Hypersonic cruise missile
- (d) Anti-drone warfare platform

Answer: (b) — Multi-calibre rocket launcher system

Explanation: India recently achieved a major milestone in indigenous defence technology after private defence firm Nibe Limited successfully tested the long-range Suryastra rocket system at Chandipur.

It is India's first indigenous universal multi-calibre rocket launcher system.

It is developed by Pune-based NIBE Limited in collaboration with Israel's Elbit Systems.

Q29. . INS Sudarshini was built by:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Goa Shipyard Limited
- (d) Cochin Shipyard Limited

Answer: (c) — Goa Shipyard Limited

Explanation: Facts about INS Sudarshini

It is an indigenously built Sail Training Ship (STS).

It was built by Goa Shipyard Limited and based at Kochi, Kerala under the Southern Naval Command of the Indian Navy.

It was successfully built and was commissioned on 27 Jan. 2012.

Science & Technology

Q1. The remnants of the newly identified dwarf galaxy "Loki" were discovered within which of the following galaxies?

- (a) Andromeda Galaxy
- (b) Whirlpool Galaxy
- (c) Milky Way Galaxy
- (d) Sombrero Galaxy

Answer: (c) — Milky Way Galaxy

Explanation: Scientists have discovered new clues

suggesting that the Milky Way grew larger billions of years ago by absorbing a smaller dwarf galaxy.

The findings, published in the journal Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, indicate that remnants of this ancient galaxy may still exist inside our own.

Researchers have named the dwarf galaxy "Loki," after the Norse god of trickery.

Q2. The Psyche mission was launched by:

- (a) European Space Agency
- (b) Indian Space Research Organisation
- (c) Roscosmos State Corporation for Space Activities
- (d) National Aeronautics and Space Administration

Answer: (d) — National Aeronautics and Space Administration

Explanation: Recently, NASA's Psyche spacecraft captured a stunning crescent image of Mars from nearly 5 million kilometres away.

It was launched on October 13, 2023 by NASA.

It is on a mission to reach the metal-rich asteroid also named Psyche.

Q3. Recently discovered with a thin atmosphere, (612533) 2002 XV93 belongs to which category of celestial bodies?

- (a) Near-Earth Object
- (b) Main-belt Asteroid
- (c) Trans-Neptunian Object
- (d) Dwarf Planet

Answer: (c) — Trans-Neptunian Object

Explanation: Astronomers have discovered a thin atmosphere on the trans-Neptunian object (612533) 2002 XV93, making it only the second such body after Pluto known to possess one.

(612533) 2002 XV93 is a small, icy celestial body located in the Kuiper Belt, a vast region of the solar system beyond the orbit of Neptune.

It is a trans-Neptunian object (TNO) that likely dates back to the dawn of the solar system, approximately 4.5 billion years ago.

Q4. LHS 3844 b is classified as a:

- (a) Gas giant
- (b) Ice giant
- (c) Super-Earth
- (d) Brown dwarf

Answer: (c) — Super-Earth

Explanation: The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) directly studied the rocky exoplanet LHS 3844 b, also called Kua'kua.

LHS 3844 b is a super-Earth located about 49 to 50 light-years away and is around 30% larger than Earth.

LHS 3844 b is a tidally locked exoplanet, which means one hemisphere permanently faces its host star.

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding Valley fever: It is a fungal infection that primarily affects the lungs. It spreads from person to person through respiratory droplets. There is currently no vaccine available for the

disease. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: Valley fever, also known as acute coccidioidomycosis, is a fungal infection that primarily affects the lungs. The fungi's spores can be stirred into the air by anything that disrupts the soil, such as farming, construction, and wind. People can then breathe the fungi into their lungs. Pets can also become infected. It does not spread from person to person or between people and animals. There is no vaccine to prevent valley fever.

Q6. "Buddharoid" is an AI-powered robot developed by which country?

- (a) China
- (b) Thailand
- (c) South Korea
- (d) Japan

Answer: (d) — Japan

Explanation: South Korea introduced its first humanoid robot monk, Gabi, at a Buddhist ceremony at Jogyesa Temple in Seoul. A humanoid robot is a machine designed with a human-like body structure, including a head, torso, arms, and legs. The name combines Siddhartha, the birth name of the Buddha, and jabi, the Korean word for mercy.

Q7. Which company recently became India's first space-tech unicorn?

- (a) Agnikul Cosmos
- (b) Bellatrix Aerospace
- (c) Skyroot Aerospace
- (d) Pixxel

Answer: (c) — Skyroot Aerospace

Explanation: Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace announced that it had become India's first space-tech unicorn following its latest round of funding of nearly USD 60 million, taking its valuation to USD 1.1 billion. A unicorn is a privately held startup valued at \$1 billion or more. Skyroot Aerospace aims to make Vikram-1 India's first privately developed orbital rocket. In 2022, the company launched Vikram-S, which became India's first privately built rocket to reach space.

Q8. The "Pathfinder" satellite, recently seen in news, is being developed by which organisations?

- (a) Pixxel and Sarvam AI
- (b) Indian Space Research Organisation and Infosys Limited
- (c) Defence Research and Development Organisation and Tata Consultancy Services
- (d) National Aeronautics and Space Administration and OpenAI

Answer: (a) — Pixxel and Sarvam AI

Explanation: Space-tech startup Pixxel, announced a partnership with LLM provider Sarvam AI to develop and build India's first orbital data centre satellite called The Pathfinder.

Expected to reach orbit by the end of 2026, the 200-kg satellite will house GPUs (graphics processing units) that will be used to carry out training and inference of Sarvam's AI model.

Q9. Consider the following statements regarding DAMPE: It is China's first astronomical satellite. It is designed to detect high-energy cosmic rays and gamma rays. It operates in a geostationary orbit. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: China's DAMPE space telescope recently made an observation on the acceleration of cosmic rays, such as nuclei of hydrogen, helium, etc., and found that the intensity of the cosmic radiation decreases more rapidly upon reaching a specific high-energy threshold. DAMPE (Dark Matter Particle Explorer), also known as "Wukong", is China's first astronomical satellite. The satellite was launched into a polar, sun-synchronous orbit with an altitude of 500 km on December 17, 2015. The main scientific objective of DAMPE is to measure electrons and photons with much higher energy resolution and energy reach than achievable with existing space experiments in order to identify possible dark matter signatures.

Q10. The satellite "CAS500-2," recently seen in news, has been developed by:

- (a) Japan
- (b) South Korea
- (c) China
- (d) United States

Answer: (b) — South Korea

Explanation: South Korea launched its domestically developed Earth-observation satellite Compact Advanced Satellite 500-2 (CAS500-2) into orbit. The satellite, also called Next-Generation Medium Satellite No. 2 or Cha Middle 2, lifted off aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California, United States.

Q11. Which of the following best describes the unique capability of the 'Drishti' satellite?

- (a) It provides only thermal imaging for weather monitoring
- (b) It captures both optical and radar images of the same area simultaneously
- (c) It is designed exclusively for communication services
- (d) It operates only during daytime under clear sky conditions

Answer: (b) — It captures both optical and radar images of the same area simultaneously

Explanation: An Indian start-up, GalaxEye, rode on a SpaceX rocket this morning to launch a first of its kind satellite that

is meant to fill a long-standing gap in space imaging. The satellite, aptly called Drishti, Equipped to take optical images, very much like a normal camera, as well as radar-generated images of the same place at the same time, something that has not been tried before. Drishti is the first satellite of GalaxEye, a company started by alumni of IIT Madras.

Q12. Consider the following statements regarding Germanium: Germanium is a metalloid. Germanium is highly unstable in air and water. Germanium is found in minerals such as germanite and argyrodite. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: About Germanium
It has the chemical symbol Ge and the atomic number 32.
It is a silvery-gray metalloid, intermediate in properties between the metals and the nonmetals.
It has a diamond-like crystalline structure, and it is similar in chemical and physical properties to silicon.
It is stable in air and water and is unaffected by alkalis and acids, except nitric acid.
Germanium ores are rare. They are found in small quantities as the minerals germanite and argyrodite.

Q13. . The Priority Pathogen List for syndromic surveillance in India has been developed by:

- (a) National Centre for Disease Control
- (b) Indian Council of Medical Research
- (c) World Health Organization
- (d) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: (b) — Indian Council of Medical Research

Explanation: The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has developed a priority pathogen list for syndromic surveillance in India.
Syndromic surveillance is a public health method that tracks symptom patterns such as fever, respiratory illness, diarrhoea, and encephalitis before laboratory confirmation.
It is used in epidemic-prone settings to identify unusual clusters of illness and to support early public health action.

Q14. Hantavirus is primarily carried by:

- (a) Mosquitoes
- (b) Rodents
- (c) Birds
- (d) Bats

Answer: (b) — Rodents

Explanation: Recently, three people have died and three are ill after a Netherlands-based cruise ship was hit by a suspected outbreak of hantavirus
Hantavirus is a strain of virus carried by rodents.
Transmission: It is transmitted to humans through inhalation of particles from dried rodent droppings.

Q15. With reference to the Methane Alert and Response System (MARS), consider the following statements: It is the world's first satellite-based system for monitoring methane

super-emitters. It was officially launched during COP28.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The UN expanded its Methane Alert and Response System (MARS) to include the coal and waste sectors.

MARS is the first global satellite-based system that monitors methane super-emitters and connects that data to rapid mitigation efforts. It is a component of the International Methane Emissions Observatory (IMEO) under the UN Environment Programme (UNEP).

Launched In: The system was announced at COP27 and officially launched in January 2023.

Q16. The Zwan-Wolf effect refers to:

- (a) A process causing rapid heating of planetary atmospheres
- (b) A phenomenon creating low-density charged particle regions near magnetic fields
- (c) A mechanism responsible for the formation of planetary rings
- (d) A reaction producing high-energy radiation near the Sun

Answer: (b) — A phenomenon creating low-density charged particle regions near magnetic fields

Explanation: In a new study published in Nature Communications, researchers from France, the U.K., and the U.S. used the NASA MAVEN spacecraft to find evidence of the Zwan-Wolf effect at Mars

As the solar wind nears the magnetic field of a planet, it becomes compressed near the magnetic boundaries.

This creates a difference in pressure, or pressure gradient, that squeezes the charged particles along the magnetic field, away from the stream.

As a result, closer to the stream is an area with a lower density of charged particles. This is called the Zwan-Wolf effect.

Q17. Which one of the following best explains the formation of Blue Straggler Stars?

- (a) Rapid collapse of interstellar gas clouds
- (b) Mass transfer from a companion star in a binary system
- (c) Complete exhaustion of nuclear fuel
- (d) Collision between a star and a black hole

Answer: (b) — Mass transfer from a companion star in a binary system

Explanation: Recently, researchers have made the world's first confirmed discovery of a blue straggler star hosting a brown dwarf companion in an extraordinarily compact binary system.

Blue Straggler Stars are hot, blue, massive stars that seem to have a different trajectory of evolution from the norm.

These are a class of stars observed in old, dense stellar systems such as globular clusters.

Q18. The SMILE mission is a joint mission between:

- (a) National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

- (b) European Space Agency (ESA) and Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS)
- (c) Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) and Roscosmos State Corporation for Space Activities
- (d) China National Space Administration (CNSA) and SpaceX

Answer: (b) — European Space Agency (ESA) and Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS)

Explanation: The European Space Agency (ESA) and the Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS) successfully launched their first-ever fully joint space mission, the Solar wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer (SMILE). SMILE is a pioneering, multi-wavelength space exploration mission designed to observe the global interaction between Earth's protective magnetic shield (the magnetosphere) and the highly charged plasma streamed by the Sun (the solar wind).

Q19. Project Garud is associated with which startup?

- (a) Skyroot Aerospace
- (b) Pixxel
- (c) Dhruva Space
- (d) Agnikul Cosmos

Answer: (c) — Dhruva Space

Explanation: Hyderabad-based Dhruva Space recently secured ₹105 crore under the Research, Development & Innovation Fund (RDIF) to power 'Project Garud', a major step towards strengthening India's private-sector satellite capabilities.

It is a satellite platform programme launched by Hyderabad-based space startup Dhruva Space.

It is focused on developing a flat-pack 500 kg-class satellite platform designed for scalable and high-volume manufacturing.

Q20. Semaglutide is primarily used for the treatment of:

- (a) Type 1 diabetes
- (b) Hypertension
- (c) Type 2 diabetes
- (d) Tuberculosis

Answer: (c) — Type 2 diabetes

Explanation: Dr Reddy's Laboratories recently has launched its generic version of Semaglutide injection used in treatment of type 2 diabetes in Canada.

Semaglutide is a prescription medication used primarily to treat type 2 diabetes.

Type 2 diabetes is a common condition that causes the level of glucose (sugar) in the blood to become too high.

Q21. "Index" is a platform launched by Parallel Web Systems to help:

- (a) Online gamers improve performance
- (b) Users trade cryptocurrencies using AI
- (c) Companies manage cybersecurity threats
- (d) Content creators and publishers

Answer: (d) — Content creators and publishers

Explanation: Parallel Web Systems, the startup founded by former Twitter chief executive Parag Agrawal, launched Index.

Index is a platform for content creators and publishers to receive compensation when artificial intelligence systems use their work.

Science & Technology

Q22. 5G Network Slicing refers to:

- (a) Division of radio spectrum into frequency bands
- (b) Creation of multiple virtual networks on a single physical 5G network
- (c) Splitting a telecom company into multiple operators
- (d) Sharing towers among telecom providers

Answer: (b) — Creation of multiple virtual networks on a single physical 5G network

Explanation: 5G Network Slicing is an architecture that allows a telecom operator to divide a single physical standalone 5G network into multiple, isolated virtual networks (or slices).

Each slice acts as an independent end-to-end network customized to meet the specific quality-of-service (QoS) requirements of a particular application, service, or user group.

Q23. Under the Sakura Science Programme, selected Indian students will visit:

- (a) South Korea
- (b) Singapore
- (c) Japan
- (d) Germany

Answer: (c) — Japan

Explanation: The Department of School Education & Literacy (DoSEL), Ministry of Education, flagged off a contingent of 56 Indian school students to visit Japan.

Originally launched as the Japan-Asia Youth Exchange Program in Science, the Sakura Science Programme is an international youth exchange initiative funded and implemented by the Japan Science and Technology Agency (JST).

It invites bright young minds to Japan for short-term visits to experience its cutting-edge scientific ecosystem.

Q24. The A2000, recently in the news, is:

- (a) A supercomputer developed by C-DAC
- (b) An AI system-on-chip developed by NetraSemi
- (c) A semiconductor fabrication plant
- (d) A quantum computing processor

Answer: (b) — An AI system-on-chip developed by NetraSemi

Explanation: Kerala-based fabless semiconductor startup Netrasemi launched its flagship AI system-on-chip, the A2000,

The A2000 is designed in India and uses TSMC's 12 nm process node for edge devices such as smart cameras, edge AI boxes, and intelligent video gateways.

Environment

Q1. The High Spatial Resolution Rainfall Forecast (UP Pilot) is derived from which weather model?

- (a) Global Forecast System (GFS) Model
- (b) Mithuna Weather Model
- (c) Weather Research and Forecasting (WRF) Model
- (d) Indian National Satellite (INSAT) Model

Answer: (b) — Mithuna Weather Model

Explanation: Union Minister launched two path-breaking AI-enabled weather forecasting products developed by the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

High Spatial Resolution Rainfall Forecast (UP Pilot)

System Name: Derived from the Mithuna weather model.

Provides an unprecedented 1-km spatial resolution rainfall forecast (downscaled from the standard 12.5-km resolution).

Q2. Megapode Sanctuary is located on:

- (a) Havelock Island
- (b) Menchal Island
- (c) Little Andaman
- (d) Car Nicobar

Answer: (b) — Menchal Island

Explanation: Megapode Sanctuary (Menchal Island):

Established to conserve the Nicobar Megapode, a unique bird that builds large mounds to incubate its eggs.

For the locals, Menchal is a sacred site believed to be the dwelling place of ancestral spirits, and they fear sanctuary status will bar them from spiritual practices.

Q3. The 'Lion' Species Spotlight Programme was inaugurated at which national park?

- (a) Ranthambore National Park
- (b) Kaziranga National Park
- (c) Gir National Park
- (d) Bandipur National Park

Answer: (c) — Gir National Park

Explanation: Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav inaugurated the 'Lion' Species Spotlight Programme at Gir National Park in Sasan Gir, Gujarat, as part of the pre-summit events leading up to the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026.

The lion population in the Greater Gir Landscape has risen to an estimated 891 individuals in 2025, dignitaries launched a 'Lion Conservation Brochure', while educational films and presentations on big cat conservation

Q4. Mayoore and Paneer Rose are newly developed varieties of:

- (a) Lotus
- (b) Lily
- (c) Rose
- (d) Orchid

Answer: (a) — Lotus

Explanation: A couple of new lotus varieties developed -- Mayoore and Paneer Rose -- have now received registration from the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority of the Government of India.

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding Kuno National Park: It was declared a national park in 2018. It was identified as a relocation site under the Asiatic Lion Reintroduction Project. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister will release two cheetahs into the wild at Kuno National Park.

It is located in the Sheopur district of Madhya Pradesh.

It is nestled near the Vindhyan Hills.

Originally established as Kuno Wildlife Sanctuary in 1981, it was upgraded to a national park in 2018.

The park's historical significance lies in its role as a relocation site for Asiatic lions under the "Asiatic Lion Reintroduction Project,".

Q6. India's first mangrove park, set to be named after former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, has been constructed at:

- (a) Navi Mumbai
- (b) Gorai
- (c) Alibaug
- (d) Versova

Answer: (b) — Gorai

Explanation: India's first mangrove park, which has been constructed at Gorai in Mumbai's western suburbs and has been awaiting opening for nearly a year, is set to be named after former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.

Q7. ANEEL fuel is primarily based on:

- (a) Thorium
- (b) Plutonium
- (c) Graphite
- (d) Lithium

Answer: (a) — Thorium

Explanation: — ANEEL is a new type of fuel that blends thorium with HALEU (high-assay low-enriched uranium) which is an important step towards the third leg of India's 3-stage nuclear programme.

— STAGE 3 of nuclear programme: The third stage will be based on the ThU233 cycle. U233 produced in the second stage can be used for the third stage of the power programme, which consists of advanced thermal and fast breeder reactors, for long-term energy security.

Q8. The White-Bellied Heron, recently seen in the news, is classified as:

- (a) Critically Endangered
- (b) Endangered
- (c) Vulnerable
- (d) Near Threatened

Answer: (a) — Critically Endangered

Explanation: A THDC India Ltd proposal seeking clearance for the Kalai-II hydroelectric project in Arunachal Pradesh does not make any mention of the habitat of the critically endangered White-Bellied Heron.

— Lohit River is a habitat for the critically endangered White-Bellied Heron, which has been accorded Scheduled-I status, the highest protection, under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.

Q9. . D'Ering Memorial Wildlife Sanctuary is especially known for its:

- (a) Mangrove ecosystem
- (b) Cold desert ecosystem
- (c) Riverine island ecosystem
- (d) Coral reef ecosystem

Answer: (c) — Riverine island ecosystem

Explanation: For the first time in nearly two decades, a tiger has been captured by camera traps in Arunachal Pradesh's D'Ering Memorial Wildlife Sanctuary. The D'Ering Memorial Wildlife Sanctuary is a unique protected area spanning 190 sq. km. It is renowned for its riverine island ecosystem, characterized by vast alluvial grasslands that provide a critical habitat for a variety of rare, threatened, and endangered species.

Q10. Western Disturbances generally originate over the:

- (a) Arabian Sea
- (b) Bay of Bengal
- (c) Mediterranean Sea
- (d) Black Sea

Answer: (c) — Mediterranean Sea

Explanation: Northwest India is enjoying a brief respite from rain and thunderstorms after the latest Western Disturbance weakened and moved eastward.

They are extratropical storm systems that form over the Mediterranean Sea and travel eastwards towards the Indian subcontinent.

They carry moisture-laden air and interact with the subtropical jet stream, influencing weather conditions over vast regions, including parts of Pakistan, India, Nepal, and Bangladesh.

Q11. Morchella mushroom belongs to which group?

- (a) Basidiomycota
- (b) Bryophyta
- (c) Ascomycota
- (d) Pteridophyta

Answer: (c) — Ascomycota

Explanation: Morchella Mushroom

It is an edible mushroom from the Ascomycota group.

Morels or Morchella is locally known as Kangaech or Guccchi mushroom.

It grows naturally in specific high elevation forest ecosystems during a narrow rainy season.

Q12. The Timor Green Pigeon is currently classified under which category of the International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List?

- (a) Vulnerable
- (b) Near Threatened
- (c) Critically Endangered
- (d) Endangered

Answer: (d) — Endangered

Explanation: The Timor Green Pigeon (*Treron psittaceus*) is an endemic bird species of Timor Island and nearby islands such as Rote, Sema, Atauro and Jaco.

The Timor Green Pigeon is endemic to Timor Island and a few adjacent islands in the Lesser Sunda region.

The Timor Green Pigeon is currently listed as Endangered on the IUCN Red List.

Q13. What is the IUCN conservation status of the rusty-spotted cat?

- (a) Endangered
- (b) Vulnerable
- (c) Near Threatened

(d) Least Concern

Answer: (c) — Near Threatened

Explanation: Recently, for the first time in Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR) and Haryana, a rusty-spotted cat has been photographed.

Habitat: It prefers moist and dry deciduous forests, scrublands, grasslands, and rocky areas.

IUCN: Near Threatened

Q14. What is the IUCN conservation status of the forest owl?

- (a) Endangered
- (b) Near Threatened
- (c) Vulnerable
- (d) Critically Endangered

Answer: (a) — Endangered

Explanation: Recently, in Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh forest owl has been spotted 113 years after it was last seen.

It is a member of the typical owl family, Strigidae.

Conservation Status

IUCN Red List: Endangered

CITES: Appendix I.

Q15. Baksa honey, recently seen in the news, is produced in which state?

- (a) Nagaland
- (b) Meghalaya
- (c) Assam
- (d) Tripura

Answer: (c) — Assam

Explanation: .

Baksa honey is a premium, near-organic honey variety produced in the Baksa district of Assam (part of the Bodoland Territorial Region).

It has been identified as the signature product of the district under the One District One Product (ODOP) initiative due to its traditional significance and export potential.

Q16. The ideal soil pH range for litchi cultivation is:

- (a) 2.0–4.0
- (b) 5.0–7.0
- (c) 7.5–9.0
- (d) 9.0–11.0

Answer: (b) — 5.0–7.0

Explanation: Recently, the Union Agriculture Ministry constituted a special expert task force to study the damage caused to litchi crops by the litchi stink bug.

It is a sub-tropical fruit and thrives best under moist sub-tropical climate.

Soil: Deep, well drained loamy soil, rich in organic matter and having pH in the range of 5.0 to 7.0 is ideal for the crop.

Q17. Which of the following materials are generally used in the preparation of Fermented Organic Manure? Animal manure Crop residues Kitchen scraps Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: About Fermented Organic Manure
It is a type of organic fertilizer produced through a controlled fermentation process of organic materials like manure, crop residues, and compost.
It is a byproduct of operational biogas or compressed biogas (CBG) plants used as a fertilizer.

Q18. Pyrolysis is a:

- (a) Biological decomposition process
- (b) Thermochemical conversion method
- (c) Mechanical recycling method
- (d) Electrochemical process

Answer: (b) — Thermochemical conversion method

Explanation: Pyrolysis is a thermochemical conversion method that breaks down organic material at high temperatures without combustion.
In the case of waste tyres, the process generally produces tyre pyrolysis oil, recovered carbon black, steel wire, and pyro-gas.
The process is used in waste management and material recovery for used tyres.

Q19. The Peacock Tarantula is most likely to be found in:

- (a) Mangrove swamps of eastern India
- (b) Tropical deciduous forests of peninsular India
- (c) Himalayan alpine forests
- (d) Thar desert

Answer: (b) — Tropical deciduous forests of peninsular India

Explanation: The Andhra Pradesh Forest Department, in collaboration with the Eastern Ghats Wildlife Society, has initiated a conservation status survey of the Peacock Tarantula (*Poecilotheria metallica*) in the vast landscape of the Nagarjunasagar Srisailem Tiger Reserve (NSTR).
The genus *Poecilotheria* belongs to the family Theraphosidae and is made up of arboreal species of spiders, which are known to occur in India and Sri Lanka.
Peacock Tarantula is found predominantly in the deciduous forests of central and southern India.

Q20. Consider the following statements regarding Canine Distemper Virus (CDV): It is caused by a single-stranded RNA virus. It affects only the respiratory system. Which of the above statement/s is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Canine Distemper Virus is a highly contagious and potentially fatal viral disease caused by a single-stranded RNA virus of the Paramyxoviridae family (the same family as measles and mumps).
It is a multi-systemic disease, meaning it attacks the respiratory, gastrointestinal, and central nervous systems of a wide variety of mammals.

Q21. The Integrated Alert System (SACHET) has been developed by:

- (a) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

- (b) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (c) Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)
- (d) National Informatics Centre (NIC)

Answer: (c) — Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)

Explanation: NDMA has successfully operationalised the Integrated Alert System (SACHET), created by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), which is the leading research and development centre under the Department of Telecommunications.

The system is based on the Common Alerting Protocol (CAP) as recommended by the UN body International Telecommunication Union.

It is currently operational across all 36 States and Union Territories of India and delivers disaster and emergency-related alerts via SMS to mobile users within geo-targeted areas.

Q22. Consider the following statements regarding the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation: It is driven primarily by differences in temperature and salinity of ocean water. It is largely confined to the upper layers of the ocean and does not involve deep-water currents. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: The Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation (AMOC) is a vast system of ocean currents that acts as a massive, invisible conveyor belt for the planet.
It is a critical component of Earth's climate system, responsible for moving heat and regulating temperatures across the globe.

The circulation is driven by differences in water temperature and salt levels (density):

Surface Flow: Warm, salty water from the tropics flows north toward Greenland.

Cooling and Sinking: As it reaches the Arctic, the water cools, becomes denser, and sinks several kilometers into the deep ocean.

This cold water drifts back south as a deep-water current.

Rising: Eventually, the water rises back to the surface to warm up and restart the thousand-year loop.

Q23. Caracal is a:

- (a) Large bear species
- (b) Medium-sized wild cat species
- (c) Marine mammal
- (d) Mountain goat species

Answer: (b) — Medium-sized wild cat species

Explanation: Recently, officials have confirmed the return of the rare caracal in the Thar Desert near the India-Pakistan border.

It is an elusive medium-sized wild cat species.

It is often referred to as the desert lynx; however, they are more closely related to the African golden cat and the Serval.

In India, it is called siya gosh, a Persian name that translates as 'black Ear'.

Q24. Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve has corridor linkages with: Nagzira-Navegaon Tiger Reserve Pench Tiger Reserve Bandipur Tiger Reserve Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: The Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve (TATR) in Maharashtra's Chandrapur district unveiled vibrant wildlife statistics during its annual 'Machan Census on Waterholes'. It is located in the Chandrapur district in Maharashtra. It has corridor linkages with Nagzira-Navegaon and Pench Tiger Reserves within the State.

Q25. Which country will host the 1st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026?

- (a) India
- (b) South Africa
- (c) Brazil
- (d) Kenya

Answer: (a) — India

Explanation: Union Environment Minister launched the official website and logo for the 1st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026 in New Delhi.

The IBCA is a first-of-its-kind inter-government international organisation and multi-agency coalition.

It serves as a global platform uniting 95 big cat range countries, conservation partners, scientific organisations, and business groups to address conservation challenges through cooperation and knowledge sharing.

Q26. Mount Dukono is located in:

- (a) Philippines
- (b) Indonesia
- (c) Japan
- (d) Papua New Guinea

Answer: (b) — Indonesia

Explanation: Mount Dukono in eastern Indonesia erupted recently, sending an ash column up to 1,400 meters above its summit.

It is an active volcano located on Halmahera Island in North Maluku, Indonesia.

It is a complex volcano presenting a broad, low profile with multiple summit peaks and overlapping craters.

Q27. The conservation status of the Amur Falcon under the IUCN Red List is:

- (a) Near Threatened
- (b) Vulnerable
- (c) Endangered
- (d) Least Concern

Answer: (d) — Least Concern

Explanation: Two of the three Amur falcons, which were satellite-tagged in Manipur's Tamenglong district in November 2025, are returning to their breeding grounds in

the Far East through India, after migrating to the warmer southern Africa region during the winter.

It is classified as 'Least Concern' under the IUCN Red List.

Q28. The conservation status of the Ganges soft-shell turtle under the IUCN Red List is:

- (a) Vulnerable
- (b) Near Threatened
- (c) Endangered
- (d) Critically Endangered

Answer: (c) — Endangered

Explanation: India's first satellite-tagged Ganges soft-shell turtle was released into its natural habitat along the northern bank of the Brahmaputra River inside Assam's Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve.

The Ganges soft-shell turtle (*Nilssoniana gangetica*), also known as the Indian softshell turtle, is a large, highly aquatic freshwater reptile belonging to the family Trionychidae. IUCN Red List: Endangered.

Q29. Dhriti Banerjee, after whom the newly discovered leopard gecko species *Eublepharis jhuma* was named, is known for becoming the first female director of which organisation?

- (a) Zoological Survey of India
- (b) Botanical Survey of India
- (c) Wildlife Institute of India
- (d) Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education

Answer: (a) — Zoological Survey of India

Explanation: Scientists from the Zoological Survey of India recently discovered a new species of leopard gecko named *Eublepharis jhuma* from the rocky hills of Bihar, India.

It is a new species of leopard gecko.

It was discovered during a wildlife survey on the outskirts of the Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary, Bihar.

Q30. *Sonerila roxburghii* has been placed under which conservation category?

- (a) Vulnerable
- (b) Endangered
- (c) Critically Endangered
- (d) Near Threatened

Answer: (c) — Critically Endangered

Explanation: Researchers recently identified a new species of flowering plant named *Sonerila roxburghii* from the ecologically sensitive Western Ghats in Kerala.

It was discovered in the Mankulam and Kallar areas of the Idukki district of Kerala, at elevations ranging between 1,380 and 1,480 metres above sea level.

It has been placed in the Critically Endangered category.

Q31. Which of the following characteristics are associated with "Andhi"? Sudden drop in temperature Blinding dust clouds Torrential rain and lightning Formation over oceanic waters only Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b) — 1, 2 and 3 only

Explanation: Andhi is the meteorological term for intense, convective dust storms or thunderstorms that occur predominantly during the pre-monsoon season in Northern India.

These severe atmospheric disturbances are characterized by a sudden drop in temperature, blinding dust clouds, torrential rain, violent lightning.

Q32. Barda Wildlife Sanctuary is being developed as a second habitat for the:

- (a) Bengal tiger
- (b) Snow leopard
- (c) Asiatic lion
- (d) Indian rhinoceros

Answer: (c) — Asiatic lion

Explanation: Barda Wildlife Sanctuary is being developed as a crucial second habitat for Asiatic lions to reduce the extinction risk posed by keeping the world's entire wild lion population confined to Gir Forest alone.

It is located in the Barda Hills of Gujarat, near the coastal city of Porbandar.

Known locally as Jam Barda, it was once a private hunting ground for the royal families of Jamnagar and Porbandar.

Q33. The main objective of Operation Gajamukhi is to:

- (a) Increase elephant tourism
- (b) Relocate tribal communities
- (c) Guide wild elephants back to their natural habitat
- (d) Establish new wildlife sanctuaries

Answer: (c) — Guide wild elephants back to their natural habitat

Explanation: Operation Gajamukhi is an ongoing, multi-phase wildlife management initiative executed by the Kerala Forest Department to mitigate human-elephant conflict at Aralam Farm and its adjoining tribal rehabilitation areas in Kannur, Kerala.

The primary goal of the mission is to safely drive wild elephants away from human settlements and agricultural zones and guide them back into their natural habitat inside the Aralam Wildlife Sanctuary.

Q34. Consider the following statements regarding ammonium sulphate: It is highly water-soluble. It contains sulphur in active sulphate form. Its nutrient effect remains effective for several years in soil. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Ammonium sulphate is an inorganic, water-soluble chemical mineral fertilizer containing two crucial plant macronutrients: 21% Nitrogen (in the readily available ammonium form) and 24% Sulphur (as active sulphate).

It is historically used in alkaline soils to provide immediate nourishment and to lower the soil's pH baseline.

Continuous or excessive application increases soil acidity significantly, requiring higher lime treatment to maintain long-term soil fertility and productivity.

Q35. Pulicat Lake sprawls across which two states?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh and Odisha
- (b) Tamil Nadu and Kerala
- (c) Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu
- (d) Karnataka and Tamil Nadu

Answer: (c) — Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu

Explanation: A historic Pulicat Lake draws birders and photographers from across South India who visit the lake to see the graceful flamingo in still waters.

It is the second largest brackish water lagoon in India after Chilika, sprawling across Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

It was designated as a Ramsar site in 2002.

Q36. Trachischium lairensangai is a newly discovered species of:

- (a) snake
- (b) Lizard
- (c) Frog
- (d) Turtle

Answer: (a) — snake

Explanation: Trachischium lairensangai is a new worm-eating snake species described in the journal Herpetozoa on 19 May 2026.

The researchers named their find after Hmar Tlawmte Lalremsanga, a professor of Zoology at Mizoram University, for his "remarkable contributions to herpetology in India", mentoring students, and fostering research collaborations within the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot.

Q37. Gangul Siyabehi Wildlife Sanctuary, recently seen in the news, is located in:

- (a) Uttarakhand
- (b) Jammu & Kashmir
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Sikkim

Answer: (c) — Himachal Pradesh

Explanation: Recently, a rare Himalayan Brown Bear (*Ursus arctos isabellinus*) has been captured on camera inside the Gangul Siyabehi Wildlife Sanctuary in Chamba of Himachal Pradesh.

It is nestled in the catchment of Siul nala (a tributary of Ravi River).

It is adjoined at the northern end by the union territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

Q38. Raipur has recently emerged as a national model for urban water conservation under which initiative?

- (a) Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari
- (b) Atal Bhujal Yojana
- (c) Jal Jeevan Mission
- (d) AMRUT 2.0

Answer: (a) — Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari

Explanation: Raipur has emerged as a national model for urban water conservation under the Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari (JSJB) initiative, creating nearly 32,000 rainwater harvesting and groundwater recharge structures.

Aim: To improve groundwater recharge and reduce urban water stress caused by rapid urbanisation and excessive groundwater extraction.

To transform Raipur into a climate-resilient Sponge City capable of conserving and reusing rainwater efficiently.

Includes pond interlinking, Kharun River Eco Bloc projects, and treated wastewater reuse for industrial purposes.

Index / Rankings / Reports

Q1. Which city has been ranked as the world's fastest-growing major city through 2035 in the Growth Hubs Index published by Savills?

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Hyderabad
- (d) Bengaluru

Answer: (d) — Bengaluru

Explanation: Bengaluru has been ranked the world's fastest-growing major city through 2035 in Savills' Growth Hubs Index, which is part of the firm's Resilient Cities research programme. The index assessed 245 cities globally using projected GDP growth to 2035, personal wealth expansion, demographic trends, inward migration, and the number of high-income households.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding the World Press Freedom Index 2026: India ranked 157th in the index. India improved its ranking compared to 2025. Norway ranked first. Eritrea ranked last. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a) — 1, 3 and 4 only

Explanation: India ranked 157th out of 180 countries in the 2026 World Press Freedom Index released by Reporters Without Borders (RSF).

Reporters Without Borders is a Paris-based organisation that publishes the World Press Freedom Index every year.

The ranking placed India in the "very serious" category for press freedom, and India fell six places from its 2025 rank of 151.

Top 5: Norway (1st for the 10th consecutive year), Netherlands, Estonia, Denmark, and Sweden.

Bottom 5: Eritrea (180th), North Korea, China, Iran, and Saudi Arabia.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding the QS Executive MBA Rankings 2026: IIM Bangalore is the highest-ranked Indian institution and is ranked globally at 35. IIM Ranchi entered the QS Executive MBA Rankings 2026 for the first time. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: The Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Bangalore has ranked the highest among Indian institutions in the QS Executive MBA rankings 2026, but recorded a sharp fall of 14 ranks compared to the previous year.

IIM Bangalore ranked 64th globally this year, the institute's lowest rank so far. It is, however, the only Indian institute in the top 100.

IIM Bangalore's descent has been steady over the last four years.

IIM Ranchi has made the rankings as a new entrant this year, at 201+.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) crime data 2024: Delhi recorded the highest number of crimes against senior citizens among metropolitan cities. Bengaluru reported the highest number of child abduction cases among metropolitan cities. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a) — 1 only

Explanation: Data released by the National Crime Records Bureau for 2024 showed a notable decline in the number of crimes registered in Delhi, even as several categories of violent and targeted offences continued to raise serious concerns for law enforcement agencies.

Delhi reported the highest number of such crimes, far ahead of other metropolitan cities such as Chennai (466), Bengaluru (386), Hyderabad (316), and Ahmedabad (295).

The data was particularly concerning in relation to crimes against children, where Delhi continued to report the highest numbers among major metropolitan cities.

Q5. According to the Global Forest Goals Report 2026, which region recorded the largest decline in primary forests between 2015 and 2025?

- (a) Europe
- (b) Africa
- (c) North America
- (d) South America

Answer: (d) — South America

Explanation: A new United Nations assessment titled Global Forest Goals Report 2026 warned that rising demand for fuelwood and charcoal has emerged as a major driver of global forest degradation, particularly in Africa and parts of Asia.

Key Findings in the Report:

Forest cover declined from 4.18 billion hectares (2015) to 4.14 billion hectares (2025), with a net annual loss of 4.12 million hectares.

The world lost nearly 16 million hectares of primary forests between 2015–2025, with South America recording the largest decline.

Q6. Consider the following statements regarding LEADS 2025: West Bengal was categorized as a High Performer among Coastal States. Madhya Pradesh was categorized as an Accelerator among Landlocked States. Arunachal Pradesh was categorized as an Accelerator among North-Eastern States. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 2 and 3 only

Explanation: Union Minister of India released the LEADS 2025 Report and felicitated the winners of the LEAPS 2025 Awards in New Delhi.

Tier

Definition

Top Examples (LEADS 2025)

Exemplars

The Gold Standard performers. States demonstrating sustained excellence across policy, infrastructure, and regulatory dimensions.

Coastal States: Tamil Nadu

Landlocked States: Uttar Pradesh

North- Eastern States: Mizoram

Union Territories: Delhi

High Performers

States that demonstrate strong and consistent outcomes across the majority of performance indicators.

Coastal States: Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra

Landlocked States: Haryana, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar

North- Eastern States: Tripura, Meghalaya

Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir, Puducherry

Accelerators

States showing notable improvement momentum and a very clear reform-oriented trajectory in recent years.

Coastal States: Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Goa, Karnataka

Landlocked States: Punjab, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh

North- Eastern States: Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Assam

Union Territories: Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Chandigarh, Ladakh, Lakshadweep

Q7. Consider the following statements regarding the NITI Aayog report on school education: Government schools account for over two-thirds of all schools in India. Internet access in schools rose from 10.05% (2014-15) to 25.5% (2024-25). Secondary dropout rate is higher than the primary dropout rate. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c) — 1 and 3 only

Explanation: NITI Aayog has released a comprehensive policy report analyzing a decade of India's school education system (2014-15 to 2024-25).

The report provides a strategic roadmap to enhance quality and equity as India moves toward its Viksit Bharat @2047 vision

Key Data/Stats on School Education:

India manages the world's largest school system with 14.71 lakh schools serving over 24.69 crore students.

The system is supported by a workforce of over 1.01 crore teachers.

While elementary enrolment is near universal, the national Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) for higher secondary stands at 58.4%.

Government schools account for 68.1% of all schools and serve 49.2% of the total student population.

Q8. The report titled "Invisible Barriers: The Costs of Non-Tariff Measures" was released by:

- (a) World Trade Organization (WTO)
- (b) International Monetary Fund (IMF)
- (c) United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)
- (d) World Bank

Answer: (c) — United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)

Explanation: UN Trade and Development (UNCTAD) in its 'Invisible Barriers: The Costs of Non-Tariff Measures' Report highlights that global trade is increasingly being shaped by regulatory restrictions, technical standards and geopolitical trade interventions.

Q9. India recently became the world's _____ largest country in installed renewable energy capacity.

- (a) 2nd
- (b) 3rd
- (c) 4th
- (d) 5th

Answer: (b) — 3rd

Explanation: India has emerged as the world's 3rd largest country in installed renewable energy capacity, reflecting rapid growth in solar and wind power generation.

A recent Morgan Stanley report highlighted that India's renewable energy transition is accelerating, though dependence on imported upstream solar components remains a challenge.

Q10. Which organisation released the report titled Sand and Sustainability: An Essential Resource for Nature and Development?

- (a) United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
- (b) United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
- (c) United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)
- (d) Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)

Answer: (b) — United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

Explanation: The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) released a landmark report titled Sand and Sustainability: An Essential Resource for Nature and Development.

Sand mining is the extraction of sand from various sources, including riverbeds, beaches, and the seabed, primarily for use in construction, land reclamation, and manufacturing. The report emphasizes that sand is the most extracted solid material on Earth, second only to water in terms of global consumption.

International

Q11. . Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Their Majesties Willem-Alexander and Máxima during his visit to:

- (a) Belgium
- (b) Denmark
- (c) Netherlands
- (d) Sweden

Answer: (c) — Netherlands

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi called on Their Majesties Willem-Alexander and Máxima at Palace Huis ten Bosch in The Hague during his visit to the Netherlands.

PM Modi arrived in The Hague on May 15 as part of his ongoing multi-nation European tour, which also includes visits to Sweden, Norway and Italy.

PM Modi landed at Amsterdam Airport

Indian Ambassador to the Netherlands Kumar Tuhin

Q12. The Afsluitdijk water management structure is located in which country?

- (a) Kingdom of Denmark
- (b) Federal Republic of Germany
- (c) Kingdom of the Netherlands
- (d) Kingdom of Belgium

Answer: (c) — Kingdom of the Netherlands

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited the iconic Afsluitdijk water management structure in the Netherlands along with Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten, underlining growing cooperation between the two countries in water management, climate resilience and sustainable infrastructure.

The Afsluitdijk, a 32-kilometre-long dam and causeway, is regarded globally as a benchmark project in flood control and land reclamation.

Q13. India's proposed Kalpasar Project is planned in:

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Maharashtra
- (d) Odisha

Answer: (a) — Gujarat

Explanation: The Kalpasar project aims to create a large freshwater reservoir across the Gulf of Khambhat while integrating tidal power generation, irrigation and transport infrastructure.

During PM Modi's visit, India and the Netherlands welcomed the signing of a Letter of Intent between India's Ministry of Jal Shakti and the Dutch Ministry of Infrastructure and Water Management for technical cooperation on the Kalpasar project.

Q14. Which of the following statements regarding the Anaimangalam Plates is/are correct? They contain inscriptions in Sanskrit and Tamil. The inscriptions deal with the genealogy of the Chola dynasty. They were currently in the possession of Leiden University in Germany. Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Chola-era plates, currently in the possession of Leiden University in the Netherlands, has been returned to India.

The plates, also known as the Anaimangalam Plates, were lost around 300 years ago and have reportedly been in the possession of the university since 1862.

They are considered important sources of royal charters in south India and provide valuable historical information

about the relationship between the Chola and Srivijaya Empires.

The charters typically open with an elaborate genealogy of the Chola kings written in Sanskrit (using the Grantha script), followed by the minute operational details of the land grant written in Tamil.

Q15. ADNOC, seen in the news, is the national oil company of:

- (a) Saudi Arabia
- (b) Qatar
- (c) United Arab Emirates
- (d) Kuwait

Answer: (c) — United Arab Emirates

Explanation: Prime Minister of India made a landmark diplomatic stopover in Abu Dhabi, holding wide-ranging talks with UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan.

The bilateral engagement represents an escalation of the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership into the realms of critical defense manufacturing, financial system integration, and advanced technology.

ADNOC and the Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Ltd. concluded an accord to enhance the UAE's participation in India's SPR by storing up to 30 million barrels of crude oil.

Q16. The 'Aronai' is traditionally:

- (a) A bamboo craft item
- (b) A musical instrument
- (c) A small woven cloth/scarf
- (d) A traditional cap

Answer: (c) — A small woven cloth/scarf

Explanation: PM Modi wore the traditional Bodo 'Aronai' scarf in The Hague, showcasing Assam's handloom heritage on a global platform.

Bodo Aronai': It is a small, beautiful cloth (1.5-2.5 meters long and 0.5 meter wide) – Assam GI Tag

Q17. The Nordic region consists of which of the following countries?

- (a) Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Finland and Iceland
- (b) Norway, Germany, Denmark, Finland and Iceland
- (c) Sweden, Finland, Poland, Norway and Iceland
- (d) Denmark, Estonia, Latvia, Finland and Sweden

Answer: (a) — Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Finland and Iceland

Explanation: The Prime Minister reached Norway for the 3rd India-Nordic Summit 2026

In the fourth leg of his visit, the Prime Minister reached Norway for the 3rd India-Nordic Summit and bilateral engagements.

The Nordic countries, also known as the Nordic region, are a group of countries in northern Europe consisting of Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, and Sweden.

The designation includes the Faroe Islands and Greenland, which are autonomous island regions of Denmark, and the Åland Islands, an autonomous island region of Finland.

Q18. Which country will provide a payload for India's upcoming Venus Orbiter Mission, Shukrayaan-1?

- (a) France
- (b) Germany

- (c) Sweden
- (d) Japan

Answer: (c) — Sweden

Explanation: Prime Minister of India co-chaired the 3rd India-Nordic Summit in Oslo, Norway (host), alongside the heads of government from Denmark, Norway, Finland, Iceland, and Sweden.

Building upon previous iterations in Stockholm (2018) and Copenhagen (2022), this forum aligns India's massive market scale and human talent with the Nordic region's pioneering strengths in clean energy, maritime technologies, and deep-tech innovation.

Announced a new Framework Agreement between ISRO and the Norwegian Space Agency, as well as a confirmed Swedish payload for India's upcoming Venus Orbiter Mission (Shukrayaan 1).

Q19. India and Italy announced that _____ will be observed as the "Year of Culture and Tourism" between the two countries.

- (a) 2025
- (b) 2026
- (c) 2027
- (d) 2030

Answer: (c) — 2027

Explanation: India and Italy will work towards further developing the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) and announced that 2027 will be observed as the "Year of Culture and Tourism" between the two countries.

Q20. Giampaolo Tomassetti, who was recently seen in news, is related to which profession?

- (a) Scientist
- (b) Artist
- (c) Diplomat
- (d) Economist

Answer: (b) — Artist

Explanation: Italian artist Giampaolo Tomassetti presented Prime Minister Narendra Modi with a painting on Varanasi during his visit to Italy

Tomassetti, who began illustrating books on Vedic culture in the 1980s, also worked on 23 large paintings related to the Mahabharata between 2008 and 2013.

Q21. Craft / Art Form State Gujarat Bihar Andhra Pradesh Punjab Consider the following pairs: Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a) — 1, 2 and 3 only

- (1) Rogan Painting
- (2) Madhubani Painting
- (3) Kalamkari
- (4) Blue Pottery

Explanation: Prime Minister Narendra Modi wrapped up his five-nation visit to the UAE, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway and Italy Netherlands

The Dutch king was gifted Blue pottery from Jaipur, Rajasthan, is a renowned, GI-tagged art .

It is crafted from a unique mixture of quartz powder, powdered glass and Fuller's earth, which gives it a striking, glass-like finish.

Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten's was presented with a Madhubani painting.

This painting is a GI-tagged folk art tradition from the Mithila region of India and Nepal, renowned for its intricate geometric patterns and vibrant colours.

Kalamkari is an ancient Indian art form known for its hand-painted or block-printed cotton textiles, created using natural dyes and intricate storytelling motifs.

Originating in Andhra Pradesh, it flourished in two distinct styles.

Rogan Painting with Tree of Life

Rogan painting is a rare and exquisite textile art form from the Kutch region of Gujarat, celebrated for its intricate craftsmanship and vibrant aesthetic tradition.

Q22. Consider the following statements regarding the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT): Under the treaty, all waters of the Eastern Rivers were allocated to Pakistan. Jhelum, Chenab and Indus are classified as Western Rivers. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: India has categorically rejected the recent "award" issued by the "illegally constituted" Court of Arbitration (CoA) concerning disputes with Pakistan under the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT).

Extent of Treaty: The Treaty extends to main rivers of Indus basin i.e. Sutlej, Beas, Ravi (Eastern rivers) and Jhelum, Chenab and Indus (Western rivers).

All the waters of the Eastern Rivers were allocated to India for her unrestricted use while India is under obligation to let flow all the waters of the Western Rivers, except for the domestic, non-consumptive and other uses permitted in the Treaty.

Q23. Which country is hosting the 68th Governing Body meeting of the Asian Productivity Organization (APO)?

- (a) India
- (b) Japan
- (c) Singapore
- (d) Thailand

Answer: (a) — India

Explanation: India is hosting the 68th Governing Body meeting of the Asian Productivity Organization in New Delhi, Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal is scheduled to attend the inaugural session

The three-day meeting, being held from May 20 to 22 at Bharat Mandapam, will see participation from more than 60 senior delegates representing 20 APO member economies,

Q24. Consider the following statements regarding Ebola: Ebola spreads through direct contact with bodily fluids of

infected persons. There is no universally known cure for Ebola. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) — Both 1 and 2

Explanation: Africa's top health agency has declared an Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo's eastern Ituri province.

The virus is transmitted to people from wild animals (such as fruit bats, porcupines, and non-human primates) and then spreads in the human population through direct contact with the blood, secretions, organs, or other bodily fluids of infected people and with surfaces and materials (e.g., bedding, clothing) contaminated with these fluids.

There is no known cure for Ebola.

Q25. Which ancient city was built along the Euphrates River?

- (a) Athens
- (b) Babylon
- (c) Rome
- (d) Alexandria

Answer: (b) — Babylon

Explanation: The Euphrates, one of the oldest and most storied rivers in human history, is disappearing.

The river originates in the Armenian Highlands of southeastern Turkey.

One of the ancient world's most important cities, Babylon, was built along the Euphrates.

Q26. COLDEX stands for:

- (a) Center for Oceanic Low-temperature Data Exploration
- (b) Center for Oldest Ice Exploration
- (c) Climate Observation Laboratory for Deep Exploration
- (d) Cryosphere Observation and Data Experiment

Answer: (b) — Center for Oldest Ice Exploration

Explanation: Scientists working in Antarctica have identified the oldest directly dated ice and air sample on Earth from the Allan Hills region of East Antarctica.

The Allan Hills site lies in East Antarctica, a region known for ancient blue ice exposures.

The discovery was made by a team affiliated with the National Science Foundation-funded Center for Oldest Ice Exploration, also known as COLDEX.

Q27. Rottnest Island, recently seen in the news, is located in:

- (a) Pacific Ocean
- (b) Atlantic Ocean
- (c) Indian Ocean
- (d) Arctic Ocean

Answer: (c) — Indian Ocean

Explanation: A 38-year-old man has died after a suspected shark attack near Rottnest Island recently, a popular tourist destination off the coast of Western Australia.

It is an Australian island in the Indian Ocean at western Australia.

Q28. According to the Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI) 2024-25, which port led the Liquid Bulk segment?

- (a) Paradip Port Authority (Odisha)

- (b) Cochin Port Authority (Kerala)
- (c) Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat)
- (d) Deendayal Port Authority (Gujarat)

Answer: (c) — Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat)

Explanation: Recently, the Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) launched the logistics port performance index (LPPI) for FY2024- 25 and 4 major digital initiatives.

Top Performers:

Paradip Port Authority (Odisha) topped the Dry Bulk category.

Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat) led the Liquid Bulk segment.

Mundra Port (Gujarat) emerged as the highest-ranked port in Container Cargo (with Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) (Maharashtra) securing the second position).

Q29. According to the State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026 Report, India ranks _____ among the world's most digitalized economies.

- (a) Third
- (b) Fourth
- (c) Fifth
- (d) Sixth

Answer: (c) — Fifth

Explanation: India has emerged as the world's fifth most digitalized economy and ranks fourth globally in AI performance, as reported by the ICRIER-Prosus Centre for Internet and Digital Economy (IPCIDE).

India surpasses Germany, France, Japan, the UK, and Canada in the AI race with 72% of global AI users now found in developing countries.

International

Q1. Consider the following statements regarding BHISHM

Cubes: They are permanently installed in hospitals for routine care. Each BHISHM Cube can handle only up to 20 emergency cases. 36 mini cubes together form one mother cube. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) — 3 only

Explanation: What is BHISHM?

Full form: Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog, Hita, and Maitri.

Purpose: Provides compact, mobile medical units for emergency care, designed to deliver medical facilities swiftly and effectively.

Compact and organised: Medical supplies and equipment are packed into 15-inch cubical boxes.

Each cube weighs up to 20 kg and is designed to be carried by an individual.

Mother and BHISHM cubes:

36 mini cubes combine to form one mother cube.

Two mother cubes combine to form one BHISHM Cube.

One Mother Cube offers first-line care, shelter, and food for up to five people for 48 hours.

Q2. The headquarters of CARICOM is located in:

- (a) Kingston, Jamaica
- (b) Port of Spain, Trinidad
- (c) Georgetown, Guyana
- (d) Bridgetown, Barbados

Answer: (c) — Georgetown, Guyana

Explanation: CARICOM, which stands for Caribbean Community, is the oldest surviving integration movement in the developing world.

It is an organization of Caribbean countries and dependencies originally established as the Caribbean Community and Commons Market in 1973 by the Treaty of Chaguaramas.

The permanent secretariat headquarter - Georgetown, Guyana.

Q3. "Project Freedom," recently seen in news, has been launched by which of the following?

- (a) United Nations
- (b) Iran
- (c) United States
- (d) European Union

Answer: (c) — United States

Explanation: The United States will launch an effort to "guide" stranded ships from the Iran-gripped Strait of Hormuz - "Project Freedom"

US will "help free up" ships stuck in the Strait of Hormuz, suggesting that his administration will break Iran's blockade of the strategic waterway.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the Korowai tribe: Cannibalism is a universally practiced cultural norm among them today. They are indigenous to Papua in Indonesia. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: Papua's Korowai tribe, often labelled 'cannibals', is re-examined as myths fade, revealing a misunderstood culture shaped by isolation, conflict, and historical misrepresentation.

The Korowai tribe is a group of indigenous people who live in the southeastern part of Papua, Indonesia.

They hunt and gather food from the forest, including wild animals and plants.

Q5. The Special 301 Report primarily evaluates:

- (a) Environmental standards
- (b) Intellectual Property (IP) rights protection
- (c) Military strength
- (d) Agricultural output

Answer: (b) — Intellectual Property (IP) rights protection

Explanation: What is the USTR Special 301 Report?

The USTR's Special 301 Report is an annual review that evaluates the adequacy and effectiveness of IP rights protection among US trading partners.

It categorises countries into three tiers: Priority Foreign Country (most severe), Priority Watch List, and Watch List.

The report serves as a policy tool to pressure countries to strengthen legal frameworks and enforcement mechanisms related to IP.

Q6. Consider the following statements regarding the Atacama Desert: It lies between the Andes Mountains and the Atlantic Ocean. It is bordered by Argentina, Peru, and Bolivia. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b) — 2 only

Explanation: About Atacama Desert

Location: It is the driest desert in the world, located in northern Chile.

It is nestled between the Andes Mountains on the east and the Pacific Ocean on the west.

It forms a continuous strip for nearly 1,000 km along the narrow coast of the northern third of Chile.

Bordered by: It is bordered by Argentina, Peru, and Bolivia. It also hosts 12 volcanoes, mainly located in the western outliers of the Andes.

Q7. Qom, recently seen in news, is located in:

- (a) Iran
- (b) Saudi Arabia
- (c) Iraq
- (d) Syria

Answer: (a) — Iran

Explanation: Qom is home to one of the largest Indian communities in Iran with over 3,000 to 3,500 nationals, many of them students enrolled in religious seminaries and universities.

It serves as a link between the central provinces of Iran and Tehran

Q8. Which country is hosting the Kimberley Process (KP) Intersessional Meeting 2026?

- (a) South Africa
- (b) Belgium
- (c) India
- (d) Botswana

Answer: (c) — India

Explanation: India commenced the Kimberley Process (KP) Intersessional Meeting in Mumbai as the Chair for the year. The Kimberley Process (KP) is a multi-stakeholder international initiative involving governments, the diamond industry, and civil society.

Q9. The Fourth India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS-IV) will be held from:

- (a) 15–18 May 2026
- (b) 20–24 May 2026
- (c) 28–31 May 2026
- (d) 1–4 June 2026

Answer: (c) — 28–31 May 2026

Explanation: India will host the Fourth India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS-IV) in New Delhi from 28 May to 31 May 2026. The summit will be held with the African Union Commission

and will bring together leaders and representatives from across the African continent.

The theme of IAFS-IV is "IA SPIRIT: India-Africa Strategic Partnership for Innovation, Resilience, and Inclusive Transformation."

Q10. Bill C-22, recently seen in the news, is related to which country?

- (a) Australia
- (b) Canada
- (c) United Kingdom
- (d) New Zealand

Answer: (b) — Canada

Explanation: Canada's Bill C-22, formally called the Supporting Authorized Access to Information Act (SAAIA), is a proposed law under debate in the House of Commons in 2026.

Bill C-22 is linked to lawful access powers in Canada and includes provisions on electronic service providers, metadata retention, and investigative powers.

Q11. The Yavarí-Tapiche Territorial Corridor is considered important because it is home to:

- (a) The world's largest coral reef system
- (b) The largest population of isolated Indigenous Peoples
- (c) The tallest tropical rainforest
- (d) The largest glacier in South America

Answer: (b) — The largest population of isolated Indigenous Peoples

Explanation: A new report revealed that the Yavarí-Tapiche Territorial Corridor—home to the world's largest population of isolated Indigenous Peoples—is under imminent threat from oil expansion, logging, and organized crime.

The Yavarí-Tapiche Territorial Corridor is a massive, proposed 16-million-hectare protected territory.

It is a global biodiversity stronghold and home to the largest population of Indigenous Peoples in Voluntary Isolation and Initial Contact (PIACI) in the western Amazon.

Q12. The theme of the 5th BRICS SAI Leaders' Summit is:

- (a) Digital Governance and Transparency
- (b) Sustainable Finance for Growth
- (c) Green Economy and Innovation
- (d) Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility

Answer: (d) — Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility

Explanation: The two-day 5th BRICS Supreme Audit Institutions (SAI) Leaders' Summit began in Bengaluru today under the theme "Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility".

Organised by the Office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India as part of India's BRICS Chairmanship 2026, the summit has brought together 42 delegates, including Heads of SAs from BRICS countries.

Q13. Which country recently announced that May 10 will be celebrated annually as "Marka-e-Haq Day"?

- (a) Bangladesh
- (b) Pakistan
- (c) Afghanistan
- (d) Iran

Answer: (b) — Pakistan

Explanation: Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif has announced that May 10 will be celebrated as 'Marka-e-Haq Day' annually.

To mark the first anniversary of 'Marka-e-Haq', the name given by Islamabad to last year's four-day conflict with India, Mr. Shehbaz also claimed that Pakistani armed forces gave a "historic and befitting response" to the enemy.

Q14. Recently, the "Catalogue of Solutions 2026–2029" was launched by which of the following organizations?

- (a) UNEP
- (b) UNDP
- (c) UN-Habitat
- (d) UNICEF

Answer: (c) — UN-Habitat

Explanation: Recently, United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat) launched the Catalogue of Solutions 2026-2029.

Q15. With reference to MERCOSUR, consider the following statements: It is a regional economic organization in South America. It was created through the Treaty of Asunción in 1991. India is a founding member of MERCOSUR. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) — 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Recently, India and Brazil agreed to significantly expand their existing trade agreement between India and the MERCOSUR bloc.

MERCOSUR Group

The Southern Common Market (MERCOSUR for its Spanish initials) is a South American regional economic organization. It is the fourth largest integrated market after the European Union (EU), North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA), and ASEAN.

It was created in 1991 by signing the Treaty of Asunción.

Q16. "From Shunya to Ananta", recently seen in news, is primarily related to:

- (a) Indian classical dance traditions
- (b) India's contribution to mathematics
- (c) Buddhist architecture in Asia
- (d) India's space programme

Answer: (b) — India's contribution to mathematics

Explanation: New York: External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar inaugurated a special exhibition titled 'From Shunya to Ananta' at the United Nations headquarters

The exhibition titled 'From Shunya to Ananta - The Indian Civilization's Contribution to Mathematics', hosted by the Permanent Mission of India to the UN, has been organised by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations in collaboration with the India International Centre.

He inaugurated the exhibition, which forms part of 'SAMHITA', a project of the India International Centre, supported by the Ministry of External Affairs.

Q17. . The theme of the 10th edition of the Indian Ocean Dialogue was:

- (a) Securing the Indo-Pacific
- (b) Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World
- (c) Blue Economy for Sustainable Growth
- (d) Maritime Cooperation and Security

Answer: (b) — Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World

Explanation: India recently hosted the tenth edition of the Indian Ocean Dialogue in New Delhi under the theme Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World.

The event marked a critical milestone as India assumed the Chairship of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) for the 2025–27 period.

Sports

National / International Championships

Q1. The Indian women's recurve team that won gold at the Archery World Cup 2026 included: Deepika Kumari Ankita Bhakat Kumkum Mohod Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) — 1, 2 and 3

Explanation: India concluded the Shanghai leg of the Archery World Cup 2026 series with two medals.

The Indian women's recurve team, comprising Deepika Kumari, Ankita Bhakat and Kumkum Mohod, won the gold medal at the Archery World Cup 2026 in Shanghai after beating hosts, the People's Republic of China, Stage 3 of the World Cup will be held in Antalya, Turkey, from June 9-14.

Q2. India's medal tally at the Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026 included:

- (a) 2 gold, 3 silver and 5 bronze
- (b) 1 silver and 9 bronze
- (c) 4 silver and 6 bronze
- (d) 10 bronze medals only

Answer: (b) — 1 silver and 9 bronze

Explanation: India finished the Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026 in Gandhinagar with 10 medals, including one silver and nine bronze.

Football

Q1. Which football club recently won its 29th La Liga title?

- (a) Real Madrid
- (b) Barcelona
- (c) Atletico Madrid
- (d) Sevilla

Answer: (b) — Barcelona

Explanation: Barcelona secured their 29th Spanish league title after beating Real Madrid 2-0 in El Clasico .

Real Madrid still holds the overall record for most LaLiga championships.

Table Tennis

Q1. Who won the DRM Cup Table Tennis Tournament 2026?

- (a) Team SPINX
- (b) Team SERSA
- (c) Team ECRSA
- (d) Team Waltair

Answer: (b) — Team SERSA

Explanation: Team SERSA emerged as the champions of the DRM Cup Table Tennis Tournament 2026, which concluded at the Railway Indoor Stadium

The two-day event, organised by the East Coast Railway Sports Association (ECRSA), Waltair Division, saw the participation of 51 players across 17 teams from Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Odisha and Chandigarh.

Q2. Which city will host the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026?

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Chennai
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Kolkata

Answer: (c) — Delhi

Explanation: Delhi will host the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026 at the Thyagraj Stadium, with players from more than 35 countries expected to participate.

Jointly organised by the Delhi government and the Table Tennis Federation of India, the championship will be held from July 27 to August 2.

Badminton

Q1. Consider the following statements: How many of the statements mentioned above is/are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

Answer: (b) — Only two

- (1) Thomas cup and Uber cup is associated with badminton.
- (2) Uber cup is a women's variant of badminton championship.

- (3) India won its maiden Uber cup in 2022.

Explanation: The 34th edition of the Thomas Cup – the men's team world championships in badminton and the 31st Uber Cup – the women's variant was held in Horsens, Denmark. The finals were played on 3rd May.

It is a biennial international championship. In 2022, India made history by winning the maiden Thomas cup and the women's team won the bronze medal in the 2014 and 2016 editions.

In the Thomas cup 2026, the Indian team was defeated by the French team in the semi-final.

Q2. Shrivanshi Valishetty, recently seen in the news, is associated with which sport?

- (a) Tennis
- (b) Badminton
- (c) Table Tennis
- (d) Squash

Answer: (b) — Badminton

Explanation: In Badminton, India's Shriyanshi Valishetty clinched the silver medal in women's singles at the Baoji China Masters in China in the summit clash of the Super 100 event at Baoji City Gymnasium.

Chess**Q1. . Which Indian grandmaster became the first Indian to qualify for the Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026 chess event?**

- (a) R Praggnanandhaa
- (b) D Gukesh
- (c) Aravindh Chithambaram
- (d) Vidit Gujrathi

Answer: (c) — Aravindh Chithambaram

Explanation: Aravindh Chithambaram became the first Indian grandmaster to secure a spot in the Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026 after he emerged victorious in the Road to EWC qualifier held at DreamHack Atlanta. \$15,000 (approximately Rs 14 lakh) in prize money

Tennis**Q1. Who won the men's doubles title at the Madrid Open 2026?**

- (a) Guido Andreozzi & Manuel Guinard
- (b) Rameev Ram & Joe Salisbury
- (c) Henry Patten & Harri Heliövaara
- (d) Nikola Mektić & Mate Pavić

Answer: (c) — Henry Patten & Harri Heliövaara

Explanation: In Tennis, Marta Kostyuk has captured the the women's singles title after winning the Madrid Open 2026, defeated world No. 8 Mirra Andreeva .

Doubles Results

Men's Doubles Final: Henry Patten and Harri Heliövaara defeated Guido Andreozzi and Manuel Guinard.

Women's Doubles Final: Kateřina Siniaková and Taylor Townsend (2) defeated Mirra Andreeva and Diana Shnaider

Q2. Who won the Italian Open 2026 men's singles title?

- (a) Novak Djokovic
- (b) Carlos Alcaraz
- (c) Jannik Sinner
- (d) Casper Ruud

Answer: (c) — Jannik Sinner

Explanation: The Italian Open 2026, also known as the Internazionali D'Italia.

Tennis world No. 1 Jannik Sinner defeated Norway's Casper Ruud in the Italian Open men's title final.

Sinner became the first Italian to win the men's singles title in Rome since Adriano Panatta in 1976,

Q3. Siddhant Bantia and Alexander Donski won the doubles title at:

- (a) Madrid Open 2026
- (b) Oeiras Open 4 2026
- (c) Monte Carlo Masters 2026
- (d) Estoril Open 2026

Answer: (b) — Oeiras Open 4 2026

Explanation: India's Siddhant Bantia and his Bulgarian partner Alexander Donski won the doubles title at Oeiras

Open 4 2026, an ATP Challenger 100 tennis tournament, in Portugal,

The title marked Siddhant Bantia's second ATP Challenger doubles crown of the season and third overall, all alongside Alexander Donski.

Golf**Q1. Who won the PGA Championship 2026?**

- (a) Rory McIlroy
- (b) Scottie Scheffler
- (c) Aaron Rai
- (d) Jon Rahm

Answer: (c) — Aaron Rai

Explanation: English golfer Aaron Rai won the PGA(Professional Golfers' Association) Championship 2026 at Aronimink Golf Club.

Race**Q1. Who won the Catalan Grand Prix recently?**

- (a) Fabio Di Giannantonio
- (b) Marc Marquez
- (c) Francesco Bagnaia
- (d) Jorge Martin

Answer: (a) — Fabio Di Giannantonio

Explanation: VR46 Racing's Fabio Di Giannantonio claimed victory at the Catalan Grand Prix 2026.

The Italian secured only his second MotoGP victory and VR46 Racing's first since the Indian Grand Prix in 2023.

Miscellaneous**Q1. Mount Kosciuszko, recently in news, is located in:**

- (a) Europe
- (b) North America
- (c) Australia
- (d) South America

Answer: (c) — Australia

Explanation: Vihaan Ram, a nine-year-old mountaineer from Hanuma Thanda in Dhoolimitta mandal of Siddipet district, Telangana, has successfully scaled Mount Kosciuszko, the highest peak on the Australian continent

Vihaan undertook the expedition with a social message, carrying a banner urging youth to 'Say No to Drugs'.

Q2. Ishank, who recently set a world record, is associated with which sport?

- (a) Athletics
- (b) Swimming
- (c) Cycling
- (d) Rowing

Answer: (b) — Swimming

Explanation: Indian pole vaulter Kuldeep Kumar rewrote the men's national record after recording 5.41m mark at the inaugural Indian Indoor Open Combined Events and Pole Vault Competition in Bhubaneswar.

He cleared the mark of 5.41m in his first attempt and decided to go for 5.46m but failed to cross that mark.

He broke the national record of 5.40m set last year by Dev Kumar Meena and also improved the national indoor record of 5.30m set earlier in March by Reegan G of Tamil Nadu.

Q3. The 2026 Asian Weightlifting Championships are being held in:

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Mumbai
- (c) Gandhinagar
- (d) Hyderabad

Answer: (c) — Gandhinagar

Explanation: India is set to host the prestigious 2026 Asian Weightlifting Championships in Gandhinagar, Gujarat from 11th May, marking the country's first time hosting the event in 44 years. The championship will conclude on the 17th of this month.

India is hosting the continental weightlifting championships for the second time. New Delhi was the host city for the 1982 Asian Championships.

Q4. The 5th Asia Cup Bridge Championships will be held in which Indian state?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Goa
- (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (c) — Goa

Explanation: The prestigious fifth Asia Cup Bridge Championships will be held from June 21-27 at the Taj Cidade de Goa Horizon, Goa, the Bridge Federation of India (BFI), .

Held once in four years, the Asia Cup ranks among the most distinguished continental Bridge Championships, conducted under the aegis of the Asia Bridge fraternity, with participation from leading nations across Asia and Oceania.

Q5. The UEFA Women's Champions League 2026 title was recently won by:

- (a) Arsenal
- (b) Barcelona
- (c) Paris Saint-Germain
- (d) Chelsea

Answer: (c) — Paris Saint-Germain

Explanation: Paris Saint-Germain (PSG) successfully defended their Union of European Football Associations (UEFA) Champions League title by defeating Arsenal Football Club. PSG became only the second club, after Real Madrid Club de Fútbol, to win the UEFA Champions League in two consecutive seasons.

Q6. Nisha Sasikumar, recently in the news, is associated with which sport/adventure activity?

- (a) Mountaineering
- (b) Scuba Diving
- (c) Paragliding
- (d) Skiing

Answer: (a) — Mountaineering

Explanation: Sixteen-year-old mountaineer Nisha Sasikumar from Chennai has summited Mount Everest, becoming one of the youngest climbers in the world to scale the world's highest mountain via the South Col route from Nepal.

Ms. Nisha reached the 8,848.86-metre summit on May 25, at the age of 16 years and 80 days, as part of an expedition organised by Elite Exped.

Banking / Finance

Q1. Which of the following best distinguishes EGRs from Gold ETFs?

- (a) EGRs are not tradable on exchanges
- (b) Gold ETFs represent physical gold, while EGRs do not
- (c) EGRs represent physical gold stored in vaults, whereas ETFs are fund units investing in gold
- (d) There is no difference between the two

Answer: (c) — EGRs represent physical gold stored in vaults, whereas ETFs are fund units investing in gold

Explanation: National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) announced the launch of Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs), a new segment aimed at bringing greater transparency, efficiency and formalisation to India's gold market. EGR is an electronic receipt issued against physical gold deposited with a Sebi-accredited vault manager.

How are EGRs different from gold ETFs?

The core difference between EGRs and gold ETFs is the underlying asset. While EGR represent physical gold in a vault, ETFs are units of a fund that invests in gold.

Q2. Debt Recovery Tribunals (DRTs), are best described as:

- (a) Constitutional bodies
- (b) Legislative bodies
- (c) Regulatory authorities
- (d) Quasi-judicial bodies

Answer: (d) — Quasi-judicial bodies

Explanation: The Department of Financial Services (DFS) convened a colloquium of Chairpersons of Debt Recovery Appellate Tribunals and Presiding Officers of Debt Recovery Tribunals (DRTs) in New Delhi.

DRTs are quasi-judicial bodies established under the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993.

Role: Their primary role is adjudicating debt recovery disputes related to banks and financial institutions.

Q3. "The Wealth of Nations", recently seen in news for its 250th anniversary, was written by:

- (a) David Ricardo
- (b) Karl Marx
- (c) Adam Smith
- (d) John Maynard Keynes

Answer: (c) — Adam Smith

Explanation: The 250th anniversary of The Wealth of Nations has revived debates on the Das Adam Smith Problem in economic thought.

The Das Adam Smith Problem refers to the perceived contradiction between self-interest in The Wealth of Nations and moral sympathy in The Theory of Moral Sentiments. Modern scholars argue it is a misinterpretation, asserting that Smith's philosophy integrates ethics and economics into a unified framework.

Q4. With reference to the UDGM portal, which of the following statements is correct?

- (a) It is operated by SEBI for tracing inactive demat accounts.
- (b) It enables inter-bank transfer of dormant deposits.
- (c) It acts as a search platform for unclaimed bank deposits.

(d) It is meant only for public sector banks.

Answer: (c) — It acts as a search platform for unclaimed bank deposits.

Explanation: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) recently told the Supreme Court that 30 banks have been integrated into its centralised web portal, UDGM, to enable legal heirs to trace funds belonging to deceased account holders.

UDGM (Unclaimed Deposits-Gateway to Access inforMation) is an online portal developed by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

It facilitates the registered users to search unclaimed deposits/accounts across multiple banks at one place in a centralized manner.

Q5. GARUDA, recently seen in the news, has been proposed by which organisation?

- (a) Reserve Bank of India
- (b) Securities and Exchange Board of India
- (c) Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
- (d) Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Answer: (b) — Securities and Exchange Board of India

Explanation: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) proposed GARUDA, a green-channel mechanism for Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).

GARUDA stands for "Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement"

The proposal seeks to reduce the waiting period for launching regular AIF schemes from the current 30 days to 10 working days after filing the Placement Memorandum (PPM) with Sebi.

Q6. India's first SEBI-approved exchange-traded weather derivatives contract "RAINMUMBAI" was launched by:

- (a) NSE – National Stock Exchange
- (b) BSE – Bombay Stock Exchange
- (c) NCDEX – National Commodities and Derivatives Exchange
- (d) MCX – Multi Commodity Exchange

Answer: (c) — NCDEX – National Commodities and Derivatives Exchange

Explanation: The National Commodities and Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX) recently announced the launch of India's first SEBI-approved exchange-traded weather derivatives contract, named "RAINMUMBAI".

It is India's first exchange-traded weather derivatives contract.

It was launched by the National Commodity and Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX).

The instrument will be used to hedge losses from unpredictable weather and monsoon variability.

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